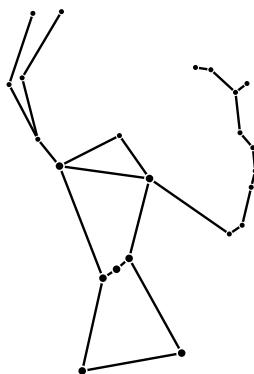


QUOTATIONS

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QUOTATIONS



Collected by John O'Hanley

1988 – 2026

Beeblebrox, ... recently voted the Worst Dressed Sentient Being in the Known Universe for the seventh time ...

~ DOUGLAS ADAMS, *Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy*

"Come on," he droned, "I've been ordered to take you down to the bridge. Here I am, brain the size of a planet and they ask me to take you down to the bridge. Call that job satisfaction? 'Cos I don't."

~ DOUGLAS ADAMS, *Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy*

More leisure than I wish is mine.

~ AESCHYLUS, *Prometheus Bound*

Don't worry about people stealing your ideas. If your ideas are any good, you'll have to ram them down people's throats.

~ HOWARD AIKEN

For twenty years, I spent two or three hours a day looking at pairs of things, comparing them, and asking myself: *Which has more life?*

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 1*

In the 20th century we have passed through a unique period, one in which architecture as a discipline has been in a state that is almost unimaginably bad. Sometimes I think of it as a mass psychosis of unprecedented dimension, in which the people of earth – in large numbers and in almost all contemporary societies – have created a form of architecture which is against life, insane, image-ridden, hollow.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 1*

... to prune a design, and look at it over and over again, searching for any little parts that are not centers – and then work at it, compressing, cutting, simplifying, re-arranging, until every single part, and every part of every part, and every part between the parts are all centers. This is tremendously hard work.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 2*

As any designer will tell you, it is the first steps in a design process which count for most. The first few strokes, which create the form, carry within them the destiny of the rest.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 2*

Insofar as unfolded buildings are lovable, what we love about them is not their age but the rightness which we experience in them. This rightness got into them *as a result of a step-by-step unfolding process*. We can see and feel the rightness. And we see it and feel it because it has a different geometric character from the character which is created by “design”.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 2*

It is essential to form this vision of the emerging building *in your mind's eye*, not in sketches on paper. Words and interior visions, when seen with your eyes closed, are more labile, more fluid, transformable, and three-dimensional, than sketches or physical designs.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 2*

It is *feeling*, above all, which has the greatest chance of dealing with the whole in a balanced way, because it is precisely the nature of feeling that it does embrace the whole – while intellectual ideas more often concentrate on parts and end up getting them out of proportion.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 2*

Living structure in buildings can only be *generated*. It cannot be created by brute force from designs. The building – its conception, plan design, detailed layout, structural design, and material detail are all unfolded, step by step in time.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 2*

Most present-day architects like *talking* about construction, but are afraid of construction tools, and have little feeling for them. In many cases, getting their hands dirty scares them.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 2*

Simplicity is the state in which all structure is removed, except exactly that structure which is required.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 2*

The gradual rubbing together of phenomena to get the right result, the slow process of getting things right, is almost unknown to us today.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 2*

The single most important thing that happens during the process of making anything, is the ever watchful task of getting the next bit of sequence right and modifying it as we go along. Paying attention to what has to be done next, and getting this right, is as important as what one actually does. The more one understands the idea of unfolding, and the more one understands the key role which sequence plays in the unfolding process, the more it becomes clear that the process of design and the process of construction are inseparable.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 2*

The step-by-step approach works. The all-or-nothing does not work. This is the secret of biological evolution. It would be impossible for nature to “design” a system as complex as an organism all at once.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 2*

We aim, by the end, to remove all extraneous structure. What we want is to cut and cut and cut until there is almost nothing left.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 2*

You know the *feeling* which the thing will have. But you do *not* know the *form*. In fact, you keep having to change the form, because as the work unfolds, you find out many, many details which have the wrong feeling, which do not function, in response to the whole, as you thought they would. Because you keep the *feeling* constant, you *have* to change the form.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 2*

... making even tiny changes too casually can be damaging.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 3*

Go into your mind's eye pretending to walk through the building, as if it existed already, but you are seeing it for the first time, and are stunned by its beauty. You are genuinely surprised. You find yourself stunned by the beauty of the rooms. And you ask yourself, then, which features of what I am seeing, are making it so beautiful?

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 3*

What an extreme comment on the state of the world: that people should weep, merely because they are allowed to sketch on paper the apartment layout that they wanted for their family.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 3*

What will generate tranquility? The essence of it is pretty simple, but requires much concentration. Stand in the place. Ask yourself what you should put there – a certain stone on the mantel, a color on a piece of wall, the shape of an opening. For any of these, you ask, does it generate greater tranquility in me? If it does, keep it. If it does not, reject it. Keep on doing that, for everything around you. And then, get rid of everything else.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 3*

... the underlying design vocabulary of the 20th century, almost throughout the century, asserted that designers should create structures that are “interesting”, “pleasing”, “fantastic”, “exhilarating”, “with elan”, and so on – anything but *beautiful*. *That* word has unalterable meaning, cannot be contaminated, and during the temporary insanity of the 20th century, struck a nerve which people could not tolerate.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 4*

I try to shape the volume such that its volume brings tears to my throat. This sadness of tears, when I reach it, is also joy.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 4*

In order to create living structure, we must please ourselves. And you need *only* please yourself. But you must please yourself *truly*.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 4*

It is very, very hard to make a beautiful building.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 4*

What is the reason for this “food-like” character of the making process? Why should it matter so much, whether a person makes something beautiful or not? Why should it have such a profound effect on the maker?

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Nature of Order, Book 4*

Here there is no mastery of unnameable creative processes: only the patience of a craftsman, chipping away slowly; the mastery of what is made does not lie in the depths of some impenetrable ego; it lies, instead, in the simple mastery of the steps in the process, and in the definition of these steps.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Timeless Way of Building*

The simple process by which people generate a living building, simply by walking it out, waving their arms, thinking together, placing stakes in the ground, will always touch them deeply.

~ CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER, *The Timeless Way of Building*

An older woman started to instruct her in the Islamic way of breast-feeding. First you say *Bismallah* before you put the nipple into the mouth. As the baby is feeding, beg Allah to protect your child from illness, earthly temptations, and the evil ways of the Jews.

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Infidel*

Ayaan believes that sexual repression is at the root of all the related problems, because “without sexual freedom there is no self.” [C. Hitchens, foreword]

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Infidel*

Drinking wine and wearing trousers were nothing compared to reading the history of ideas.

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Infidel*

In Saudia Arabia, everything bad was the fault of the Jews. The children next door were taught to pray for the health of their parents and the destruction of the Jews.

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Infidel*

Little children were excised on kitchen tables – I knew this from Somalis for whom I translated.

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Infidel*

Most of all, I think it was the novels that saved me from submission.

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Infidel*

The Muslim Brotherhood believed that there was a pure, original Islam to which we all should return. The movement was founded in the 1920s in Egypt as an Islamic revivalist movement, then caught on and spread – slowly at first, but much faster in the 1970s, as waves of funding flooded in from the suddenly massively rich Saudis.

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Infidel*

The Prophet said: “I have left you with clear guidance; no one deviates from it after me, except that he shall be destroyed.”

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Infidel*

The clan simply would not stand for it. If I married Ken [a non-Muslim Kenyan], he might even be killed.

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Infidel*

The most fanatical Brotherhood members, who were usually in their teens and twenties ...

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Infidel*

We were not just servants of Allah, we were slaves.

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Infidel*

Estimates are that 200 million women worldwide have undergone female genital mutilation; most victims, though not all, are Muslim.

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Prey*

Having seen firsthand how quickly history can fast-forward, I am keenly aware that it can just as rapidly rewind.

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Prey*

In 1953, President Nasser elicited uproarious laughter when he told an Egyptian audience that the Muslim Brotherhood wanted to force all women to wear the hijab in public. Only decades later, what had seemed a joke became reality.

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Prey*

Rapists can avoid persecution in Algeria, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait, Libya, Palestine, and Syria if they marry their victims.

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Prey*

Writing under a pseudonym about her ordeal, one of the survivors of the grooming gangs in Rotherham said she had been the victim of “religiously sanctioned sexual violence.” “They made it clear that because I was a non-Muslim, and not a virgin, and because I didn’t dress ‘modestly’, that they believed I deserved to be ‘punished’.” That punishment included more than a hundred rapes by perpetrators, some of whom quoted the Quran while beating her.

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Prey*

Yet these days, those who advocate the superiority of Western civilization are demonized, especially on university campuses, as racists or white supremacists.

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Prey*

“It doesn’t matter which woman it is, what she looks like, her age, or anything. Their idea is that every man wants to fuck every woman nearby him. I’m sorry to say it so directly. It is really about sexuality. The head scarf is also about sexuality, and here we have women without head scarves. It’s so hard for them to accept that they are willing to kill me for it.” [Seyran Ates]

~ AYAAN HIRSI ALI, *Prey*

Dixon liked and revered him for his air of detesting everything that presented itself to his senses, and of not meaning to let this detestation become staled by custom.

~ KINGSLEY AMIS, *Lucky Jim*

She went on like this while Dixon looked her in the eyes. His panic mounted in sincerity and volume.

~ KINGSLEY AMIS, *Lucky Jim*

"I doubt it," he said at last. "Upon consideration, I feel it incumbent upon me to doubt it. I have miscellaneous concerns in London that need my guiding hand."

~ KINGSLEY AMIS, *Lucky Jim*

"I've finished with Bertrand." She spoke as if of a household detergent that had proved unsatisfactory.

~ KINGSLEY AMIS, *Lucky Jim*

He looked Richard up and down, and said, as if identifying him by name, "Charisma bypass."

~ MARTIN AMIS, *The Information*

His hair resembled damp ripe hay that had undergone reckless chemical enrichment.

~ MARTIN AMIS, *The Information*

His third novel wasn't published anywhere. Neither was his fourth. Neither was his fifth. In those three brief sentences we adumbrate a Mahabharata of pain.

~ MARTIN AMIS, *The Information*

In appearance Frances Ort suggested a rainbow coalition of the chromosomes. She could probably go anywhere in the five boroughs – Harlem, Little Astoria, Chinatown – and provoke no comment other than the usual incitements to immediate and rigorous sexual congress.

~ MARTIN AMIS, *The Information*

It would seem that the universe is thirty billion light-years across and every inch of it would kill us if we went there. This is the position of the universe with regard to human life.

~ MARTIN AMIS, *The Information*

Now Pluto. One should never mock the afflicted, of course, but Pluto really is an awful little piece of shit.

~ MARTIN AMIS, *The Information*

The target is driving along. Without a care in the world, as they say. Although of course no one old enough to drive is without a care in the world. No one old enough to drive a trike is without a care in the world.

~ MARTIN AMIS, *The Information*

... but these days, as Odilo says again and again to all his friends (and the compliment, I think, is pitched decorously high), she bangs like a shithouse door in a gale.

~ MARTIN AMIS, *Time's Arrow*

From my point of view, work is an eight-hour panic attack.

~ MARTIN AMIS, *Time's Arrow*

I didn't immediately see this: that now human shit is out in the open, we'll get a chance to find out what this stuff can really do.

~ MARTIN AMIS, *Time's Arrow*

The humans had grown their winter coats, and the high buildings trembled in the tight grip of their stress equations.

~ MARTIN AMIS, *Time's Arrow*

Chiunque può arrabbiarsi: questo è facile. Ma arrabbiarsi con la persona giusta, e nel grado giusto, ed al momento giusto, e per lo scopo giusto, e nel modo giusto: questo non è nelle possibilità di chiunque e non è facile.

~ ARISTOTELE

... The years shall run like rabbits
For in my arms I hold
The Flower of the Ages,
And the first love of the world.

But all the clocks in the city
Began to whirl and chime:
O let not time deceive you,
You cannot conquer time ...

In headaches and in worry
Vaguely life leaks away,
And Time will have his fancy
To-morrow or today ...

~ W. H. AUDEN, *As I Walked Out One Evening*

Voici une autre forme de tentation, encore plus dangereuse. Il s'agit de la maladie de la curiosité. C'est elle qui nous incite à tenter de découvrir les secrets de la nature, tous ces secrets inaccessibles à notre compréhension qui ne nous concernent pas et que l'homme ne devrait pas désirer connaître.

~ SAINT AUGUSTIN

... ogni attimo una punta di eternità.

~ MARCO AURELIO

La morte sorride a tutti; un uomo non puo far altro che sorriderle di rimando.

~ MARCO AURELIO

... nor could he refrain from often saying to himself, in Mr. Rushworth's company, "If this man had not twelve thousand a year, he would be a very stupid fellow."

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Mansfield Park*

"Certainly, my home at my uncle's brought me acquainted with a circle of admirals. Of *Rears*, and *Vices*, I saw enough. Now, do not be suspecting me of a pun, I entreat." Edmund again felt grave, and only replied, "It is a noble profession."

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Mansfield Park*

... and from habitude very little incommoded by the remarks and ejaculations of Mrs. Allen, whose vacancy of mind, and incapacity for thinking, were such that, as she never talked a great deal, so she could never be entirely silent.

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Northanger Abbey*

And why had she been so partial to that grove? Was it from dejection of spirits?

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Northanger Abbey*

It was not within the power of his gallantry to detain her longer.

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Northanger Abbey*

... and though not the very happiest being in the world herself, had found enough in her duties, her friends, and her children, to attach her to life, and make it no matter of indifference to her when she was called on to quit them.

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Persuasion*

She had some feelings she was ashamed to investigate. They were too much like joy, senseless joy!

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Persuasion*

Yes, here I am, Sophia, quite ready to make a foolish match. Anybody between fifteen and thirty may have me for asking. A little beauty, a few smiles, and a few compliments to the navy, and I am a lost man.

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Persuasion*

... but his friend Mr. Darcy soon drew the attention of the room by his fine, tall person, handsome features, noble mien, and the report which was in general circulation within five minutes after his entrance, of his having ten thousand a year.

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Pride and Prejudice*

And now nothing remains for me but to assure you in the most animated language of the violence of my affection.

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Pride and Prejudice*

Have you anything else to propose for my domestic felicity?

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Pride and Prejudice*

I have not the pleasure of understanding you. Of what are you talking?

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Pride and Prejudice*

I never saw a more promising inclination. He was growing quite inattentive to other people, and wholly engrossed by her. Every time they met, it was more decided and remarkable. At his own ball he offended two or three young ladies by not asking them to dance, and I spoke to him twice myself, without receiving an answer. Could there be finer symptoms? Is not general incivility the very essence of love?

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Pride and Prejudice*

The Gardiners staid only one night at Longbourn, and set off the next morning with Elizabeth in pursuit of novelty and amusement.

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Pride and Prejudice*

Elinor agreed to it all, for she did not think he deserved the compliment of rational opposition.

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Sense and Sensibility*

“Is there a felicity in the world,” said Marianne, “superior to this?”

~ JANE AUSTEN, *Sense and Sensibility*

Truth emerges more readily from error than from confusion.

~ FRANCIS BACON, *Novum Organum*

... we cannot tell how many wildly foolish actions are due to the secret rivalries that drive men to mirror the type they have set up as ideal, to consume their energies in making themselves a moonshine reflection of someone else.

~ HONORÉ DE BALZAC, *Cousin Bette*

Plage. Et mer.

Lumière.

Le vent du nord.

Le silence des marées.

Des jours. Des nuits.

Une liturgie. Immobile, si on regarde bien. Immobile.

~ ALESSANDRO BARICCO, *Océan Mer*

Elle n'a pas de murs, Tombouctou, parce que là-bas ils pensent, depuis toujours, que sa beauté suffirait, à elle seule, pour arrêter n'importe quel ennemi.

~ ALESSANDRO BARICCO, *Océan Mer*

Le scientifique rejette systématiquement, catégoriquement, sans nuance et sans appel toutes les explications qui invoqueraient, même partiellement et de très loin, le surnaturel, la magie et le miracle.

~ CYRILLE BARRETTE, *Mystère sans magie*

The temple bell stops,
but the sound keeps coming
out of the flowers.

~ BASHO

Ô Mort, vieux capitaine, il est temps! levons l'ancre!
Ce pays nous ennuie, ô Mort! Appareillons!

~ CHARLES BAUDELAIRE

Mais les vrais voyageurs sont ceux-là seuls qui partent
Pour partir, coeurs légers, semblables aux ballons,
De leur fatalité jamais ils ne s'écarternt,
Et, sans savoir pourquoi, disent toujours : Allons!

~ CHARLES BAUDELAIRE, *Le voyage*

... le bonheur est marié au silence.

~ CHARLES BAUDELAIRE, *Petits poèmes en prose*

Connaissez-vous la paresseuse Belgique, et avez-vous admiré
comme moi tous ces chiens vigoureux attelés à la charrette du
boucher, de la laitière ou du boulanger, et qui témoignent, par
leurs aboiements triomphants, du plaisir orgueilleux qu'ils
éprouvent à rivaliser avec les chevaux?

~ CHARLES BAUDELAIRE, *Petits poèmes en prose*

Grand délice que celui de noyer son regard dans l'immensité du
ciel et de la mer! Solitude, silence, incomparable chasteté de l'azur!

~ CHARLES BAUDELAIRE, *Petits poèmes en prose*

Il est l'heure de s'enivrer! Pour n'être pas les esclaves martyrisés du Temps, enivrez-vous; enivrez-vous sans cesse! De vin, de poésie ou de vertu, à votre guise.

~ CHARLES BAUDELAIRE, *Petits poèmes en prose*

J'invoque la muse familière, la citadine, la vivante, pour qu'elle m'aide à chanter les bons chiens, les pauvres chiens, les chiens crottés, ceux-là que chacun écarte, comme pestiférés et pouilleux, excepté le pauvre dont ils sont les associés, et le poète qui les regarde d'un oeil fraternel.

~ CHARLES BAUDELAIRE, *Petits poèmes en prose*

Les illusions, – me disait mon ami, – sont aussi innombrables peut-être que les rapports des hommes entre eux, ou des hommes avec les choses. Et quand l'illusion disparaît, c'est-à-dire quand nous voyons l'être ou le fait tel qu'il existe en dehors de nous, nous éprouvons un bizarre sentiment, compliqué moitié de regret pour le fantôme disparu, moitié de surprise agréable devant la nouveauté, devant le fait réel.

~ CHARLES BAUDELAIRE, *Petits poèmes en prose*

Multitude, solitude: termes égaux et convertibles pour le poète actif et fécond. Qui ne sait pas peupler sa solitude, ne sait pas non plus être seul dans une foule affairée.

~ CHARLES BAUDELAIRE, *Petits poèmes en prose*

Ô nuit! ô rafraîchissantes ténèbres! vous êtes pour moi le signal d'une fête intérieure, vous êtes la délivrance d'une angoisse! Dans la solitude des plaines, dans les labyrinthes pierreux d'une capitale, scintillement des étoiles, explosion des lanternes, vous êtes le feu d'artifice de la déesse Liberté!

~ CHARLES BAUDELAIRE, *Petits poèmes en prose*

... ordinary reading, slow and uniform, strikes [a digital native] as incompatible, alien. It isn't just boring and obsolete. It's irritating.

~ MARK BAUERLEIN, *The Dumbest Generation*

A predictable descent commenced. The sixties generation's leaders didn't anticipate how their claim of exceptionalism would affect the next generation, and the next, but the sequence was entirely logical. Informed rejection of the past became uninformed rejection of the past, and then the complete and unworried ignorance of it.

~ MARK BAUERLEIN, *The Dumbest Generation*

Confidence and enjoyment don't guarantee better students. Furthermore, they prevent the students from forming one of the essential ingredients of long-term success: an accurate, realistic appraisal of their present capacities.

~ MARK BAUERLEIN, *The Dumbest Generation*

Few things are worse for adolescent minds than overblown appraisals of their merits.

~ MARK BAUERLEIN, *The Dumbest Generation*

For all their technological adroitness, they don't read or write or divide very well.

~ MARK BAUERLEIN, *The Dumbest Generation*

Fully 45 percent of the students just don't think leisure reading is important ("a little" or "not at all"). Unconvinced of what adult readers feel deep in their hearts and know from long experience, nearly half of the student body disregards books by choice and disposition, and they don't expect to suffer for it. In their minds, a-literacy and anti-intellectualism pose no career obstacles, and they have no shame attached.

~ MARK BAUERLEIN, *The Dumbest Generation*

How serenely this undergrad announces the transfer from "the whole book thing" to the Internet, as if the desertion of a civilization's principal storehouse merits little more than a shrug.

~ MARK BAUERLEIN, *The Dumbest Generation*

In 1959, political philosopher Leo Strauss defined liberal education as “the counter-poison to mass culture”. A history professor who agrees with this view today becomes a fuddy-duddy in his own department.

~ MARK BAUERLEIN, *The Dumbest Generation*

Over the years, the indulgence of youth circulated among educators and settled into sanctioned pedagogy with a predictable result: not an unleashing of independent, creative, skeptical mental energies of rising students, but what we have seen in previous chapters, routine irreverence and knowledge deficits.

~ MARK BAUERLEIN, *The Dumbest Generation*

Spend some hours in school zones and you see that the indulgent attitude toward youth, along with the downplaying of tradition, has reached the point of dogma among teachers, reporters, researchers, and creators in arts and humanitarian fields, and pro-knowledge, pro-tradition conceptions strike them as bluntly unpleasant, if not reactionary and out of touch.

~ MARK BAUERLEIN, *The Dumbest Generation*

The 18-year-old may have a Visa card, cell phone, My Space page, part-time job, Play Station 2, and an admissions letter to State U., but ask this wired and on-the-go high school senior a few intellectual questions and the facade of in-the-knownness crumbles.

~ MARK BAUERLEIN, *The Dumbest Generation*

The more mentors have engaged youth in youth terms, though, the more youth have disengaged from the mentors themselves and from the culture they are supposed to represent.

~ MARK BAUERLEIN, *The Dumbest Generation*

... as empty as the inside of your shiny skull.

~ YVES BEAUCHEMIN, *The Alleycat*

A kitchen should look like an operating room. The most tenacious germ should die in an hour, of melancholy.

~ YVES BEAUCHEMIN, *The Alleycat*

Save your tears to salt your soup.

~ YVES BEAUCHEMIN, *The Alleycat*

What's come over you? Have you found a Rembrandt in your basement?

~ YVES BEAUCHEMIN, *The Alleycat*

All of the astounding inventiveness and infinite variety of geometry during that amazingly prolific half century [1872–1922] is seen as one orderly, simple whole from the commanding summit which Klein recognized as the proper point of view to sweep in the whole of the past of geometry and to foresee much of its future. Here is the famous sentence: “Given a manifold and a group of transformations of the same, to develop the theory of invariants relating to that group.”

~ E. T. BELL, *The Queen of the Sciences*

Any normal boy or girl of sixteen could master the calculus in half the time often devoted to stumbling through Book One of Caesar's *Gallic War*.

~ E. T. BELL, *The Queen of the Sciences*

As it is of some importance to understand exactly what Weierstrauss proved, I state it more fully. By retaining *all* the postulates of a field, it is impossible to construct a class of things which satisfies all postulates and which is not either the class of all complex numbers or one of the latter's subclasses.

~ E. T. BELL, *The Queen of the Sciences*

Common sense and all appearances notwithstanding, there are precisely as many real numbers as there are complex numbers.

~ E. T. BELL, *The Queen of the Sciences*

How could the whole race have missed [analytic geometry] till Descartes saw it?

~ E. T. BELL, *The Queen of the Sciences*

Mathematics, according to David Hilbert, is a game played according to certain simple rules with meaningless marks on paper.

~ E. T. BELL, *The Queen of the Sciences*

The assumptions from which mathematics starts are simple; the rest is not.

~ E. T. BELL, *The Queen of the Sciences*

It must not be supposed that stout women of a certain age never seek to seduce the eye and trouble the meditations of man by other than moral charms.

~ ARNOLD BENNETT, *The Old Wives' Tale*

She was attached to it by the heavy chains of habit.

~ ARNOLD BENNETT, *The Old Wives' Tale*

The reason that the vast majority of Serbs are adamant that they are threatened by genocide on all fronts and that they were mercilessly exploited in Yugoslavia is quite simply because their media have been telling them so day in day out for years.

~ CHRISTOPHER BENNETT, *Yugoslavia's Bloody Collapse*

Yugoslavia's disintegration is largely a testimony to the power of the media in the modern world.

~ CHRISTOPHER BENNETT, *Yugoslavia's Bloody Collapse*

It is the most general term that can possibly be conceived, as it may stand for any one thing in the universe of which we speak.

~ HUGH BLAIR, *Lectures on Rhetoric and Belles Lettres*

... we must not forget to observe, that spoken language has a great superiority over written language, in point of energy or force. The voice of the living speaker makes impression on the mind, much stronger than can be made by the perusal of any writing.

~ HUGH BLAIR, *Lectures on Rhetoric and Belles Lettres*

A multitude of Latin words have of late been poured in upon us.

~ HUGH BLAIR, *Lectures on Rhetoric and Belles Lettres*

And hence, if our Language, by reason of the simple arrangement of its words, possesses less harmony, less beauty, and less force, than the Greek or Latin; it is, however, in its meaning, more obvious and plain.

~ HUGH BLAIR, *Lectures on Rhetoric and Belles Lettres*

Perspicuity, it will be readily admitted, is the fundamental quality of Style; a quality so essential in every kind of Writing, that for the want of it, nothing can atone. Without this, the richest ornaments of Style only glimmer through the dark; and puzzle instead of pleasing the reader. This, therefore, must be our first object, to make our meaning clearly and fully understood, and understood without the least difficulty. "Discourse" says Quintilian, "ought always to be obvious, even to the most careless and negligent hearer, so that the sense shall strike his mind, as the light of the sun does our eyes, though they are not directed upwards to it. We must study, not only that every hearer may understand us, but that it shall be impossible for him not to understand us."

~ HUGH BLAIR, *Lectures on Rhetoric and Belles Lettres*

The Greek, which is the most perfect of all the known tongues, is very regular and complete in all the moods and tenses. The Latin, though formed on the same model, is not so perfect; particularly in the passive voice, which forms most of the tenses, by the help of the auxiliary *sum*.

~ HUGH BLAIR, *Lectures on Rhetoric and Belles Lettres*

The use and importance of Precision, may be deduced from the nature of the human mind. It never can view, clearly and distinctly, above one object at a time.

~ HUGH BLAIR, *Lectures on Rhetoric and Belles Lettres*

The words which a man uses to express his ideas, may be faulty in three respects; they may either not express that idea which the author intends, but some other which only resembles, or is akin to it; or, they may express that idea, but not quite fully and completely; or, they may express it, together with something more than he intends. Precision stands opposed to all these three faults; but chiefly to the last.

~ HUGH BLAIR, *Lectures on Rhetoric and Belles Lettres*

This artificial method of communicating thought, we now behold carried to the highest perfection. Language is become a vehicle by which the most delicate and refined emotions of one mind can be transmitted, or, if we may so speak, transfused into another. Not only are names given to all objects around us, by which means an easy and speedy intercourse is carried on for providing the necessities of life, but all the relations and differences among these objects are minutely marked, the invisible sentiments of the mind are described, the most abstract notions and conceptions are rendered intelligible; and all the ideas which science can discover, or imagination create, are known by their proper names. The object is become familiar; and, like the expanse of the firmament, and other great objects, which we are accustomed to behold, we behold it without wonder.

~ HUGH BLAIR, *Lectures on Rhetoric and Belles Lettres*

Thought and language act and re-act upon each other mutually. Logic and rhetoric have here, as in many other cases, a strict connexion; and he that is learning to arrange his sentences with accuracy and order, is learning, at the same time, to think with accuracy and order.

~ HUGH BLAIR, *Lectures on Rhetoric and Belles Lettres*

To pronounce with a proper degree of slowness, and with a full and clear articulation, is the first thing to be studied by all who begin to speak in public; and cannot be too much recommended to them.

~ HUGH BLAIR, *Lectures on Rhetoric and Belles Lettres*

We are pleased with an author, we consider him as deserving praise, who frees us from all fatigue of searching for his meaning; who carries us through his subject without any embarrassment or confusion; whose style flows always like a limpid stream, where we see to the very bottom.

~ HUGH BLAIR, *Lectures on Rhetoric and Belles Lettres*

[French] is, perhaps, the happiest language for conversation, in the known world; but on the higher subjects of composition, the English may be justly esteemed greatly to excel it considerably.

~ HUGH BLAIR, *Lectures on Rhetoric and Belles Lettres*

Hear the voice of the Bard!
Who Present, Past & Future sees;
Whose ears have heard
The Holy Word
That walk'd among the ancient trees;

~ WILLIAM BLAKE, *Introduction to Songs of Experience*

If the doors of perception were cleansed every thing would appear to man as it is, infinite.

~ WILLIAM BLAKE, *The Marriage of Heaven and Hell*

... infantilization is deepening in a culture increasingly driven by electronics.

~ ROBERT BLY, *The Sibling Society*

But today we are lying to ourselves about the renaissance the computer will bring. It will bring nothing.

~ ROBERT BLY, *The Sibling Society*

Capitalism has siphoned off male energy.

~ ROBERT BLY, *The Sibling Society*

Television is stealing the neocortex's observation time and giving a little useless information in return.

~ ROBERT BLY, *The Sibling Society*

We do not value initiation of young men or women, because we can't imagine invisible gifts any more.

~ ROBERT BLY, *The Sibling Society*

So I lowered the sails ... and once I had lowered them there was nothing more I could do except pray. So I prayed. And between times I turned to one of my sailing manuals to see what advice it contained for me. It was like being in hell with instructions.

~ CHAS BLYTH

The very fact that repetition of the same experiment, in general yields different recordings pertaining to the object, immediately implies that a comprehensive account of experience in this field must be expressed by statistical laws.

~ NIELS BOHR, *Atomic Physics and Human Knowledge*

Thus, the description of quantum phenomena requires a distinction in principle between the objects under investigation and the measuring apparatus by means of which the experimental conditions are defined.

~ NIELS BOHR, *Atomic Physics and Human Knowledge*

... elle avait passé la semaine de son absence à Rumilly dans une orgie perpétuelle avec ses autres valets.

~ LA COMTESSE DE BOIGNE, *Mémoires*

... il était à sa nièce, madame de Rothe, fille de sa soeur, lady Forester. Elle était veuve d'un général Rothe; elle avait été assez belle, était restée fort despote, et faisait les honneurs de la maison de son oncle avec lequel elle vivait depuis de longues années dans une intimité fort complète qu'ils prenaient peu le soin de dissimuler.

~ LA COMTESSE DE BOIGNE, *Mémoires*

... les massacres de Parga, d'Hydra, de Chio, toutes ces dames chrétiennes enlevées à leur famille et vendues sur les marchés de Smyrne n'arrachaient pas un cri à un seul organe de la presse [britannique].

~ LA COMTESSE DE BOIGNE, *Mémoires*

... l'esprit de parti, monstre dont on ne peut trop repousser les approches quand on vit dans un temps de révolution et qu'on veut conserver quelque chose d'humain.

~ LA COMTESSE DE BOIGNE, *Mémoires*

... on se bornait à se détester cordialement de part et d'autre.

~ LA COMTESSE DE BOIGNE, *Mémoires*

Il est établie qu'à cet âge [de 18 ans] une demoiselle entre en vente et qu'on doit la diriger sur les meilleurs marchés.

~ LA COMTESSE DE BOIGNE, *Mémoires*

Il regnait une épidémie de vengeance.

~ LA COMTESSE DE BOIGNE, *Mémoires*

Je me rappelle que les rires de monsieur de Calonne, lorsque l'année suivante, à Londres, il me trouva lisant un volume de Smith, *Wealth of Nations*, dont je faisais ma récréation, furent pour moi le premier avertissement que ce goût n'était pas général aux filles de quinze ans.

~ LA COMTESSE DE BOIGNE, *Mémoires*

La comtesse de Lieven en frémit et ne peut cacher son dépit, car, en outre de ses autres avantages, la nouvelle ambassadrice était plus jeune, plus jolie, et avait un impertinent embonpoint qui offusquait la désespérante maigreur de sa rivale.

~ LA COMTESSE DE BOIGNE, *Mémoires*

Le duc de Richelieu avait été marié, à dix-sept ans, à mademoiselle de Rochechouart qui en avait douze. Selon l'usage du temps, on l'avait envoyé voyager. Pendant les trois années de son absence, il recevait de fréquentes lettres de sa jeune épouse, remplies de grâce et d'esprit.

~ LA COMTESSE DE BOIGNE, *Mémoires*

Le fait était que monsieur de Talleyrand, amoureux comme un homme de dix-huit ans de sa nièce, la comtesse Edmond de Périgord, se serait trouvé gêné par la présence de la princesse.

~ LA COMTESSE DE BOIGNE, *Mémoires*

Leur visage s'épanouit quand un frère aîné vient les prier à danser; si elles causent avec un cadet, en revanche, les mères s'agitent sur leurs banquettes et paraissent au supplice.

~ LA COMTESSE DE BOIGNE, *Mémoires*

Monsieur de Lusson, jeune homme d'une charmante figure, immensément riche, bon officier, vivait habituellement dans la meilleure compagnie, eut l'imprudence d'aller à un de ces bals; on l'en chassa avec une telle dureté que, désespéré du ridicule dont il restait couvert dans un temps où le ridicule était le pire des maux, il se tua en arrivant à Paris.

~ LA COMTESSE DE BOIGNE, *Mémoires*

[Madame Gand] avait les plus beaux cheveux du monde; Édouard les admira. Elle lui assura qu'il n'en connaissait pas encore tout le mérite. Elle passa dans un cabinet de toilette et revint les cheveux détachés et tombant de façon à en être complètement voilée. Mais c'était Ève, avant qu'aucun tissu n'eût inventé, et avec moins d'innocence, *naked and not ashamed*. Le souper s'acheva dans ce costume primitif.

~ LA COMTESSE DE BOIGNE, *Mémoires*

A rough count showed that about 150 machines are under construction in America and England. One sometimes wonders where the programmers will come from.

~ BOWDEN ET. AL., *Faster Than Thought*

Coding time is usually only a fraction of the total time involved in getting the programme to work – such is the frailty of mankind.

~ BOWDEN ET. AL., *Faster Than Thought*

The machines have already reached the stage where the most common source of error is the human beings who programme them.

~ BOWDEN ET. AL., *Faster Than Thought*

But at sea, alone at the tiller, on a clear night with the stars in their millions and oneself alone, a pinpoint to the Moon, I felt nearer to the cool abstract heart of the Universe.

~ ERNLE BRADFORD, *The Journeying Moon*

Sometimes, in the late hours with a big city blinking outside the windows, people ask "But, out of all the places you've been to, which would you prefer to live in?" Always I am about to say "Greece," then something checks me, and I answer "Sicily".

~ ERNLE BRADFORD, *The Journeying Moon*

Berndt proclaimed the necessity for a universal indoctrination of the readers with anti-Semitism. In terms of every-day journalism this meant that no news item and no article should be allowed to appear without this slant.

~ ERNEST BRAMSTED, *Goebbels and National Socialist Propaganda*

From the start *Der Angriff* was designed as an “either-or” paper with the challenging motto on the front page “For the Suppressed Against the Exploiters!”

~ ERNEST BRAMSTED, *Goebbels and National Socialist Propaganda*

Computers can compute, but that’s not what people use them for, mostly. Mostly, computers store and retrieve information.

~ TIM BRAY, *Beautiful Code*

A recent Diet Pepsi campaign featured celebrities and showgirls smiling, cavorting, and grunting “uh-huh!” for half a minute. Not exactly a logical delineation of the product’s features and benefits.

~ RICHARD BRODIE, *Virus of the Mind*

Here is why imitation is so widespread; it is a good strategy. The others being imitated are the end line of a billion years of natural selection; they are the *survivors*, the successful replicators.

~ RICHARD BRODIE, *Virus of the Mind*

Memes involving danger, food, and sex spread faster than other memes because we are wired to pay more attention to them – we have *buttons* around those subjects.

~ RICHARD BRODIE, *Virus of the Mind*

Our minds excel at copying information and at following instructions. Remember the four characteristics of a virus: penetration, copying, possibly issuing instructions, and spreading. As horrifying as the thought may be initially, our minds are ideally susceptible to infection by mind viruses.

~ RICHARD BRODIE, *Virus of the Mind*

The ideas that spread the easiest, and therefore pervade society, are the ones that easily penetrate that old Stone–Age brain of ours. The whole of science has been a concerted effort to *foil* that natural selection of Stone–Age ideas by our brains and instead select ideas that are useful, that work, that are accurate models of reality.

~ RICHARD BRODIE, *Virus of the Mind*

To the universe, there's no *you*, or human beings, or giraffes, or solar systems, or galaxies. All those are human–invented distinctions. They are all memes.

~ RICHARD BRODIE, *Virus of the Mind*

I have no relative but the universal mother, Nature: I will seek her breast and ask repose.

~ CHARLOTTE BRONTË, *Jane Eyre*

If she were a nice, pretty child, one might compassionate her forlornness; but one really cannot care for such a little toad as that.

~ CHARLOTTE BRONTË, *Jane Eyre*

... a young lady in whose skull the organs of reverence and reserve were not largely developed.

~ CHARLOTTE BRONTË, *Villette*

He laid himself open to my observation, according to my presence in the room just that degree of notice and consequence a person of my exterior habitually expects: that is to say, about what is given to unobtrusive articles of furniture, chairs of ordinary joiner's work, and carpets of no striking pattern.

~ CHARLOTTE BRONTË, *Villette*

I now signified that it was imperatively necessary my apartment should be relieved of the honour of her presence: she went away laughing.

~ CHARLOTTE BRONTË, *Villette*

No mockery in this world ever sounds to me so hollow as that of being told to *cultivate* happiness. What does such advice mean? Happiness is not a potato, to be planted in mould, and tilled with manure.

~ CHARLOTTE BRONTË, *Villette*

She went through, in that brief interval of her infant life, emotions such as some never feel: it was in her constitution: she would have more of such instants if she lived.

~ CHARLOTTE BRONTË, *Villette*

Oh, dreadful is the check – intense the agony
When the ear begins to hear and the eye begins to see;
When the pulse begins to throb, the brain to think again,
The soul to feel the flesh and the flesh to feel the chain!

~ EMILY BRONTË, *Julian M. and A.G. Rochelle*

Auschwitz has become a monstrous object of covetous lust.
Whence the frenzied effort to gain admission to this very closed club, and the desire to dislodge those who are already in it.

~ PASCAL BRUCKNER, *The Tyranny of Guilt*

In the nineteenth century, Tocqueville had already observed that the government had taken the place of Providence. Must it also take the place of conscience?

~ PASCAL BRUCKNER, *The Tyranny of Guilt*

The whole paradox of a sobered-up Europe is that it is no less arrogant than imperial Europe because it continues to project its categories on the rest of the world and childishly boasts that it is the origin of all the ills that beset mankind.

~ PASCAL BRUCKNER, *The Tyranny of Guilt*

Being you is not a gratifying experience at the atomic level.

~ BILL BRYSON, *A Short History of Nearly Everything*

Space is extremely well named and rather dismayingly uneventful.

~ BILL BRYSON, *A Short History of Nearly Everything*

There seemed to be a mystifying universal conspiracy among textbook authors to make certain the material they dealt with never strayed too near the realm of the mildly interesting, and was always at least a long-distance phone call from the frankly interesting.

~ BILL BRYSON, *A Short History of Nearly Everything*

Genius is only a greater aptitude for patience.

~ COMTE DE BUFFON

An analysis of the better-defined tools from Choukoutien has shown that the majority were chipped by right-handed persons. Monkeys and apes are usually indifferent to which hand they use, and the acquisition of greater skill in the one hand is a human trait linked with the dominance of one side of the brain, and doubtless connected with the habitual use of tools. Ninety-five percent of modern adult human beings are right-handed, but left-handedness was commoner in earlier times, as it is still among untrained infants.

~ C. SINGER ET. AL., *A History of Technology*

At the same time, metal-workers were among the first full-time specialists in industrial production, though specialists in magic or religion may have become so earlier.

~ C. SINGER ET. AL., *A History of Technology*

By the middle of the fourth century B.C., however, the Ionic alphabet of 24 letters had become standardized. It was the most perfect instrument for recording and preserving human speech that had come into existence.

~ C. SINGER ET. AL., *A History of Technology*

In the Mediterranean, deforestation had become serious by classical times.

~ C. SINGER ET. AL., *A History of Technology*

It is a common fallacy to suppose that monkeys cannot oppose the thumb to the other digits.

~ C. SINGER ET. AL., *A History of Technology*

One result of [the development of Neolithic farming] is that it now became worthwhile to keep prisoners as slaves instead of eating or torturing them.

~ C. SINGER ET. AL., *A History of Technology*

The Egyptians of the Old Kingdom had discovered the principle of expressing a single sound, whether consonant or vowel, by a single sign. Owing to their intense conservatism, they did not fully use it.

~ C. SINGER ET. AL., *A History of Technology*

The [medieval] diet of the masses was mainly vegetarian and frugal, two meals being usual.

~ C. SINGER ET. AL., *A History of Technology*

The diet of the masses in ancient Greece and Rome consisted of little but bread and a porridge of wheat or barley supplemented by vegetable, fish, and spice.

~ C. SINGER ET. AL., *A History of Technology*

The restriction of the various Semitic alphabets to consonants is difficult to explain, but it must be remembered that the structure of all the Semitic languages rests on the basis of consonantal bi-lateral or tri-lateral roots. These give the essential conception of the word, the vowels only providing the relations, case, tense, mood, and so forth [swim, swam, swum].

~ C. SINGER ET. AL., *A History of Technology*

When Europeans first explored Australia there were some 500 tribes with a total population of about 300,000. There were as many languages as tribes.

~ C. SINGER ET. AL., *A History of Technology*

Yet from the meagre data available it appears that all early vehicles shared one other peculiarity besides solid wheels – namely paired draught.

~ C. SINGER ET. AL., *A History of Technology*

Ces excursions secrètes, la fréquentation trop habituelle de Louis XV avec des demoiselles dont les charmes remplaçaient les avantages de l'éducation.

~ MME CAMPAN, *Mémoires*

C'était particulièrement contre la reine que l'insurrection était dirigée: je frémis encore en me souvenant que les poissardes, ou plutôt les furies qui portaient des tabliers blancs, criaient qu'ils étaient destinés à recevoir les entrailles de Marie-Antoinette; qu'elles s'en feraient des cocardes, et mêlaient les expressions les plus obscènes à ces horribles menaces; tant l'ignorance et la cruauté, qui se trouvent dans le masse de presque tous les peuples, peuvent dans les temps de troubles leur inspirer des sentiments atroces!

~ MME CAMPAN, *Mémoires*

Je rentrai chez moi pour écrire cette conversation.

~ MME CAMPAN, *Mémoires*

La grande piété de madame Élisabeth donnaient à ses actions et à ses discours une noblesse qui peignait celle de son ame. Le jour où l'on immola cette digne descendante de saint Louis, le bourreau, en lui attachant les mains derrière le dos, releva une des pointes du devant de son fichu. Madame Élisabeth, avec un calme et une voix qui semblait ne pas venir de la terre, lui dit ces mots: "Au nom de la pudeur, couvrez-moi le sein." J'ai appris ce trait héroïque de madame de Sérilly, condamnée le même jour que la princesse, mais qui obtint un sursis au moment de l'exécution, madame de Montmorin, sa parente, ayant déclaré que sa cousine était grosse.

~ MME CAMPAN, *Mémoires*

Le chevalier de Dampierre avait été tué près de la voiture du roi, en sortant de Varennes. Un pauvre curé de village, à quelques lieues de l'endroit où ce crime venait d'être commis, eut l'imprudence de s'approcher pour parler au roi; les cannibales qui environnaient la voiture se jettent sur lui. "Tigres, leur cria Barnave, avez-vous cessé d'être Français? Nation de braves, êtes-vous devenue un peuple d'assassins?" Ces seules paroles sauvèrent d'une mort certaine le curé déjà terrassé. Barnave, en les prononçant, s'était jeté presque hors la portière, et madame Élisabeth, touchée de ce noble élan, le retenait par la basque de son habit.

~ MME CAMPAN, *Mémoires*

Puisque la fortune est si volage et que vous avez vu par vos propres yeux avec quelle rapidité elle abandonne ses favoris, n'oubliez jamais ces deux vers de La Fontaine, et qu'ils vous servent de devise: *Travaillez, prenez de la peine; C'est le fonds qui manque le moins.*

~ MME CAMPAN, *Mémoires*

Voici un trait vraiment touchant qu'on raconte du jeune dauphin que la mort nous a enlevé. Ce prince étant tombé en langoeur de la maladie dont il est mort, avait toujours témoigné beaucoup d'affection à M. de Bourset, son valet de chambre. Il lui demanda un jour des ciseaux; ce gentilhomme lui représenta que cela lui était défendu. L'enfant insista avec douceur, et l'on fut obligé de lui céder. Muni des ciseaux qu'il désirait, il s'en servit pour se couper une boucle de cheveux qu'il enveloppa avec soin dans une feuille de papier: "Tenez, Monsieur, dit-il à son valet de chambre, voilà le seul présent que je puisse vous faire, n'ayant rien à ma disposition; mais quand je serai mort, vous présenterez ce gage à mon papa et à maman; en se souvenant de moi, j'espère qu'ils se souviendront de vous." [Le dauphin avait 7 ans.]

~ MME CAMPAN, *Mémoires*

Louisa's vocation was activity. Such a vocation happily complemented Jonas's taste for inertia.

~ ALBERT CAMUS, *Jonas, or the Artist at Work*

Yet, the very persistence of such misinterpretations [of SR] must have some deep, underlying cause which a historian of ideas can easily identify: the perennial tradition of both Western and Eastern thought which regards time as merely apparent and not genuinely real.

~ M. CAPEK, *The New Aspects of Time*

... the law of gravitation is a generalized law of inertia.

~ M. CAPEK, *The Philosophical Impact of Contemporary Physics*

It frequently happens that within one and the same mind the true grasp of the mathematical side of the theory coexists with serious misapprehensions of its physical and especially its philosophical meaning.

~ M. CAPEK, *The Philosophical Impact of Contemporary Physics*

The intensity of every astonishment gradually wears off; the human mind, by the sheer effect of repetition and habit, gradually becomes accustomed to even the strangest and least familiar ideas.

~ M. CAPEK, *The Philosophical Impact of Contemporary Physics*

This plainly shows that the term “curvature” is essentially metaphorical, for it is based on an analogy with curvature of two-dimensional surfaces.

~ M. CAPEK, *The Philosophical Impact of Contemporary Physics*

What is left of the classical definition of space as “simultaneous juxtaposition of points?” Nothing but a word with misleading connotations.

~ M. CAPEK, *The Philosophical Impact of Contemporary Physics*

Yet the idea of a timeless container, in which all matter is located and in which all motion takes place, has such deep roots in the very structure of human imagination that it is almost impossible to get rid of it.

~ M. CAPEK, *The Philosophical Impact of Contemporary Physics*

Once a means to an end, a way to identify information for deeper study, scanning is becoming an end in itself.

~ NICOLAS CARR, *The Shallows*

The Net is, by design, an interruption system, a machine geared for dividing attention.

~ NICOLAS CARR, *The Shallows*

“How do users read on the Web?”, [Jakob Nielsen] asked them. His succinct answer: “They don’t.”

~ NICOLAS CARR, *The Shallows*

Il y a plus de bonheur dans le désir que dans sa satisfaction.

~ ROCH CARRIER, *Fin*

Le suicide est un manque d'humour absolu.

~ ROCH CARRIER, *Fin*

... I, an islander born, am enclosed in the depths of a barbarian continent where no sea exists.

~ CHARITON, *Callirhoe*

... are you not ashamed to be suffering the heartache of a boy?

~ CHARITON, *Callirhoe*

The heroic Garibaldino sat on the same bench bowing his hoary head, his old soul dwelling alone with its memories, tender and violent, terrible and dreary – solitary on the earth full of men.

~ JOSEPH CONRAD, *Nostromo*

The priest's inquisitional instincts suffered but little from the want of classical apparatus of the Inquisition.

~ JOSEPH CONRAD, *Nostromo*

There is no credulity so eager and blind as the credulity of covetousness, which, in its universal extent, measures the moral misery and the intellectual destitution of mankind.

~ JOSEPH CONRAD, *Nostromo*

He would have amused me if I had wanted to be amused.

~ JOSEPH CONRAD, *The Shadow-Line*

He, as I knew, was not in a state to interest himself in any sublunary matters.

~ JOSEPH CONRAD, *The Shadow-Line*

... the order and magnitude of the stars and all of their orbits and the heaven itself are so connected that in no part can anything be transposed without confusion to the rest and to the whole universe.

~ COPERNICUS, *De Revolutionibus*

... when you grow up these days, you're told you're going to have four or five different careers during your lifetime. But what they don't tell you is that you're also going to be four or five different people along the way.

~ DOUGLAS COUPLAND, *Miss Wyoming*

It appeared that the swift wings of their desires would have shattered against the iron gates of the impossible.

~ STEPHEN CRANE, *The Red Badge of Courage*

"I'm commencin' t' feel pretty bad," said the tattered man, suddenly breaking one of his little silences. "I'm commencin' t' feel pretty damn bad."

~ STEPHEN CRANE, *The Red Badge of Courage*

Enjoyment appears at the boundary between boredom and anxiety, when the challenges are just balanced with the person's capacity to act.

~ MIHALY CSIKSZENTMIHALY, *Flow*

I developed a theory of optimal experience based on the concept of *flow*— the state in which people are so involved in an activity that people will do it even at great cost, for the sheer sake of doing it.

~ MIHALY CSIKSZENTMIHALY, *Flow*

The more a job inherently resembles a game – with variety, appropriate and flexible challenges, clear goals, and immediate feedback – the more enjoyable it will be regardless of the worker's level of development.

~ MIHALY CSIKSZENTMIHALY, *Flow*

listen: there's a hell of a good universe next door; let's go.

~ E. E. CUMMINGS

It is a curious characteristic of our age that cultural influences now seem to flow from the lower social classes upward, rather than from the upper classes downward.

~ THEODORE DALRYMPLE, *Life at the Bottom*

As many [of my patients] have told me, they prefer disaster to boredom.

~ THEODORE DALRYMPLE, *Our Culture, What's Left Of It*

Attention to detail attenuates in an environment of generalized ugliness.

~ THEODORE DALRYMPLE, *Our Culture, What's Left Of It*

One of them [photos of British life during the war] was ever present in my mind when I entered a bomb shelter with my friends: that of two young children, both blind, their sightless eyes turned upward to the sound of the explosions above them, a heart-rending look of incomprehension on their faces.

~ THEODORE DALRYMPLE, *Our Culture, What's Left Of It*

The only permissible judgement in polite society is that no judgement is permissible.

~ THEODORE DALRYMPLE, *Our Culture, What's Left Of It*

When young people want to praise themselves, they describe themselves as “nonjudgemental”. For them, the highest form of morality is amorality.

~ THEODORE DALRYMPLE, *Our Culture, What's Left Of It*

I have also learned to value everything I do in life. I open the fridge: I say thank you. I drink cold water: I say thank you. I am thankful for everything – big things and little things. Gratitude is very important. I am grateful that I have the privilege of being thankful. I was thankful before, but now it's on a different level. [Freed Israeli hostage.]

~ EMILY DAMARI

Heaven calls to you and around you wheels, displaying to you its eternal beauties, and your eye gazes only upon the earth.

~ DANTE

L'amor che mi fa bella.

~ DANTE

Se tu segui tua stella, non puoi fallire a glorioso porto.

~ DANTE

Dr. Duncan's lectures on *Materia Medica* at 8 o'clock on a winter's morning are something fearful to remember.

~ CHARLES DARWIN, *The Life and Letters of Charles Darwin*

My reflection, when I first made myself master of the central idea of the *Origin*, was, "How extremely stupid not to have thought of that!" [T. H. Huxley]

~ CHARLES DARWIN, *The Life and Letters of Charles Darwin*

The sight of a naked savage in his native land is an event which can never be forgotten.

~ CHARLES DARWIN, *The Life and Letters of Charles Darwin*

Certainly, no fact in the long history of the world is so startling as the wide and repeated extermination of its inhabitants.

~ CHARLES DARWIN, *The Voyage of the Beagle*

The eight years [Darwin] spent examining, dissecting, and classifying barnacles led his children to assume that barnacles were part of the ordinary routine of any normal father of a family. One of them, hearing of a neighbour whose mornings were sometimes spent in idleness, asked, "But when does he do his barnacles?"

~ CHARLES DARWIN, *The Voyage of the Beagle*

I have found it an amusing strategy, when asked whether I am an atheist, to point out that the questioner is also an atheist when considering Zeus, Apollo, Amon Ra, Mithras, Baal, Thor, Wotan, the Golden Calf and the Flying Spaghetti Monster. I just go one god further.

~ RICHARD DAWKINS, *The God Delusion*

St. Augustine said it quite openly: 'There is another form of temptation, even more fraught with danger. This is the disease of curiosity.'

~ RICHARD DAWKINS, *The God Delusion*

But genes are denizens of geological time: genes are forever.

~ RICHARD DAWKINS, *The Selfish Gene*

The genes are master programmers, and they are programming for their lives. They are judged according to the success of their progress in coping with all the hazards which life throws at their survival machines, and the judge is the ruthless judge of the court of survival.

~ RICHARD DAWKINS, *The Selfish Gene*

The replicators which survived were the ones which built *survival machines* for themselves to live in.

~ RICHARD DAWKINS, *The Selfish Gene*

They are in you and me; they created us, body and mind; and their preservation is the ultimate rationale for our existence. They have come a long way, those replicators. Now they go by the name of genes, and we are their survival machines.

~ RICHARD DAWKINS, *The Selfish Gene*

The human mind is an iterative processor. It never does anything precisely right the first time. What it does consummately well is to make a slight improvement to a flawed product.

~ TOM DEMARCO, *Structured Analysis and System Specification*

... the independence, security, and social maturity of children in traditional societies impress all visitors who have come to know them.

~ JARED DIAMOND, *The World Until Yesterday*

A recurring theme is that the other Westerners and I are struck by the emotional security, self-confidence, curiosity, and autonomy of members of small-scale societies, not only as adults but already as children.

~ JARED DIAMOND, *The World Until Yesterday*

Among those 20 New Guineans, the smallest number of languages that anyone spoke was 5. Several men spoke from 8 to 12 languages, and the champion was a man who spoke 16.

~ JARED DIAMOND, *The World Until Yesterday*

As a result, food is a major and almost constant subject of conversation. The significance of sex and food is reversed between the Siriono and us Westerners; the Siriono's strongest anxieties are about food, they have sex virtually whenever they want, and sex compensates for food hunger, while our strongest anxieties are about sex, we have food virtually whenever we want, and eating compensates for sexual frustration.

~ JARED DIAMOND, *The World Until Yesterday*

Ever since my first trip to New Guinea, I have been impressed by how much more time New Guineans spend talking with each other than do we Americans and Europeans. Talking is the main form of entertainment in New Guinea.

~ JARED DIAMOND, *The World Until Yesterday*

First contact with previously uncontacted tribal peoples is terrifying. Neither side knows what the other side wants or will do.

~ JARED DIAMOND, *The World Until Yesterday*

For instance, no one in the densely populated mountain valleys of the main body of New Guinea had seen or even heard of the ocean, lying at a distance of only 50 to 120 miles.

~ JARED DIAMOND, *The World Until Yesterday*

In 1931 no New Guinean born in Goroka had ever visited Wapenamanda a mere 107 miles to the west; the idea of traveling from Goroka to Wapenamanda, without being killed by an unknown stranger within the first 10 miles from Goroka, would have been unthinkable.

~ JARED DIAMOND, *The World Until Yesterday*

“People are basically the same everywhere.” No, I eventually came to realize, in many basic ways we are not all the same.

~ JARED DIAMOND, *The World Until Yesterday*

... our intellectual powers are rather geared to master static relations and that our powers to visualize processes evolving in time are relatively poorly developed.

~ EDSGER W. DIJKSTRA, *Goto Statement Considered Harmful*

Perhaps the most saddening thing now is that, even after all those years of frustrating experience, still so many people honestly believe that some law of nature tells us that machines have to be that way. They silence their doubts by observing how many of these machines have been sold, and derive from that observation the false sense of security that, after all, the design cannot have been that bad. But upon closer inspection, that line of defense has the same convincing strength as the argument that cigarette smoking must be healthy because so many people do it.

~ EDSGER W. DIJKSTRA, *The Humble Programmer*

We should recognise the closed subroutine as one of the greatest software inventions; it has survived three generations of computers, and it will survive a few more, because it caters for the implementation of one of our basic patterns of abstraction.

~ EDSGER W. DIJKSTRA, *The Humble Programmer*

- Everyone deserves an umbrella.
- In one little phrase you’ve defined the minimum of human rights.

~ FYODOR DOSTOYEVSKY, *Devils*

In the present instance, however, [the governor] didn’t fight, and although he didn’t refrain from using very strong language as he climbed out of his carriage, he did so merely to retain his popularity.

~ FYODOR DOSTOYEVSKY, *Devils*

Oh, you abstract, useless windbag.

~ FYODOR DOSTOYEVSKY, *Devils*

What is habit not capable of?

~ FYODOR DOSTOYEVSKY, *Devils*

And all because I was so confoundedly bored, gentlemen, all because I was so horribly bored. Crushed by doing nothing.

~ FYODOR DOSTOYEVSKY, *Notes From the Underground*

I envy such a man with all the forces of my embittered heart.

~ FYODOR DOSTOYEVSKY, *Notes From the Underground*

Is it not possible that man loves something besides prosperity? Perhaps he is just as fond of suffering? Whether it is good or bad, it is sometimes very pleasant to smash things too.

~ FYODOR DOSTOYEVSKY, *Notes From the Underground*

Let us suppose, gentlemen, that man is not stupid. But if he is not stupid, he is monstrously ungrateful. Phenomenally ungrateful. I'm even inclined to believe that the best definition of man is – a creature who walks on two legs and is ungrateful.

~ FYODOR DOSTOYEVSKY, *Notes From the Underground*

Question – who is he? Answer – a loafer. I must say it would have been a real pleasure to have heard that said about myself, for it would have meant that a positive definition had been found for me and that there was something one could say about me. “A loafer!” – why, it's a title, a purpose in life. It's a career, gentlemen, a career!

~ FYODOR DOSTOYEVSKY, *Notes From the Underground*

What is an insult but a sort of purification?

~ FYODOR DOSTOYEVSKY, *Notes From the Underground*

For, after all, you do grow up, you do outgrow your ideals, which turn to dust and ashes, which are shattered into fragments; and if you have no other life, you just have to build one up out of these fragments. And all the time your soul is craving and longing for something else. And in vain does the dreamer rummage about in his old dreams, raking them over as though they were a heap of cinders, looking in these cinders for some spark, however tiny, to fan it into a flame so as to warm his chilled blood by it and revive in it all that he held so dear before, all that touched his heart, that made his blood course through his veins, that drew tears from his eyes, and that so splendidly deceived him!

~ FYODOR DOSTOYEVSKY, *White Knights*

Good Lord, only *amomentof* bliss? Isn't such a moment sufficient for the whole of a man's life?

~ FYODOR DOSTOYEVSKY, *White Knights*

P.A.M. Dirac is said to have usually opened his course in quantum mechanics with the remark: "The existence of an external world is assumed. That is all the metaphysics you will need for this course."

~ STILLMAN DRAKE, *Galileo: Pioneer Scientist*

I sit with Shakespeare and he winces not. Across the color-line I move arm in arm with Balzac and Dumas, where smiling men and welcoming women glide in gilded halls. From out the caves of the evening that swing between the strong-limbed earth and the tracery of the stars, I summon Aristotle and Aurelius, and they come all graciously with no scorn nor condescension.

~ W. E. B. DUBOIS

Allons nous faire tuer où l'on nous dit d'aller. La vie vaut-elle la peine de faire autant de questions?

~ ALEXANDRE DUMAS, *Les trois mousquetaires*

An Englishman in Paris in 1791 reported that "clubs abound in every street." There were literary societies, sporting associations, Freemason lodges, workmen's gatherings.

~ WILL AND ARIEL DURANT, *The Age of Napoleon*

Coleridge, about 1798, complained convincingly: "I am pestered every ball night to dance, which very *modestly* I refuse. They dance a most infamous dance called the Waltzen. There are perhaps twenty couples – the Man and his Partner embrace each other, arms and waists, knees almost touching, and then whirl round and round, to lascivious music."

~ WILL AND ARIEL DURANT, *The Age of Napoleon*

Napoleon: "The women are everywhere – at plays, on public walks, in libraries. You see very pretty women in the scholar's study room. Only here [in Paris], of all the places on Earth, do women deserve such influence, and indeed the men are mad about them, think of nothing else, and live only through and for them. A woman, in order to know what is due her, and what power she has, must live in Paris for six months."

~ WILL AND ARIEL DURANT, *The Age of Napoleon*

The "Fourth Estate" – the journalists and the press – may have been more influential than the schools in forming the mind and mood of France in those effervescent years.

~ WILL AND ARIEL DURANT, *The Age of Napoleon*

The *Vindication* [Wollstonecraft] proceeded to list some feminine faults of that time: the admiration of weakness and timidity, which feeds and pleases the male's assumption of superiority; the addiction to cards, gossip, astrology, sentimentality, and literary trash; the absorption in dress and self-admiration.

~ WILL AND ARIEL DURANT, *The Age of Napoleon*

[In England] until 1929 the legal age of marriage was fourteen for the male, twelve for the female.

~ WILL AND ARIEL DURANT, *The Age of Napoleon*

"The old nobility," said Napoleon, "would have survived if it had known enough to become master of printing materials. The advent of cannon killed the feudal system; ink will kill the modern system."

~ WILL AND ARIEL DURANT, *The Age of Napoleon*

Clear thought and clear expression seem divine things to the Athenian; he has no patience with learned obfuscation.

~ WILL DURANT, *The Life of Greece*

In this way the Greece that defeated the King of Kings turns upon itself, Greek meets Greek in a thousand battles, and in the course of a century after Marathon the most brilliant civilization in history consumes itself in a prolonged national suicide.

~ WILL DURANT, *The Life of Greece*

The letter of the law forbids him to remain single, but the law is not always enforced in Periclean days; and after him the number of bachelors mounts until it becomes one of the basic problems of Athens. There are so many ways of being amused in Greece! Those men who yield marry late, usually near thirty, and then insist upon brides not much older than fifteen.

~ WILL DURANT, *The Life of Greece*

Pour l'heure, je devais reprendre le train, continuer à pédaler sur les quais du port, rêver du New York au bord de la mer, fumer des cigarettes au bistrot en parlant d'amour et d'anarchie.

~ BENOÎT DUTEURTRE, *Le voyage en France*

Well I'm living in a foreign country,
But I'm bound to cross the line.
Beauty walks a razor's edge,
Some day I'll make it mine.

~ BOB DYLAN, *Shelter From The Storm*

The ghost of 'lectricity howls in the bones of her face.

~ BOB DYLAN, *Visions of Johanna*

I must let virtue go if I would see God face to face.

~ MEISTER ECKHART

Man's best chance of finding God is where he left him.

~ MEISTER ECKHART

One person who has mastered life is better than a thousand persons who have mastered only the contents of books.

~ MEISTER ECKHART

The just are they that take everything alike from God no matter what it is, big and little, good and bad, all the same, no more no less, but one thing like another.

~ MEISTER ECKHART

The soul is motionless when nothing whatever can perturb her, when she is neither glad nor sad and cannot be gladdened nor yet saddened, and when she has no need to cling to any creature.

~ MEISTER ECKHART

Turning and change lead nowhere; stopping, we progress.

~ MEISTER ECKHART

Harold Transome was neither the dissolute cosmopolitan so vigorously sketched by the *Tory Herald*, nor the intellectual giant and moral lobster suggested by the liberal imagination of the *Watchman*.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Felix Holt, the Radical*

Harold preferred a slow-witted large-eyed woman, silent and affectionate, with a load of black hair weighing much more heavily than her brains.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Felix Holt, the Radical*

It is not true that love makes all things easy: it makes us choose what is difficult.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Felix Holt, the Radical*

Mr. Jermyn's establishment was broken up, and he was understood to have gone to reside at a great distance: some said "abroad", that large home of ruined reputations.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Felix Holt, the Radical*

No system, religious or political, I believe, has laid it down as a principle that all men are alike virtuous, or even that all the people rated for £80 houses are an honour to their species.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Felix Holt, the Radical*

Explain my preference! I never had a *preference* for her, any more than I have a preference for breathing.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Middlemarch*

Far off in the bending sky was the pearly light; and she felt the largeness of the world and the manifold wakings of men to labour and endurance.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Middlemarch*

Mr. Casaubon ... concluded that the poets had much exaggerated the force of masculine passion.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Middlemarch*

Only a few children in Middlemarch looked blonde by the side of Rosamond, and the slim figure displayed by her riding-habit had delicate undulations.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Middlemarch*

Plain women he regarded as he did the other severe facts of life, to be faced with philosophy and investigated by science.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Middlemarch*

Sane people did what their neighbours did, so that if any lunatics were at large, one might know and avoid them.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Middlemarch*

The best piety is to enjoy – when you can. You are doing the most then to save the earth's character as an agreeable planet.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Middlemarch*

The iron had not entered his soul, but he had begun to imagine what the sharp edge would be.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Middlemarch*

The remark was taken up by Mr. Chichely, a middle-aged bachelor and courting celebrity, who had a complexion something like an Easter egg, a few hairs carefully arranged, and a carriage implying the consciousness of a distinguished appearance.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Middlemarch*

There was a table spread with the best cold eatables, as at a superior funeral.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Middlemarch*

"Now aunt," he went on, rubbing his hands and looking at Miss Noble, who was making tender little beaver-like noises.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Middlemarch*

You already suspect that the Vicar did not shine in the more spiritual functions of his office; and indeed, the utmost I can say for him in this respect is, that he performed those functions with undeviating attention to brevity and despatch.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Mr. Gilfil's Love-Story*

... there was no pleasant morning greeting between them; not because of any unfriendliness, but because the sweet flower of courtesy is not a growth of such homes as the Red House.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Silas Marner*

Moreover, he bore a swarthy foreignness of complexion which boded little honesty.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *Silas Marner*

... for in bucolic society five-and-twenty years ago, the human animal of the male sex was understood to be perpetually athirst, and “something to drink” was as necessary a condition of thought as Time and Space.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *The Sad Fortunes of the Reverend Amos Barton*

Every man who is not a monster, a mathematician, or a mad philosopher, is the slave of some woman or other.

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *The Sad Fortunes of the Reverend Amos Barton*

The snow lay thick upon the graves ...

~ GEORGE ELIOT, *The Sad Fortunes of the Reverend Amos Barton*

... we prefer to practise and rehearse anything rather than how to be untrammelled and free.

~ EPICTETUS

Although life is a matter of indifference, the use which you make of it is not a matter of indifference.

~ EPICTETUS

And I am not saying that it is not permissible to groan, only do not groan in the centre of your being.

~ EPICTETUS

And if you meet anything that is laborious, or sweet, or held in high repute, or in no repute, remember that *now* is the contest, and here before you are the Olympic games, and that it is impossible to delay any longer, and that it depends on a single day and a single action, whether progress is lost or saved.

~ EPICTETUS

For the origin of sorrow is this – to wish for something that does not come to pass.

~ EPICTETUS

Socrates never got wrought up during an argument, never used any term of abuse or insolence, but endured the abuse of others, and put an end to strife.

~ EPICTETUS

“When, then, shall I see Athens once more and the Acropolis?” Poor man, are you not satisfied with what you are seeing every day? Have you anything finer or greater to look at than the sun, the moon, the stars, the whole Earth, the sea? And if you really understand Him that governs the Universe, and bear Him about within you, do you yet yearn for bits of stone and a pretty rock?

~ EPICTETUS

Meglio avere come amico una persona che non è di casa ma si identifica con i tuoi modi di essere, piuttosto che mille parenti stretti.

~ EURIPIDE

For instance, many peoples are convinced that deaths are caused by witchcraft. To speak of witchcraft being for these peoples a supernatural agency hardly reflects their own view of the matter, since from their point of view nothing could be more natural.

~ E. E. EVANS-PRITCHARD, *Theories of Primitive Religion*

... to tell you, Madam, that I am a man unblemished in my honour, have nobly served my king and country; and for a lady's service, I think that nature has not been defective.

~ GEORGE FARQUAR, *Sir Harry Wildair*

Madame, I have tought dat Fortune be one blind bitch.

~ GEORGE FARQUAR, *Sir Harry Wildair*

Some time ago he had got the travelling maggot in his head.

~ GEORGE FARQUAR, *Sir Harry Wildair*

La vita è un giusto miscuglio di dolori e di gioie.

~ FEDRO

... Shem did nothing but eat and work and sleep. He thought of nothing else but these three things and was devoid of wonder.

~ TIMOTHY FINDLAY

The reasons for sorcery are mainly those of economics or of personal status; desire for land; wish to punish for theft of food; jealousy of competitive achievement; resentment at a personal affront.

~ RAYMOND FIRTH, *Tikopia Ritual and Belief*

I think he'd tanked up a good deal at luncheon and his determination to have my company bordered on violence.

~ F. SCOTT FITZGERALD, *The Great Gatsby*

When the melody rose her voice broke up sweetly, following it, in a way contralto voices have, and each change tipped out a little of her warm human magic upon the air.

~ F. SCOTT FITZGERALD, *The Great Gatsby*

"Can't repeat the past?" he cried incredulously. "Why of course you can!"

~ F. SCOTT FITZGERALD, *The Great Gatsby*

"Her voice is full of money," he said suddenly.

~ F. SCOTT FITZGERALD, *The Great Gatsby*

Ciò che cerchiamo o è qui o in nessun luogo.

~ QUINTO ORAZIO FLACCO

Writers who know nothing of the true poetry of modern science have supposed that the perception of the sublime is born of ignorance, and that to admire, it is necessary not to know. This is assuredly a strange error.

~ FLAMMARION AND GORE, *Popular Astronomy*

... I had written myself into a state, and it was immensely enjoyable ... a state of the soul so far above ordinary life, a state in which fame counts for nothing, and even happiness is irrelevant.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT

... the humiliations that adjectives inflict on me, the cruel ravages of the relative pronoun.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT

Do not put your portrait at the beginning of your book. Leave that little trick to the scribblers. The artist *ought not to exist*.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT

I have been attacked by the government, by the priests and by the newspapers. My triumph is complete.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT

I'm like a piece of wood, which I don't mind in the least. Passion, excitement being what I dread, I think that if happiness is to be found anywhere it's in stagnation.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT

J'ai entrevue quelquefois (dans mes grands jours de soleil) un état de l'âme ainsi supérieur à la vie, pour qui la gloire ne serait rien, et le bonheur même inutile.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT

May I die like a dog rather than try to rush through even one sentence before it is perfectly ripe.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT

Si robuste que l'on soit, on se sent comme broyé par la sottise universelle.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT

To be stupid, and selfish, and to have good health are the three requirements for happiness; though if stupidity is lacking, the others are useless.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT

Je ne sais pas si vous avez du talent. Ce que vous m'avez apporté prouve une certaine intelligence, mais n'oubliez point ceci, jeune homme, que le talent – suivant le mot de Buffon – n'est qu'une longue patience. Travaillez.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Lettre à Guy de Maupassant*

... il accompagnait une femme d'une cinquantaine d'années, laide, magnifiquement vêtue, et d'un rang social problématique.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *L'éducation sentimentale*

Après avoir passé successivement par la demi-tasse, le grog, le bischof, le vin chaud et même l'eau rougie, il était revenu à la bière; et, de demi-heure en demi-heure, laissait tomber ce mot : «Bock!», ayant réduit son langage à l'indispensable.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *L'éducation sentimentale*

Des années passèrent; et il supportait le désœuvrement de son intelligence et l'inertie de son cœur.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *L'éducation sentimentale*

Il trouvait que le bonheur mérité par l'excellence de son âme tardait à venir.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *L'éducation sentimentale*

Les coeurs des femmes sont comme ces petits meubles à secret, pleins de tiroirs emboîtés les uns dans les autres; on se donne du mal, on se casse les ongles, et on trouve au fond quelque fleur desséchée, des brins de poussière ou le vide!

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *L'éducation sentimentale*

... chaque notaire porte en soi les débris d'un poète.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Madame Bovary*

Emma ressemblait à toutes les maîtresses; et le charme de la nouveauté, peu à peu tombant comme un vêtement, laissait voir à nu l'éternelle monotonie de la passion, qui a toujours les mêmes formes et le même langage.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Madame Bovary*

Quel bonheur dans ce temps-là! quelle liberté! quel espoir! quelle abondance d'illusions!

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Madame Bovary*

À la ville, avec le bruit des rues, le bourdonnement des théâtres et les clartés du bal, elles avaient des existences où le coeur se dilate, où les sens s'épanouissent. Mais elle, sa vie était froide comme un grenier dont la lucarne est au nord, et l'ennui, araignée silencieuse, filait sa toile dans l'ombre à tous les coins de son coeur.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Madame Bovary*

Il ne faut pas demander des oranges aux pommiers, du soleil à la France, de l'amour à la femme, du bonheur à la vie.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Pensées*

Il n'y a pour moi dans le monde que les beaux vers, les phrases bien tournées, harmonieuses, chantantes, les beaux couchers de soleil, les clairs de lune, les tableaux colorés, les marbres antiques et les têtes accentuées. Au delà, rien.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Pensées*

La masse, le nombre est toujours idiot. Je n'ai pas beaucoup de convictions, mais j'ai celle-là fortement.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Pensées*

La médiocrité chérit la règle, moi je la hais.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Pensées*

La rage de vouloir conclure est une des manies les plus funestes et les plus stériles qui appartiennent à l'humanité. Chaque religion et chaque philosophie a prétendu avoir Dieu à elle, toiser l'infini et connaître la recette du bonheur. Quel orgueil et quel néant! Je vois, au contraire, que les plus grands génies et les plus grandes oeuvres n'ont jamais conclu. Homère, Shakespeare, Goethe, tous les fils aînés de Dieu (comme dit Michelet) se sont bien gardés de faire autre chose que représenter.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Pensées*

Le bonheur est une monstruosité! punis sont ceux qui le cherchent.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Pensées*

Le mépris de la gloriole et du gain est la première marche pour atteindre le Beau.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Pensées*

Le succès est une conséquence et ne doit pas être un but.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Pensées*

L'artiste doit être dans son oeuvre comme Dieu dans la création, invisible et tout-puissant, qu'on le sente partout, mais qu'on ne le voie pas.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Pensées*

S'écarter des journaux! la haine de ces boutiques-là est le commencement de l'amour du Beau.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Pensées*

Tout est là: l'amour de l'Art.

~ GUSTAVE FLAUBERT, *Pensées*

This is extraordinary; but, come, unbosom yourself with freedom, and let us know the person to whom you have thus engaged yesterday.

~ SAMUEL FOOTE, *The Comic Theatre*

What a bewitching eye she has! and then, such a shape! Odso, I believe this baggage will turn my brain.

~ SAMUEL FOOTE, *The Comic Theatre*

What surprise! – what joy! – what confusion! – Support me, Subtle! I am unable to bear this conflict of tumultuous passions!

~ SAMUEL FOOTE, *The Comic Theatre*

Other Kingdom copse is just like any other beech copse, and I am therefore spared the fatigue of describing it.

~ E. M. FORSTER, *Other Kingdom*

That evening, for the first time, I heard the chalk downs singing to each other across the valleys, as they often do when the air is quiet and they have had a comfortable day.

~ E. M. FORSTER, *The Curate's Friend*

Amis, mangeons et buvons joyeusement
Tant qu'il y a de l'huile dans la lampe:
Qui sait si dans l'autre monde nous nous reverrons?
Qui sait si dans l'autre monde il y a une taverne?

~ ANATOLE FRANCE, *Le crime de Sylvestre Bonnard*

Mais Thérèse est sourde comme un sac de charbon et lente comme la justice.

~ ANATOLE FRANCE, *Le crime de Sylvestre Bonnard*

Nos passions, c'est nous.

~ ANATOLE FRANCE, *Le crime de Sylvestre Bonnard*

Nous sommes d'éternels enfants et nous courons sans cesse après des jouets nouveaux.

~ ANATOLE FRANCE, *Le crime de Sylvestre Bonnard*

Qui vit peu change peu.

~ ANATOLE FRANCE, *Le crime de Sylvestre Bonnard*

For the essence of bullshit is not that it is *false* but that it is *phony*.

~ HARRY FRANKFURT, *On Bullshit*

Her statement is not germane to the enterprise of describing reality.

~ HARRY FRANKFURT, *On Bullshit*

In the old days, craftsmen did not cut corners. They worked carefully, and they took care with every aspect of their work. Every part of the product was considered, and each was designed and made to be exactly as it should be. These craftsmen did not relax their thoughtful self-discipline even with respect to features of their work that would ordinarily not be visible. Although no one would notice if those features were not quite right, the craftsmen would be bothered by their consciences. So nothing was swept under the rug. Or, one might perhaps also say, there was no bullshit.

~ HARRY FRANKFURT, *On Bullshit*

It is impossible for someone to lie unless he thinks he knows the truth. Producing bullshit requires no such conviction.

~ HARRY FRANKFURT, *On Bullshit*

It is just his lack of connection with a concern with truth – this indifference to how things really are – that I regard as the essence of bullshit.

~ HARRY FRANKFURT, *On Bullshit*

One of the most salient features of our culture is that there is so much bullshit. Everyone knows this. Each of us contributes his share. But we tend to take the situation for granted.

~ HARRY FRANKFURT, *On Bullshit*

The problem of understanding why our attitude toward bullshit is generally more benign than our attitude toward lying is an important one, which I shall leave as an exercise for the reader.

~ HARRY FRANKFURT, *On Bullshit*

[The bullshitter] does not reject the authority of the truth, as the liar does, and oppose himself to it. He pays no attention to it at all. By virtue of this, bullshit is a greater enemy of the truth than lies are.

~ HARRY FRANKFURT, *On Bullshit*

... may we not reasonably conjecture that just as on the material side of human culture there has everywhere been an Age of Stone, so on the intellectual side there has everywhere been an Age of Magic?

~ J. G. FRAZER, *The Golden Bough*

This universal faith, this truly Catholic creed, is a belief in the efficacy of magic. While religious systems differ not only in different countries, but in the same country in different ages, the system of sympathetic magic remains everywhere and at all times substantially alike in its principles and practice.

~ J. G. FRAZER, *The Golden Bough*

Whatever doubts science may entertain as to the possibility of action at a distance, magic has none.

~ J. G. FRAZER, *The Golden Bough*

Toute la question est là: trouver ce qui convient à sa nature et ne copier le bonheur de personne.

~ EUGÈNE FROMENTIN, *Dominique*

A big library really has the gift of tongues and vast potencies of telepathic communication.

~ NORTHROP FRYE

Philosophy is written in this grand book of the universe, which stands continually open to our gaze. But the book cannot be understood unless one first learns to comprehend the language in which it is composed. *It is written in the language of mathematics.*

~ GALILEO

Deep down, I'm pretty superficial.

~ AVA GARDNER

On a pu constater que la reprise des erreurs était si fréquente que le phénomène de répétition crée une forme apparente de vérité, pernicieuse et tenace.

~ FRANÇOIS GARNIER, *L'âne à la lyre*

The enchanting charms of this sublime science reveal themselves only to those who have the courage to go deeply into it. But when a woman, who because of her sex and our prejudices encounters infinitely more obstacles than a man in familiarizing herself with complicated problems, succeeds nevertheless in surmounting these obstacles and penetrating the most obscure parts of them, without doubt she must have the noblest courage, quite extraordinary talents and superior genius.

~ GAUSS, *Letter to Sophie Germain (1807)*

... the severity of the [Church] fathers, who despised all knowledge that was not useful to salvation, and who considered all levity of discourse as a criminal abuse of the gift of speech.

~ EDWARD GIBBON, *Decline and Fall of the Roman Empire*

But it is always easy, as well as agreeable, for the inferior ranks of mankind to claim a merit from the contempt of that pomp and pleasure which fortune has placed beyond their reach.

~ EDWARD GIBBON, *Decline and Fall of the Roman Empire*

Carus, taking off a cap which he wore to conceal his baldness, assured the ambassadors that, unless their master acknowledged the superiority of Rome, he would speedily render Persia as naked of trees as his own head was destitute of hair.

~ EDWARD GIBBON, *Decline and Fall of the Roman Empire*

Confiscation, exile, or simple death, were esteemed uncommon instances of his lenity.

~ EDWARD GIBBON, *Decline and Fall of the Roman Empire*

His manners were less pure, but his character was equally amiable with that of his father. Twenty-two acknowledged concubines, and a library of sixty-two thousand volumes, attested the variety of his inclinations; and from the productions which he left behind him, it appears that the former as well as the latter were designed for use rather than for ostentation.

~ EDWARD GIBBON, *Decline and Fall of the Roman Empire*

Of the various forms of government which have prevailed in the world, an hereditary monarchy seems to present the fairest scope for ridicule.

~ EDWARD GIBBON, *Decline and Fall of the Roman Empire*

The peace of the Eastern church was invaded by a swarm of fanatics, incapable of fear, or reason, or humanity; and the Imperial troops acknowledged, without shame, that they were much less apprehensive of an encounter with the fiercest barbarians.

~ EDWARD GIBBON, *Decline and Fall of the Roman Empire*

One of the principal objects of theoretical research is to find the point of view from which the subject appears in the greatest simplicity.

~ JOSIAH W. GIBBS

At last we end by saying that He – the Unfindable – is everywhere, anywhere, and kneel down at haphazard.

~ ANDRÉ GIDE, *Les nourritures terrestres*

Books had taught me that every liberty is provisional and never anything but the power to choose one's slavery.

~ ANDRÉ GIDE, *Les nourritures terrestres*

Everything is prepared for the organization of joy.

~ ANDRÉ GIDE, *Les nourritures terrestres*

From the day that I succeeded in persuading myself that I had no need to be happy, happiness began to dwell in me.

~ ANDRÉ GIDE, *Les nourritures terrestres*

Mere being became an immense delight to me.

~ ANDRÉ GIDE, *Les nourritures terrestres*

There were days when simply repeating to myself that two and two still made four was enough to fill me with positive beatitude, and other days when it was completely indifferent to me.

~ ANDRÉ GIDE, *Les nourritures terrestres*

A babord le néant, à tribord l'oubli ...

~ JEAN GIRADOUX, *Ondine*

Plus on souffre, plus on est heureux.

~ JEAN GIRADOUX, *Ondine*

A great mass of evidence, theoretical, textual, and archeological, suggests that in the beginnings of humanity the sacrificial victims were human.

~ RÉNÉ GIRARD, *I See Satan Fall Like Lightning*

Human communities constantly resort to sacrifice to ease their distress.

~ RÉNÉ GIRARD, *I See Satan Fall Like Lightning*

In short, a paradox occurs: the antagonists resemble one another more and more. They have ears only for the deceptive celebration of differences, which rages more than ever in our societies, not because real differences are increasing but because they are disappearing.

~ RÉNÉ GIRARD, *I See Satan Fall Like Lightning*

The peoples of the world do not invent their gods. They deify their victims.

~ RÉNÉ GIRARD, *I See Satan Fall Like Lightning*

The principle source of violence between human beings is mimetic rivalry, the rivalry resulting from imitation of a [role] model.

~ RÉNÉ GIRARD, *I See Satan Fall Like Lightning*

The synoptic gospels use *satan/satanas* and *diabolos* interchangeably and with equal frequency. Both words refer to one who accuses, slanders, denounces, and seduces.

~ RÉNÉ GIRARD, *I See Satan Fall Like Lightning*

Unanimity in human groups is rarely a vehicle of truth; more often it is nothing but a mimetic, tyrannical phenomena. It resembles elections in totalitarian countries.

~ RÉNÉ GIRARD, *I See Satan Fall Like Lightning*

They do not know what they are doing. In this passage [from the Passion] we are given the first definition of the unconscious in human history.

~ RÉNÉ GIRARD, *The Scapegoat*

... I intend to show that all myths must have their roots in real acts of real violence against real victims.

~ RÉNÉ GIRARD, *The Scapegoat*

... the Gospels reveal the scapegoat mechanism everywhere, even within us.

~ RÉNÉ GIRARD, *The Scapegoat*

Once mobilized, the crowd has absolute power, dragging institutions with it until they are forced to disintegrate.

~ RÉNÉ GIRARD, *The Scapegoat*

The causality of magic is one with mythology, so the importance of its denial cannot be exaggerated.

~ RÉNÉ GIRARD, *The Scapegoat*

The constituted authorities give in to [the mob] and yield up the victims demanded by their caprice, just as Pilate gave up Jesus or Herod John the Baptist.

~ RÉNÉ GIRARD, *The Scapegoat*

Although mathematics is clearly of huge importance in the development of physics, one of the greatest achievements in all of science – Darwin's achievement in *On the Origin of Species* – makes no real use of mathematics.

~ PETER GODFREY-SMITH, *Theory and Reality*

And crucially, for Popper it is never possible to confirm or establish a theory by showing its agreement with observations. *Confirmation is a myth.* The only thing that an observational test can do is to show that a theory is false.

~ PETER GODFREY-SMITH, *Theory and Reality*

For Popper, an inspiring example of genuine science was the work of Einstein. Examples of pseudo-science were Freudian psychology and Marxist views about society and history.

~ PETER GODFREY-SMITH, *Theory and Reality*

The humanities had gone to hell, and now they were trying to wreck science as well, via endless relativist bleating that science is “just another approach to knowledge with no special status.”

~ PETER GODFREY-SMITH, *Theory and Reality*

“Death to the Jews” has been our war cry for fourteen years. Let them die.

~ JOSEPH GOEBBELS

A law against hating Jews is usually the beginning of the end for Jews.

~ JOSEPH GOEBBELS, *Diary*

A dose of that within your guts my boy,
and every other wench is Helen of Troy.

~ GOETHE, *Faust*

And feel, in what that one look brings,
a beggar with the wealth of kings.

~ GOETHE, *Faust*

Two souls, alas, are housed within my breast,
and each will wrestle for the mastery there.

~ GOETHE, *Faust*

I cannot help it that my pictures do not sell. Nevertheless, the time will come when people will see that they are worth more than the price of the paint.

~ VINCENT VAN GOGH

He was never held captive by the beauties, however, never was their slave or even a very assiduous admirer, if only because intimacy with a woman involves a lot of exertion.

~ I. A. GONCHAROV, *Oblomov*

Lying down was not for Ilya Ilyitch either a necessity as it is for a sick or a sleepy man, or an occasional need as it is for a person who is tired, or a pleasure as it is for a sluggard: it was his normal state.

~ I. A. GONCHAROV, *Oblomov*

Masha came to ask him if he would like to go and see the river freezing: everyone was going.

~ I. A. GONCHAROV, *Oblomov*

Their sensitive minds were never tired of this beauty: the earth, the sky, the sea – all roused their feelings, and they sat side by side in silence, looking with one heart at the glory of creation.

~ I. A. GONCHAROV, *Oblomov*

Pendant des mois, elle resta insensible à tout; pendant des mois, envahie et remplie tout entière par la pensée du petit être qui n'était plus, elle porta dans ses entrailles la mort de son enfant comme elle avait porté sa vie.

~ EDMOND ET JULES DE GONCOURT, *Germinie Lacerteux*

That great force, Fashion, which in Paris affects everything, even a priest's cassock, had taken him up and launched him. People came to him from all parts. The ordinary, commonplace confessions were heard by other priests, but all the choice sins were brought to him.

~ EDMOND ET JULES DE GONCOURT, *Renée Mauperin*

Why, yes, I should like to be rich just to show the contempt I have for money.

~ EDMOND ET JULES DE GONCOURT, *Renée Mauperin*

The purpose of art is the lifelong creation of a state of wonder.

~ GLENN GOULD

... set theory and topology were extraordinarily late arrivals on the mathematical scene.

~ I. GRATTAN-GUINESS, *Norton History of the Mathematical Sciences*

In addition, the teaching of theories from axioms, or some close imitation of them such as the basic laws of algebra, is usually an educational disaster; for whatever the gains in rigour, they are achieved at the expense of a heavy loss of heuristic understanding and intuitive reasoning – the very things that lie at the heart of real educational theory.

~ I. GRATTAN-GUINESS, *Norton History of the Mathematical Sciences*

Mathematics is rich, even dense, with interconnections, but it exhibits no unity.

~ I. GRATTAN-GUINESS, *Norton History of the Mathematical Sciences*

Neither Newton nor Leibniz married, nor did they seem to be “interested”.

~ I. GRATTAN-GUINESS, *Norton History of the Mathematical Sciences*

But it has never been clearer that there is only one place to lay the blame [for 9/11] and it has ever been thus. The cause of all this misery, mayhem, violence, terror and ignorance is of course religion itself, and if it seems ludicrous to have to state such an obvious reality, the fact is that the government and the media are doing a pretty good job of pretending that it isn't so.

~ MURIEL GRAY

[Having venture capitalists run your company] was like watching a kindergarten class get into a Boeing 747 and flip all the switches and try to figure out why it didn't take off.

~ PHILIP GREENSPAN

In any library in the world, I am at home, unselfconscious, still, and absorbed.

~ GERMAINE GREER

It is in this gesture of “going beyond”, to be something in oneself rather than the pawn of a consensus, the refusal to stay within a rigid circle that others have drawn around one – it is in this solitary act that one finds true creativity. All other things follow as a matter of course.

~ ALEXANDER GROTHENDIECK, *Récoltes et semailles*

When the Spanish discovered [the Aztecs] in the sixteenth century, they were sacrificing for religious reasons some 10,000 – 50,000 human victims each year.

~ JOHN GUNN, *Violence in Human Society*

There is no clear line. The whole thing works by being a bit opaque, cloudy, misty, and unclear. We think that the world is divided quite clearly; there is fiction and there is reality; but usually they just get mixed together.

~ YUVAL HARARI

... witnesses in courts put their hand on a bible when swearing to tell the truth, the whole truth, and nothing but the truth. It's ironic that they swear to tell the truth on a book brimming with so many fictions, myths, and errors.

~ YUVAL HARARI, *Homo Deus*

Stories serve as the foundations and pillars of human societies. As history unfolded, stories about gods, nations, and corporations grew so powerful that they began to dominate objective reality.

~ YUVAL HARARI, *Homo Deus*

The greatest scientific discovery was the discovery of ignorance.

~ YUVAL HARARI, *Homo Deus*

This obstacle was finally removed about 5,000 years ago, when the Sumerians invented both writing and money. These Siamese twins – born to the same parents at the same time and in the same place – broke the data-processing limitations of the human brain.

~ YUVAL HARARI, *Homo Deus*

We see that the self too is an imaginary story, just like nations, gods and money. Each of us has a sophisticated system that throws away most of our experiences, keeps only a few choice samples, and out of all that jumble it weaves a seemingly coherent story about who I am, where I came from and where I am going.

~ YUVAL HARARI, *Homo Deus*

Writing thus facilitated the appearance of powerful fictional entities.

~ YUVAL HARARI, *Homo Deus*

According to the French legislators, if a certified lawyer followed all the proper liturgy and rituals, wrote all the required spells and oaths on a wonderfully decorated piece of paper, and affixed his ornate signature to the bottom of the document, then hocus pocus – a new company was incorporated.

~ YUVAL HARARI, *Sapiens*

How did *Homo sapiens* manage to cross this critical threshold, eventually founding cities comprising tens of thousands of inhabitants, and empires ruling hundreds of millions? The secret was probably the appearance of fiction. Large numbers of strangers can cooperate successfully by believing in common myths.

~ YUVAL HARARI, *Sapiens*

Money was created many times in many places. Its development required no technological breakthroughs – it was a purely mental revolution. It involved the creation of a new inter-subjective reality that exists solely in people’s imagination.

~ YUVAL HARARI, *Sapiens*

There is no trace of [the belief in heaven and hell] in the Old Testament, which also never claims that the souls of people continue to live after the death of the body.

~ YUVAL HARARI, *Sapiens*

These creeds do not like to be called religions, and refer to themselves as ideologies. But this is just a semantic exercise. If a religion is a system of human norms and values that is founded on belief in a superhuman order, then Soviet Communism was no less a religion than Islam.

~ YUVAL HARARI, *Sapiens*

We did not domesticate wheat. It domesticated us. The word *domesticate* comes from the Latin *domus*, which means *house*. Who’s the one living in a house? Not the wheat. It’s the *Sapiens*.

~ YUVAL HARARI, *Sapiens*

After this they lived quietly and uneventfully for two or three years at Sir Ashley Mattisfont’s residence in that part of England, with as near an approach to bliss as the climate of this country allows.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *A Group of Noble Dames*

... the eternal hills and tower behind them were grayish-brown; the sky, dropping behind all, grey of the purest melancholy.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *A Pair of Blue Eyes*

A delightful place to be buried in, postulating that delight can accompany a man to his tomb under any circumstances.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *A Pair of Blue Eyes*

I always did doubt a man's being a gentleman if his palate has no acquired tastes. An unedified palate is the irrepressible cloven foot of the upstart.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *A Pair of Blue Eyes*

... a young married man, who having no individuality worth mentioning was known as "Susan Tall's husband."

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Far From the Madding Crowd*

... and used all the hair-oil he possessed upon his usually dry, sandy, and inextricably curly hair, till he had deepened it to a splendidly novel color, between that of guano and Roman cement, making it stick to his head like mace round a nutmeg, or wet sea-weed round a boulder after the ebb.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Far From the Madding Crowd*

Kiss my foot, sir; my face is for mouths of consequence.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Far From the Madding Crowd*

Seeing his advance take the form of an attitude threatening a possible enclosure, if not compression, of her person, she edged off around the bush.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Far From the Madding Crowd*

The dog took no notice, for he had arrived at an age at which all superfluous barking was cynically avoided as a waste of breath – in fact, he never barked even at the sheep except to order, when it was done with an absolutely neutral countenance, as a sort of Commination–service which, though offensive, had to be gone through once now and then to frighten the flock for their own good.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Far From the Madding Crowd*

The throw was the idea of a man conjoined with the execution of a woman. No man who had ever seen bird, rabbit, or squirrel in his childhood, could possibly have thrown with such utter imbecility as was shown here.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Far From the Madding Crowd*

Here he stood, looking forth at the school, whence he could hear the usual sing-song tones of the little voices that had not learnt Creation's groan.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Jude the Obscure*

Necessary meditations on the actual, including the mean bread-and-cheese question, dissipated the phantasmal for a while, and compelled Jude to smother higher thinkings under immediate needs.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Jude the Obscure*

The barmaid concocted the mixture with the bearing of a person compelled to live amongst animals of an inferior species.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Jude the Obscure*

... his was a nature not greatly dependent upon the ministrations of the other sex for its comforts.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Life's Little Ironies*

He himself was full of vague latter-day glooms and popular melancholies.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Life's Little Ironies*

Occasionally Mop could produce the aforesaid moving effect upon the souls of grown-up persons, especially young women of fragile and responsive organization.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Life's Little Ironies*

There were tones in it which bred the immediate conviction that indolence and averseness to systematic application were all that lay between "Mop" and the career of a second Paganini.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Life's Little Ironies*

Too steady-going to be "a buck" (as fast and unmarried men were then called), he was an approximately fashionable man of mild type.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Life's Little Ironies*

But I am getting used to the horror of my existence.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *The Return of the Native*

He had been a lad of whom something was expected. Beyond this all had been chaos. That he would be successful in an original way, or that he would go to the dogs in an original way, seemed equally probable. The only absolute certainty about him was that he would not stand still in the circumstances amid which he was born.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *The Return of the Native*

He had reached the stage in a young man's life when the grimness of the general human situation first becomes clear; and the realization of this causes ambition to halt awhile. In France it is not uncustomary to commit suicide at this stage; in England we do much better, or much worse, as the case may be.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *The Return of the Native*

There is a certain degree and tone of light which tends to disturb the equilibrium of the senses, and to promote dangerously the tenderer moods.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *The Return of the Native*

He threw fictitiousness into his very gait, even now, when there was nobody to see him, and struck out at stems of wild parsley with his regimental switch as he had used to do when soldiering was new to him, and life in general a charming experience.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *The Trumpet-Major*

... with a sudden start he worked on, climbing higher into the sky, and cutting himself off more and more from all intercourse with the sublunary world.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *The Woodlanders*

As in most villages so secluded as this, intermarriages were of Hapsburgian frequency among the inhabitants.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *The Woodlanders*

Fitzpiers examined so closely that his breath touched her tenderly, at which their eyes rose to an encounter – hers showing themselves as deep and mysterious as interstellar space.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *The Woodlanders*

For answer she ran off into the gloom of the sluggish dawn.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *The Woodlanders*

Grace heaved a divided sigh, with a tense pause between, and moved onward, her heart feeling uncomfortably big and heavy, and her eyes wet.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *The Woodlanders*

The young lady remained in his thoughts. He might have followed her; but he was not constitutionally active, and preferred a conjectural pursuit.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *The Woodlanders*

... it was an accepted thing that Leaf didn't in the least mind having no head, that deficiency of his being an unimpassioned matter of parish history.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Under the Greenwood Tree*

... they were never to be seen drawing the back of the hand across the mouth after drinking – a local English custom of extraordinary antiquity, but stated by Fancy to be decidedly dying out among the better classes of society.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Under the Greenwood Tree*

I fancy I've seen him look across at Miss Day in a warmer way than Christianity asked for.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Under the Greenwood Tree*

Thereupon he plunged in his hands, and they paddled together. It being the first time in his life that he touched female fingers under water, Dick duly registered the sensation as rather a nice one.

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Under the Greenwood Tree*

"Well!", said Mrs. Penny, flopping into a chair, "my heart hasn't been in such a thumping state of uproar since I used to sit up on old Midsummer-eves to see who my husband was going to be."

~ THOMAS HARDY, *Under the Greenwood Tree*

Everything in existence, said he, taking a handful of louis from his pocket, is contained in these little pieces of metal, which will convey you commodiously from one end of the world to the other. All men obey those who possess this powder, and eagerly tender their services. To despise money is to despise happiness, liberty, in short, enjoyments of every kind.

~ MADAME DE HAUSSET, *Mémoires*

The king gave each of his [illegitimate] children about ten thousand francs a year. They inherited after each other as they died off, and seven or eight were already dead.

~ MADAME DE HAUSSET, *Mémoires*

The studied forms of politeness do not give the greatest possible scope to an exuberance of wit and fancy. The fear of giving offence destroys sincerity, and without sincerity there can be no true enjoyment of society, nor unfettered exertion of intellectual activity.

~ WILLIAM HAZLITT

Magic has existed among all peoples and at every period.

~ HEGEL

“In the first moment, I was deeply shaken. I had the sensation of looking through the surface of atomic phenomena at a distant foundation of a strange inner beauty, and the thought that I was to probe this wealth of mathematical structures that nature had spread out before me down below almost made me dizzy. I was far too agitated to sleep. And so, with dawn beginning to break, I left the house and headed for the southern tip of the island, to where a solitary tower of rocks jutting out into the sea had kindled my desire to climb it. I reached for the top without too much difficulty, and waited for the sun to rise.”

~ ELISABETH HEISENBERG, *Inner Exile*

... what we observe in nature is not nature in itself but nature exposed to our method of questioning.

~ WERNER HEISENBERG, *Physics and Philosophy*

The electrodynamics of moving bodies can be derived at once from the principle of relativity.

~ WERNER HEISENBERG, *Physics and Philosophy*

The idea that electromagnetic waves could be a reality in themselves, independent of any bodies, did at that time not occur to the physicists.

~ WERNER HEISENBERG, *Physics and Philosophy*

I've not had this much fun since the war.

~ ERNEST HEMINGWAY, *The Sun Also Rises*

... for long ago the Hellenes distinguished themselves from barbarians by their superior cleverness and freedom from naive stupidity.

~ HERODOTUS

... since she was well-endowed with the blessings of Aphrodite, she acquired a large fortune.

~ HERODOTUS

According to this law, an Egyptian could get a loan by declaring his father's corpse as security.

~ HERODOTUS

For even in such a short span of life, no human being is born so fortunate that the wish to be dead rather than alive will not occur to him, and not just once, but often.

~ HERODOTUS

In the middle of their heated argument, seven pairs of hawks pursuing and pecking violently at a pair of eagles appeared above them. When they saw this, they all approved of Darius' plan and, emboldened by this omen of the birds, continued on toward the palace.

~ HERODOTUS

One of the truly universal concepts that runs through almost every phase of mathematics is that of a *function*, a *mapping* from one set to another. One could safely say that there is no part of mathematics where the notion does not arise or play a central role.

~ I. N. HERSTEIN, *Abstract Algebra*

For violence was still an accepted part of everyday life, and it was not to be expected in an age which set so little store by human dignity that it could be otherwise. Men accustomed to paying twopence to go and laugh and jeer at the lunatics in Bedlam; to watching women knocking each other about with bare fists in the boxing ring; to throwing bricks at defenceless people in the stocks and pillory; to being given a holiday on the day of a hanging so that they could go to the fair at Tyburn and cheer as men and women slowly died at the end of the rope; to seeing their fellow human beings being whipped and burned and disemboweled and cut into four pieces; to passing the putrescent bodies of highwaymen suspended in iron cages near the scenes of their crimes – men accustomed to life in which these things were commonplace were not likely to come to the view that brutality was inexcusable.

~ CHRISTOPHER HIBBERT, *The Roots of Evil*

The French imagination was immediately captured [by the guillotine]. It was reproduced in miniature as a table decoration; its design was incorporated in earrings, brooches, snuff boxes, cups, and plates.

~ CHRISTOPHER HIBBERT, *The Roots of Evil*

I do not see that the sex of a candidate is an argument against [Emmy Noether's] admission as *Privatdocent*. After all, we are a university, not a bathing establishment.

~ DAVID HILBERT

At the beginning [propaganda] was apparently crazy in the impudence of its assertions, later it became disagreeable, and finally it was believed. There, propaganda was considered a weapon of the first order.

~ ADOLF HITLER, *Mein Kampf*

Today I am going to play the prophet again. If international Jewry should succeed, in Europe or elsewhere, in precipitating nations into a world war, the result will be not the bolshevization of Europe and a victory for Judaism, but the extermination in Europe of the Jewish race.

~ ADOLPH HITLER, *Annual Speech, 1939*

An unacknowledged animus against boys is loose in our society.

~ CHRISTINA HOFF-SOMERS, *The War Against Boys*

Does Gilligan really understand boys? She finds boys lacking in empathy, but does she empathize with them? The new pedagogies designed to "educate boys more like girls" (in Gloria Steinem's phrase) are not harmless. Their approach to boys is unacceptably meddlesome, and even subtly abusive.

~ CHRISTINA HOFF-SOMERS, *The War Against Boys*

"The most common word in the mouths of American soldiers has been a vulgar expression for sexual intercourse. This word does duty as adjective, adverb, verb, noun and in any other form it can possibly be used, however inappropriate or ridiculous in application."

~ RICHARD HOLMES, *Acts of War*

Miles Tripp recalled the talismans of his Lancaster crew: Harry's red and blue scarf, Dig's hat, George and his girlfriend's brassiere ...

~ RICHARD HOLMES, *Acts of War*

"A sniper's just another man, and your training tells you what to do. But what do you do about some fucker four miles away?"
[artillery]

~ RICHARD HOLMES, *Acts of War*

In Gulliver's Travels (1726), the Lilliputians decide that Gulliver consults his watch so often that it must be his god.

~ CARL HONORÉ, *In Praise of Slow*

When God made time he made plenty of it.

~ CARL HONORÉ, *In Praise of Slow*

Come, wanton winds, and blow my fears and sorrows to the Cretan sea!

~ HORACE

C'est ici, dans l'exercice d'une marche tranquille, que je saisis le mieux l'abolition possible et féconde du temps.

~ MICHEL HOST, *Valet de nuit*

La beauté me fait du bien en étant belle.

~ VICTOR HUGO, *Les travailleurs de la mer*

- Préparez-vous.
- A quoi?
- A mourir.
- Pourquoi? demanda le vieillard.

~ VICTOR HUGO, *Quatre-vingt-treize*

... l'exquise douceur de la voix féminine ...

~ NANCY HUSTON

And if ever, by some unlucky chance, anything unpleasant should somehow happen, why, there's always soma to give you a holiday from the facts.

~ ALDOUS HUXLEY, *Brave New World*

But industrial civilization is only possible when there's no self-denial. Self-indulgence up to the very limits imposed by hygiene and economics. Otherwise the wheels stop turning.

~ ALDOUS HUXLEY, *Brave New World*

He had discovered Time and Death and God.

~ ALDOUS HUXLEY, *Brave New World*

He was a mine of irrelevant information.

~ ALDOUS HUXLEY, *Brave New World*

She thinks of herself that way. She doesn't mind being meat.

~ ALDOUS HUXLEY, *Brave New World*

The loving cup of strawberry ice-cream soma was passed from hand to hand and, with the formula "I drink to my annihilation," twelve times quaffed.

~ ALDOUS HUXLEY, *Brave New World*

But through all the stream of events, the impact of people and social life forced upon him, Einstein remains lonely, loving solitude, isolation, and conditions which secure undisturbed work.

~ LEOPOLD INFELD, *Quest*

This law [that objects all fall at the same speed], so simple that it is nearly obvious, is only three hundred years old!

~ LEOPOLD INFELD, *Quest*

To ponder a problem for ten years without any encouragement from the outside world requires strength of character. This strength of character, perhaps more than his great intuition and imagination, lead to Einstein's scientific achievements.

~ LEOPOLD INFELD, *Quest*

We are slaves to bathrooms, frigidaire, cars, radios, and millions of other things. Einstein tried to reduce them to the absolute minimum.

~ LEOPOLD INFELD, *Quest*

As in the pseudoscience of bloodletting, just so in the pseudoscience of city rebuilding and planning, years of learning and a plethora of subtle and complicated dogma have arisen on a foundation of nonsense.

~ JANE JACOBS, *The Death and Life of Great American Cities*

Ask a houser how his planned neighborhood improves on the old city and he will cite, as a self-evident virtue, More Open Space ... More Open Space for what? For muggings?

~ JANE JACOBS, *The Death and Life of Great American Cities*

Cities are, by definition, full of strangers.

~ JANE JACOBS, *The Death and Life of Great American Cities*

In cities, liveliness and variety attract more liveliness, deadness and monotony repel life.

~ JANE JACOBS, *The Death and Life of Great American Cities*

Je suis athée, Dieu merci ...

~ JOSEPH JOFFO, *Incertain sourire*

One pattern of 0s and 1s is converted into another, and that is what computation is.

~ GEORGE JOHNSON, *A Shortcut Through Time*

No one wanted him; he was outcast from life's feast.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *A Painful Case*

The car ran on merrily with its cargo of hilarious youth.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *After the Race*

I had never spoken to her, except for a few casual words, and yet her name was like a summons to all my foolish blood.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Araby*

She dealt with moral problems as a clever deals with meat.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *The Boarding House*

Experience had embittered his heart against the world.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Two Gallants*

His head was large, globular, and oily; it sweated in all weathers.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Two Gallants*

Most people considered Lenehan a leech but, in spite of this reputation, his adroitness and eloquence had always prevented his friends from forming any general policy against him.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Two Gallants*

That takes the solitary, unique, and, if I may so call it, *recherché* biscuit!

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Two Gallants*

... papa's little lump of dung ...

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

... the seaweedy rocks.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

A monstrous fine bit of cowflesh.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

Fine lump of a woman, all the same, the soi-disant town clerk,
Henry Campbell remarked, and plenty of her.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

Give us a squint at that literature, grandfather, the ancient mariner
put in, manifesting some natural impatience.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

He can kiss my royal Irish arse.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

He laid the dry snot picked from his nostril on a ledge of rock,
carefully. For the rest let look on that will.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

Head like a prize pumpkin.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

Hot mockturtle vapor and steam of newbaked jumpuffs rolypoly
poured out from Harrison's. The heavy noonreek tickled the top of
Mr. Bloom's gullet.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

I asked him what he thought of the charge of pederasty brought
against the bard. He lifted his hands and said: All we can say is life
ran very high in those days.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

I speak the tongue of a race whose acme of mentality is the maxim:
time is money. Material domination. Dominus! Lord! Where is
the spirituality? Lord Jesus! Lord Salisbury. A sofa in a west end
club. But the Greek!

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

Interesting only to the parish clerk. I mean, we have the plays. I mean when we read the poetry of King Lear what is it to us how the poet lived? As for living, our servants can do that for us, Villiers de l'Isle has said.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

Isn't the sea what Algy calls it? a grey sweet mother? The snotgreen sea. The scrotumtightening sea.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

Joy: I ate it: joy.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

Little monkeys common as ditchwater.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

Mighty cheese.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

Mr. Bloom admired the caretaker's prosperous bulk.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

Mr. Bloom was rather inclined to poohpooh the suggestion as egregious balderdash.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

O, the night in the Camden hall when the daughters of Erin had to lift their skirts to step over you as you lay in your mulberrycouloured, multicoloured, multitudinous vomit!

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

Thanky vous.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

The heaventree of stars hung with humid nightblue fruit.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

The night air was certainly a treat to breathe though Stephen was a bit weak on his pins.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

There too, opposite to him was Lynch, whose countenance bore already the stigmata of early depravity and premature wisdom.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

This was so happy a conceit that it renewed the storms of mirth and threw the whole room into the most violent agitations of delight.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

You behold in me, Stephen said with grim displeasure, a horrible example of free thought.

~ JAMES JOYCE, *Ulysses*

With many men of twenty-five the period of psychological puberty is not yet over.

~ CARL JUNG, *Collected Works*, v.10

Experience, not books, is what leads to understanding.

~ CARL JUNG, *Psychology and Alchemy*

At the same time, Spain withdrew from active participation in the intellectual life of Europe.

~ HENRY KAMEN, *The Spanish Inquisition*

By the end of the sixteenth century there were no professors of mathematics in Alcala or Salamanca.

~ HENRY KAMEN, *The Spanish Inquisition*

The distinguishing feature of the Inquisition, its absolute secrecy ...

~ HENRY KAMEN, *The Spanish Inquisition*

The records of the Inquisition are full of instances where neighbours denounced neighbours, friends denounced friends, and members of the same family denounced each other.

~ HENRY KAMEN, *The Spanish Inquisition*

Torture was used as a last resort and applied only in a minority of cases.

~ HENRY KAMEN, *The Spanish Inquisition*

Two classes of people alone qualified for the stake – unrepentent heretics and relapsed heretics.

~ HENRY KAMEN, *The Spanish Inquisition*

By a number, then, until further notice, we shall mean one of a particular collection of grunts (differing with the language) associated with the ritual of counting.

~ KERSHNER AND WILCOX, *The Anatomy of Mathematics*

It is regrettable that mathematical words should have other meanings as well, since a nonmathematical meaning tends to influence understanding of the mathematical meaning. Thus, *set*, *function*, *relation*, and *operation* have mathematical meanings that are entirely, or almost entirely, divorced from their everyday meanings. The reader should not expect *real numbers* to be any more real, or any less imaginary, than *imaginary numbers*. There is nothing even remotely irrational about *irrational numbers*. These are all equally straightforward mathematical entities which happen to be unfortunately named.

~ KERSHNER AND WILCOX, *The Anatomy of Mathematics*

The need to recognize the existence of an undefined basis [assumptions] cannot be overemphasized.

~ KERSHNER AND WILCOX, *The Anatomy of Mathematics*

The practical use of mathematics has an importance which it would be foolish to deny. Without mathematics such amenities of modern civilization such as elevators, automatic cigarette vending machines and atomic bombs could not have been developed.

~ KERSHNER AND WILCOX, *The Anatomy of Mathematics*

After Gutenberg, a whole industry developed in Germany of printing cards whose texts supposedly kept the purchaser safe from the plague and other afflictions.

~ ROSS KING, *The Bookseller of Florence*

I am ten leagues deep in calamity.

~ RUDYARD KIPLING, *Kim*

The boat of my soul lacked direction.

~ RUDYARD KIPLING, *Kim*

There was nothing in his composition to which drill and routine appealed.

~ RUDYARD KIPLING, *Kim*

To importune the wise out of season is to invite calamity.

~ RUDYARD KIPLING, *Kim*

“Since when have the hill-asses owned all Hindustan?” The retort was a swift and brilliant sketch of Kim’s pedigree for three generations.

~ RUDYARD KIPLING, *Kim*

... the intention is evidently to wear us down, as many individuals as possible are to be driven to suicide.

~ VICTOR KLEMPERER, *To The Bitter End*

On the Feldherrnhalle, carefully painted in giant letters:
“Buchenwald, Velden, Dachau – I am ashamed to be a German.”

~ VICTOR KLEMPERER, *To The Bitter End*

Once, as she was searching, she had wanted to light a cigarette and had had no matches; something was glowing on the ground, she wanted to use it – it was a burning corpse.

~ VICTOR KLEMPERER, *To The Bitter End*

The brief items on Dresden are shameless. Nothing but the irreplaceable works of art, not a word about the 200,000 dead.

~ VICTOR KLEMPERER, *To The Bitter End*

They deal in slogans as bootleggers deal in faded spirits; and the more innocent the customer, the more easily he becomes a victim of the ideological hooch sold under the trade-mark of Peace, Democracy, Progress or what you will.

~ ARTHUR KOESTLER, *The God That Failed*

De Revolutionibus is a relatively staid, sober, and unrevolutionary work.

~ THOMAS S. KUHN, *The Copernican Revolution*

Copernicus belonged to the minority group of Renaissance astronomers who did not cast horoscopes.

~ THOMAS S. KUHN, *The Copernican Revolution*

Copernicus himself believed in neither [infinite space nor the possibility of a vacuum]. As we shall see, he tried to preserve most of the central features of Aristotelian and Ptolemaic cosmology.

~ THOMAS S. KUHN, *The Copernican Revolution*

Copernicus' system is neither simpler nor more accurate than Ptolemy's.

~ THOMAS S. KUHN, *The Copernican Revolution*

During the century and a half following Galileo's death in 1642, a belief in the earth-centered universe was gradually transformed from an essential sign of sanity to an index, first, of inflexible conservatism, then of excessive parochialism, and finally of complete fanaticism.

~ THOMAS S. KUHN, *The Copernican Revolution*

Men who believed that their terrestrial home was only a planet circulating blindly about one of an infinity of stars evaluated their place in the cosmic scheme quite differently than had their predecessors who saw the earth as the unique and focal center of God's creation.

~ THOMAS S. KUHN, *The Copernican Revolution*

The Copernican Revolution, as we know it, is scarcely to be found in the *De Revolutionibus* and that is the second essential incongruity of the text.

~ THOMAS S. KUHN, *The Copernican Revolution*

The initial battle between Copernicus and the astronomers of antiquity was fought over technical minutiae.

~ THOMAS S. KUHN, *The Copernican Revolution*

There is no way of proving that a conceptual scheme is final.

~ THOMAS S. KUHN, *The Copernican Revolution*

The temptation to write history backward is both omnipresent and perennial.

~ THOMAS S. KUHN, *The Structure of Scientific Revolutions*

To be accepted as a paradigm, a thing must seem better than its competitors, but it need not, and in fact never does, explain all the facts with which it can be confronted.

~ THOMAS S. KUHN, *The Structure of Scientific Revolutions*

Elle savourait l'absence totale d'aventures. Aventure: façon d'embrasser le monde. Elle ne voulait plus embrasser le monde. Elle ne voulait plus le monde.

~ MILAN KUNDERA, *L'identité*

L'amitié, ce n'est pas le problème des femmes ... c'est le problème des hommes. C'est leur romantisme. Pas le nôtre.

~ MILAN KUNDERA, *L'identité*

Juste au pied du morne Nelhio, le cimetière de Port-au-Prince, comme un lot de diamants mal taillés. C'est le lieu du rendez-vous générale.

~ DANY LAFFERRIÈRE, *Pays sans chapeau*

A man without a mask is indeed very rare.

~ R. D. LAING

Human beings seem to have an almost unlimited capacity for self-deception, for deceiving themselves into taking their own lies for the truth.

~ R. D. LAING, *The Politics of Experience*

We all live in the hope that authentic meeting between human beings can still occur.

~ R. D. LAING, *The Politics of Experience*

We have to realize that we are as deeply afraid to live and to love as to die.

~ R. D. LAING, *The Politics of Experience*

... he was a man of the most dangerous type, an honest fanatic.
~ HENRY CHARLES LEA, *A History of the Inquisition of the Middle Ages*

Commencing with those accused of magic, it extended to all who were noted for letters or philosophy. Terror reigned throughout the East; all who had libraries burned them. [Eastern Empire, about 374 AD]

~ HENRY CHARLES LEA, *A History of the Inquisition of the Middle Ages*

Every misfortune and every accident that occurred in a hamlet would be attributed to witchcraft.

~ HENRY CHARLES LEA, *A History of the Inquisition of the Middle Ages*

In such a religion the priest exercises the functions which in purer faiths are relegated to the sorcerer.

~ HENRY CHARLES LEA, *A History of the Inquisition of the Middle Ages*

Ludicrous as all this may seem [details of witch behaviour], every one of these details has served as the basis of charges under which countless human beings have perished in the flames.

~ HENRY CHARLES LEA, *A History of the Inquisition of the Middle Ages*

The awful words "Thou shall not suffer a witch (Mekasshepha) to live" have rung through the centuries, and have served as a justification for probably more judicial slaughter than any other sentence in the history of human jurisprudence.

~ HENRY CHARLES LEA, *A History of the Inquisition of the Middle Ages*

With the triumph of Christianity the circle of forbidden practices was enormously enlarged. A new sacred magic was introduced which superseded and condemned as sorcery and demon-worship a vast array of observances and beliefs, which had become an integral part and almost ineradicable part of daily life.

~ HENRY CHARLES LEA, *A History of the Inquisition of the Middle Ages*

Ordinary languages, though mostly helpful for the inferences of thought, are yet subject to countless ambiguities and cannot do the task of a calculus, which is to expose mistakes in inference. This remarkable advantage is afforded up to date only by the symbols of arithmeticians and algebraists, for whom inference consists only in the use of characters, and a mistake in thought and in the calculus is identical.

~ LEIBNIZ

For Islamists, democracy, expressing the will of the people, is the road to power, but it is a one-way road.

~ BERNARD LEWIS, *The Crisis of Islam*

On the Holocaust three positions are not infrequently found in the Arabic media: it never happened; it was greatly exaggerated; the Jews deserved it anyway.

~ BERNARD LEWIS, *The Crisis of Islam*

The Arab world translates about 330 books annually [2002], one fifth of the number that Greece translates. Spain translates almost 100,000 in one year.

~ BERNARD LEWIS, *The Crisis of Islam*

Yet the most powerful accusation of all is the degeneracy and debauchery of the American way of life, and the threat that it offers to Islam. This is what is meant by the term the Great Satan, applied to the United States by Ayatollah Khomeini. Satan as depicted in the Qu'ran is neither an imperialist nor an exploiter. He is a seducer, "the insidious tempter who whispers in the hearts of men."

~ BERNARD LEWIS, *The Crisis of Islam*

... what wastes the talents of the present generation is the idleness in which all but a few of us pass our lives, only exerting ourselves or showing any enterprise for the sake of getting praise or pleasure out of it, never from the honourable and admirable motive of doing good to the world.

~ LONGINUS, *On the Sublime*

... it is not right to display the triviality of one's mind before an audience of all the ages.

~ LONGINUS, *On the Sublime*

In the doorway stood a person of such singular appearance that I should have exclaimed aloud but for the restraints of good breeding.

~ H. P. LOVECRAFT, *The Picture in the House*

It is an intriguing thought that without the assistance of those anaerobic microflora living in the stinking muds of the sea-beds, lakes, and ponds, there might be no reading or writing of books. Without the methane they produce, oxygen would rise inexorably in concentration to a level at which any fire would be a holocaust and land life, apart from the microflora in damp places, would be impossible.

~ JAMES LOVELOCK, *Gaia - A New Look at Life on Earth*

Because we are tribal animals, the tribe does not act in unison until a real and present danger is perceived.

~ JAMES LOVELOCK, *The Revenge of Gaia*

Despite all these warnings, we carry on destroying and seem to worry only about the nearly trivial, even imaginary, risk of cancer from mobile telephones, power lines, pesticide residues in food, or sunlight; topping them all is a fear of anything to do with nuclear energy.

~ JAMES LOVELOCK, *The Revenge of Gaia*

Few, even among climate scientists and ecologists, seem yet to realize fully the potential severity, or the immanence, of catastrophic global disaster; understanding is still in the conscious mind alone and not yet the visceral reaction of fear.

~ JAMES LOVELOCK, *The Revenge of Gaia*

How on Earth, you may ask, can something so good, something so benign as nuclear energy have been demonized to the point where people and sensitive governments are frightened to use it? I think it is a consequence of the vulnerability of people to the astonishing power to deceive of an endlessly repeated falsehood.

~ JAMES LOVELOCK, *The Revenge of Gaia*

Most of all, [the greens] must drop their wrongheaded objection to nuclear energy.

~ JAMES LOVELOCK, *The Revenge of Gaia*

We are no more qualified to be the stewards or developers of the Earth than are goats to be gardeners.

~ JAMES LOVELOCK, *The Revenge of Gaia*

At the age of twelve I was reading Caesar, at thirteen the Greek testament. I had already mastered four books of Euclid, much algebra, and the mechanical parts of French.

~ ANDREW MACPHAIL, *The Master's Wife*

It was easier to avoid a spell than to remove it once it had been cast, although she was quite familiar with the best practice of exorcism. A piece of silver was put into a white bowl, and the bowl allowed to fill from a running spring. The vessel was turned slowly, and "suitable words" were spoken, until the contents were poured over the afflicted animal. A threepenny bit of silver was used; it was the smallest silver coin, and the exorciser always retained it as a fee for their service.

~ ANDREW MACPHAIL, *The Master's Wife*

Delightful realm of Imagination, which the benevolent Being has bestowed upon man, to console him for the realities of life, I must quit thee.

~ XAVIER DE MAISTRE, *A Journey Around My Room*

From the expedition of the Argonauts to the Assembly of the Notables, from the nethermost Hell to the last fixed star of the Milky Way, to the confines of the Universe, to the gates of chaos, this is the vast expanse over the length and breadth of which I wander at leisure, for neither time nor space fail me.

~ XAVIER DE MAISTRE, *A Journey Around My Room*

Happy is he who finds a friend whose heart and mind are in sympathy with his own; a friend who is linked to him by similar tastes, feelings, and knowledge; a friend who is not tormented by ambition or egotism; who prefers the shade of a tree to the pomp of a court! Happy is he who possesses a friend!

~ XAVIER DE MAISTRE, *A Journey Around My Room*

The moment was short and full of ecstasy; cold reason soon resumed her sway, and in the twinkling of an eye, a whole year was added to my life; my heart grew icy cold, and I found myself on a level with the throng of commonplace beings who crowd the earth.

~ XAVIER DE MAISTRE, *A Journey Around My Room*

We were happy in our errors, but now – ah! all is sadly changed. We have been compelled, like others, to read the human heart; and truth, falling like a bomb into the midst of us, has forever destroyed the enchanted palace of illusion.

~ XAVIER DE MAISTRE, *A Journey Around My Room*

What a capital article of furniture an arm-chair is, and what a treasure to a thoughtful man! During the long winter evenings it is often delightful, and always prudent, to lounge luxuriously in it, far from the turmoil of the madding crowd. A good fire, books, and pens; what safeguards these are against ennui! And how pleasant again, to forget books and pens in the delights of stirring the fire, while giving one's-self up to some sweet thought, or making a few rhymes for the amusement of friends! The hours glide by and fall into silence – into eternity, without making their sad passage felt.

~ XAVIER DE MAISTRE, *A Journey Around My Room*

Combien peu de personnes, me disais-je, jouissent maintenant avec moi du spectacle sublime que le ciel étale inutilement pour les hommes assoupis! Passe encore pour ceux qui dorment; mais qu'en coûterait-il à ceux qui se promènent, à ceux qui sortent en foule du théâtre de regarder un instant et d'admirer les brillantes constellations qui rayonnent de toutes parts sur leur tête? – Non, les spectateurs attentifs de *Scapin* ou de *Jocrisse* ne daigneront pas lever les yeux: Ils vont rentrer brutalement chez eux, ou ailleurs, sans songer que le ciel existe. Quelle bizarrerie! Parce qu'on peut le voir souvent et gratis, ils n'en veulent pas. Si le firmament était toujours voilé pour nous, si le spectacle qu'il nous offre dépendait d'un entrepreneur, les premières loges sur les toits seraient hors de prix, et les dames de Turin s'arracheraient ma lucarne.

~ XAVIER DE MAISTRE, *Expédition nocturne autour de ma chambre*

C'est un charme toujours nouveau pour moi que celui de contempler le ciel étoilé, et je n'ai pas à me reprocher d'avoir fait un seul voyage, ni même une simple promenade nocturne, sans payer le tribut d'admiration que je dois aux merveilles du firmament.

~ XAVIER DE MAISTRE, *Expédition nocturne autour de ma chambre*

Spectateur éphémère d'un spectacle éternel, l'homme lève un instant les yeux vers le ciel, et les referme pour toujours; mais, pendant cet instant rapide qui lui est accordé, de tous les points du ciel et depuis les bornes de l'univers, un rayon consolateur part de chaque monde et vient frapper ses regards, pour lui annoncer qu'il existe un rapport entre l'immensité et lui, et qu'il est associé à l'éternité.

~ XAVIER DE MAISTRE, *Expédition nocturne autour de ma chambre*

... natives communally, as well as individually, never act except on traditional and conventional lines.

~ B. MALINOWSKI, *Argonauts of the Western Pacific*

But each of the rites and spells is to the native mind, quite as indispensable for the success of the enterprise, as is the practical activity.

~ B. MALINOWSKI, *Argonauts of the Western Pacific*

Disease is not conceived as an extraneous force, coming from outside and settling on the man, it is directly a man-made, sorcerer-made something.

~ B. MALINOWSKI, *Argonauts of the Western Pacific*

The goal is, briefly, to grasp the native's point of view, his relation to life, to realise *his* vision of *his* world.

~ B. MALINOWSKI, *Argonauts of the Western Pacific*

... anthropology should not only be the study of savage custom in the light of our mentality and our culture, but also the study of our own mentality in the distant perspective borrowed from Stone Age man.

~ B. MALINOWSKI, *Magic, Science, and Religion*

But there is no doubt whatever to him that all serious and especially all fatal illnesses are due to various forms and agencies of witchcraft.

~ B. MALINOWSKI, *Magic, Science, and Religion*

It is in the spell that the main virtue of all magic resides. The rite is there only to launch the spell, to serve as an appropriate mechanism of transmission.

~ B. MALINOWSKI, *Magic, Science, and Religion*

To the natives, knowledge of magic means the knowledge of the spell; and in any act of witchcraft the ritual centers around the utterance of the spell.

~ B. MALINOWSKI, *Magic, Science, and Religion*

Women and the suspicion of magical practices are the main causes of quarrels and village brawls.

~ B. MALINOWSKI, *Magic, Science, and Religion*

Yet when the sociologist approaches the study of magic, there where it still reigns supreme, he finds to his disappointment an entirely sober, prosaic, even clumsy art, enacted for purely practical reasons, governed by crude and shallow beliefs, carried out in a simple and monotonous technique. This was already indicated in the definition of magic given above when in order to distinguish it from religion we described it as a body of purely practical acts, performed as a means to an end.

~ B. MALINOWSKI, *Magic, Science, and Religion*

[Magic] remains from the earliest times in the hands of specialists, and the first profession of mankind is that of wizard or witch.

~ B. MALINOWSKI, *Magic, Science, and Religion*

At night I can read with a lightheartedness verging on insouciance.

~ ALBERTO MANGUEL, *The Library at Night*

My books have unlimited patience. They will wait for me till the end of my days.

~ ALBERTO MANGUEL, *The Library at Night*

It is primarily women who reinvigorate the warrior back into society, the energy of the queen, not the king.

~ KARL MARLANTES, *What It Is Like To Go To War*

The least acknowledged aspect of war, today, is how exhilarating it is.

~ KARL MARLANTES, *What It Is Like To Go To War*

The realm I enter now, the transcendent realm one reaches through violence, is one that society says it condemns but in fact celebrates everywhere, on film, on television, and in the news.

~ KARL MARLANTES, *What It Is Like To Go To War*

We don't want to think that something as ugly and brutal as combat could be involved in any way with the spiritual. However, would any practicing Christian say that Calvary Hill was not a sacred place?

~ KARL MARLANTES, *What It Is Like To Go To War*

The precept that location is the key to the success of a business applies to art, and even to life itself: we thrive or wither depending on how nourishing our environment is.

~ YANN MARTEL, *Beatrice and Virgil*

This slave girl, born of Fronto and Flacilla, was my delight whom I would hug and kiss. Don't let little Erotion fear the dark shadows and the yawning mouths of Cerebus. She was just that many days from finishing her sixth cold winter. May the soft turf cover her fragile bones, and lie lightly upon her, earth. She was never heavy on you.

~ MARTIAL, *Epigrams*

The hetaira's ideal beau is young, good-looking, lavishly and unfailingly generous, intelligent and good-tempered. Sadly the species has been hunted to extinction, so hetairas compete viciously for any man with just two of the above qualities.

~ PHILIP MATYSZAK, *24 Hours in Ancient Athens*

But there is in my nature a strain of asceticism, and I have subjected my flesh each week to a more severe mortification. I have never failed to read the *Literary Supplement of The Times*.

~ W. SOMERSET MAUGHAN, *The Moon and Sixpence*

He made enemies rather than friends.

~ W. SOMERSET MAUGHAN, *The Moon and Sixpence*

The faculty for myth is innate in the human race.

~ W. SOMERSET MAUGHAN, *The Moon and Sixpence*

There is no object more deserving of pity than the married bachelor.

~ W. SOMERSET MAUGHAN, *The Moon and Sixpence*

Marriage is a very good thing, but I think it's a mistake to make a habit of it.

~ W. SOMERSET MAUGHAN, *The World Over*

Oh! cet oeil de la femme, quelle puissance il a! Comme il trouble, envahit, possède, domine. Comme il semble profond, plein de promesses, d'infini! On appelle cela se regarder dans l'âme! Oh! monsieur, quelle blague! Si l'on y voyait, dans l'âme, on serait plus sage, allez.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Au printemps*

Moi je crois que ce qui nous séduit le plus dans les exotiques, c'est leur défaut de prononciation. Aussitôt qu'une femme parle mal notre langue, elle est charmante; si elle fait une faute de français par mot, elle est exquise, et si elle baragouine d'une façon tout à fait inintelligible, elle devient irrésistible.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Découverte*

Ils sont incapables de s'attacher à une chose jusqu'à l'aimer uniquement, de s'intéresser à rien jusqu'à être illuminés par le bonheur de comprendre.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Fort comme la mort*

L'architecture est morte aujourd'hui, en ce siècle encore artiste, pourtant, mais qui semble avoir perdu le don de faire de la beauté avec des pierres, le mystérieux secret de la séduction par les lignes, le sens de la grâce dans les monuments. Nous paraissions ne plus comprendre, ne plus savoir que la seule proportion d'un mur peut donner à l'esprit la même sensation de joie artistique, la même émotion secrète et profonde qu'un chef-d'oeuvre de Rembrandt, de Velasquez ou de Véronèse.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *La Sicile*

Comme elle est petite cette ville à côté de l'autre, celle où l'on vit! Et pourtant comme ils sont plus nombreux que les vivants, ces morts. Il nous faut de hautes maisons, des rues, tant de place, pour les quatre générations qui regardent le jour en même temps, boivent l'eau des sources, le vin des vignes et mangent le pain des plaines. Et pour toute les générations des morts, pour toute l'échelle de l'humanité descendue jusqu'à nous, presque rien, un champ, presque rien! La terre les reprend, l'oubli les efface. Adieu!

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *La morte*

Et puis, j'aime aussi les cimetières, parce que ce sont des villes monstrueuses, prodigieusement habitées. Songez donc à ce qu'il y a de morts dans ce petit espace, à toutes les générations de Parisiens qui sont logés là, pour toujours, troglodytes définitifs enfermés dans leurs petits caveaux, dans leurs petits trous couverts d'une pierre ou marqués d'une croix, tandis que les vivants occupent tant de place et font tant de bruit, ces imbéciles.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Les tombales*

... ceux qui n'ont pas aimé poétiquement prennent et choisissent les femmes comme on choisit une côtelette à la boucherie, sans s'occuper d'autre chose que de la qualité de leur chair.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *L'ermite*

Qu'y a-t-il, en effet, de plus ignoble, de plus répugnant que cet acte ordurier et ridicule de la reproduction des êtres, contre lequel toutes les âmes délicates sont et seront éternellement révoltées?

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *L'inutile beauté*

J'avais trente-cinq ans, et je ne pensais pas plus à me marier qu'à me pendre.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Ma femme*

Les années se suivaient, lentes, monotones, et courtes parce qu'elles étaient vides.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Monsieur Parent*

... elle consentit à épouser ce gros garçon très riche, qui n'était pas laid, mais qui ne lui plaisait guère, comme elle aurait consenti à passer un été dans un pays désagréable.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Mont Oriol*

Ah!, vous ne comprenez pas, vous autres, comme c'est amusant, les affaires, non pas les affaires des marchands ou des commerçants, mais les grandes affaires, les nôtres! Oui, mon cher, quand on les entend bien, cela résume tout ce qu'ont aimé les hommes, c'est en même temps la politique, la guerre, la diplomatie, tout, tout! Il faut toujours chercher, trouver, inventer, tout comprendre, tout prévoir, tout combiner, tout oser. Le grand combat, aujourd'hui, c'est avec l'argent qu'on le livre.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Mont Oriol*

C'est bon, dit-il, d'être jeune, quelquefois.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Mont Oriol*

Elle ne les vit pas, ou ne les reconnut point. Toute pâle sur son oreiller blanc, avec ses cheveux blonds répandus sur ses épaules, elle regardait, de ses clairs yeux bleus, le monde inconnu, mystérieux et fantastique où vivent les fous.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Mont Oriol*

Laissez donc, dit-il, je la connais, leur intelligence, à tous ces brasseurs d'affaires. Ils n'ont qu'une chose en tête : l'argent! Toutes les pensées que nous donnons aux belles choses, tous les actes que nous perdons pour nos caprices, toutes les heures que nous jetons à nos distractions, toute la force que nous gaspillons pour nos plaisirs, toute l'ardeur et toute la puissance que nous prend l'amour, l'amour divin, ils les emploient à chercher de l'or, à songer à l'or, à amasser de l'or! L'homme, l'homme intelligent, vit pour toutes les grandes tendresses désintéressées, les arts, l'amour, la science, les voyages, les livres; et s'il cherche l'argent, c'est parce que cela facilite les joies réelles de l'esprit et même le bonheur du coeur! Mais eux, ils n'ont rien dans l'esprit et dans le coeur que ce goût ignoble du trafic! Ils ressemblent aux hommes de valeur, ces écumeurs de la vie, comme le marchand de tableaux ressemble au peintre, comme l'éditeur ressemble à l'écrivain, comme le directeur de théâtre ressemble au poète.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Mont Oriol*

Mais les mots noirs sur le papier blanc, c'est l'âme toute nue.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Notre Cœur*

Elle sait pourtant qu'elle va mourir, qu'elle ne verra point le printemps, que dans un an, le long de la même promenade, ces mêmes gens qui passent devant elle viendront encore respirer l'air tiède de ce doux pays, avec leurs enfants un peu plus grands, avec le cœur toujours rempli d'espoirs, de tendresses, de bonheur, tandis qu'au fond d'un cercueil de chêne la pauvre chair que lui reste encore aujourd'hui sera tombée en pourriture, laissant seulement ses os couchés dans la robe de soie qu'elle a choisie pour linceul.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Oeuvres posthumes*

La misanthropie de ses oeuvres [Flaubert] ne vient pas d'autres chose. La saveur amère qui s'en degage n'est que cette constante constatation de la médiocrité, de la banalité, de la sottise sous toutes les formes.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Oeuvres posthumes*

La profonde et délicieuse jouissance qui vous monte au cœur devant certaines pages, devant certaines phrases, ne vient pas seulement de ce qu'elles disent; elle vient d'une accordance absolue de l'expression avec l'idée, d'une sensation d'harmonie, de beauté secrète, échappant la plupart du temps au jugement des foules.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Oeuvres posthumes*

Les mots ont une âme.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Oeuvres posthumes*

[Flaubert] avait pour les grands écrivains français une admiration frénétique; il possédait par cœur des chapitres entiers des maîtres, et il les déclamaient d'une voix tonnante, grisé par la prose, faisant sonner les mots, scandant, modulant, chantant la phrase.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Oeuvres posthumes*

Je ne refuse pas de voir le monde, de causer, de dîner avec des amis, mais lorsque je les sens depuis longtemps près de moi, même les plus familiers, ils me lassent, me fatiguent, m'énervent, et j'éprouve une envie grandissante, harcelante, de les voir partir ou de m'en aller, d'être seul.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Qui sait?*

Quoi que nous tentions, quoi que nous fassions, quels que soient l'élan de nos coeurs, l'appel de nos lèvres et l'étreinte de nos bras, nous sommes toujours seuls.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Solitude*

Certes, en certains jours, j'éprouve l'horreur de ce qui est jusqu'à désirer la mort. Je sens jusqu'à la souffrance suraiguë la monotonie invariable des paysages, des figures et des pensées. Le médiocrité de l'univers m'étonne et me révolte, la petitesse de toutes choses m'emplit de dégoût, la pauvreté des êtres humains m'anéantit.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Sur l'eau*

Comme je l'aime, cette dédicace de Jules Vallès: «A tous ceux qui, nourris de grec et de latin, sont morts de faim.»

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Sur l'eau*

Mais d'autres hommes, parcourant d'un éclair de pensée le cercle étroit des satisfactions possibles, demeurent atterrés devant le néant du bonheur, la monotonie et la pauvreté des joies terrestres.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Sur l'eau*

O liberté! liberté! seul bonheur, seul espoir et seul rêve!

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Sur l'eau*

Quelques pigeons se promenaient au bord du ruisseau, cherchant leur vie.

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *Une vie*

Partir à pied, quand le soleil se lève, et marcher dans la rosée, le long des champs, au bord de la mer calme, quelle ivresse!

~ GUY DE MAUPASSANT, *À Vendre*

... le bon temps où l'on était si malheureux.

~ GEORGE DU MAURIER, *Trilby*

Les hommes livrent leur âme, comme les femme leur corps, par zones successives et bien défendues.

~ ANDRÉ MAUROIS, *Climats*

Shakespeare would have grasped wave functions, Donne would have understood complementarity and relative time. They would have been excited. What richness! They would have plundered this new science for their imagery. And they would have educated their audiences too. But you 'arts' people, you're not only ignorant of these magnificent things, you're rather proud of knowing nothing.

~ IAN MCEWAN, *The Child in Time*

Hitler, one may say, came to power through a typical but dazzled and blinded youth movement.

~ F. MEINKE, *The German Catastrophe*

... I never fancied broiling fowls; – though once broiled, judiciously buttered, and judgmatically salted and peppered, there is no one who will speak more respectfully, not to say reverentially, of a broiled fowl than I will.

~ HERMAN MELVILLE, *Moby Dick*

Already we are boldly launched upon the deep; but soon we shall be lost in its unshored, harborless immensities.

~ HERMAN MELVILLE, *Moby Dick*

Circumambulate the city of a dreary Sabbath afternoon.

~ HERMAN MELVILLE, *Moby Dick*

I'll try a pagan friend, thought I, since Christian kindness has proved but hollow courtesy.

~ HERMAN MELVILLE, *Moby Dick*

Panting and snorting like a mad battle steed that has lost its rider, the masterless ocean overruns the globe.

~ HERMAN MELVILLE, *Moby Dick*

This right-whale I take to have been a Stoic; the sperm whale, a Platonian, who might have taken up Spinoza in his later years.

~ HERMAN MELVILLE, *Moby Dick*

Top-heavy was the ship as a dinnerless student with all Aristotle in his head.

~ HERMAN MELVILLE, *Moby Dick*

Yea, foolish mortals, Noah's flood is not yet subsided; two thirds of the fair world it yet covers.

~ HERMAN MELVILLE, *Moby Dick*

Yes, as everyone knows, meditation and water are wedded forever.

~ HERMAN MELVILLE, *Moby Dick*

Damn is a simple verb and its only child is a simple adjective, but *hell* ranges over all the keys of the grammatical scale and enters into combinations as avidly as oxygen.

~ H. L. MENCKEN, *The American Scene*

He liked people who sweated freely, and were not debauched by the refinements of the toilet.

~ H. L. MENCKEN, *The American Scene*

In the field of language an Americanism is generally regarded as obnoxious *ipso facto*, and when a new one of any pungency begins to force its way into English usage the guardians of the national linguistic chastity belabor it with great vehemence, and predict calamitous consequences if it is not put down.

~ H. L. MENCKEN, *The American Scene*

That leveling, by the democratic theory, is upward, but in actuality it is downward, for the mob suspects and resents superiorities, whereas inferiorities give it a pleasant glow.

~ H. L. MENCKEN, *The American Scene*

The point is: one should try to enjoy the conversible world, despite its inanities, because removing oneself from it is dangerous to one's mental health.

~ STEPHEN MILLER, *Conversation – A History of a Declining Art*

... we should learn to spend as much time looking for evidence that we are wrong as we spend searching for reasons we are correct.

~ LEONARD MLODINOW, *The Drunkard's Walk*

Avoiding the illusion of meaning in random patterns is a difficult task.

~ LEONARD MLODINOW, *The Drunkard's Walk*

Complete chaos is ironically a kind of perfection.

~ LEONARD MLODINOW, *The Drunkard's Walk*

We habitually underestimate the effect of randomness.

~ LEONARD MLODINOW, *The Drunkard's Walk*

When chance is involved, people's thought processes are often seriously flawed.

~ LEONARD MLODINOW, *The Drunkard's Walk*

L'homme sait enfin qu'il est seul dans l'immensité indifférente de l'univers d'où il a émergé par hasard.

~ JACQUES MONOD

December. Early snows and Orion. The pale fires of the Milky Way.

~ L. M. MONTGOMERY, *The Blue Castle*

In the Stirling clan ankles were among the unmentionables.

~ L. M. MONTGOMERY, *The Blue Castle*

In the horrible but expressive slang phrase, she keeps all her goods in the shop-window.

~ L. M. MONTGOMERY, *The Blue Castle*

It was so easy to defy once you got started.

~ L. M. MONTGOMERY, *The Blue Castle*

"Can I acquire merit by getting or doing anything there for you or Cissy?"

~ L. M. MONTGOMERY, *The Blue Castle*

Culture is an alliance of the dead, the living, and the not-yet born.

~ CHARLES MOORE

Bruant wasn't being particularly unkind to Lucien. Everything at Le Mirliton was served with a side order of abuse.

~ CHRISTOPHER MOORE, *Sacré Bleu*

The Louvre's a little pious, isn't it? Can't throw a round of darts in there without scoring three Madonnas and a baby Jesus.

~ CHRISTOPHER MOORE, *Sacré Bleu*

They both waited, each took a drink, looked at her, said nothing. Dogs watching Shakespeare.

~ CHRISTOPHER MOORE, *Sacré Bleu*

You're grinning at me like lunatics? I am a creature of awesome power and divine aspect.

~ CHRISTOPHER MOORE, *Sacré Bleu*

C'était des harangues de sections, et puis l'hymne des Marseillais, et puis des chansons à plusieurs couplets sur des airs d'opéra-comique que le président Lubin, orné de son écharpe, chantait hors de mesure avec une voix et des gréments et des manières du beau Léandre, qui ravissait les spectateurs. Je crois bien que le président chanta ainsi en *solo* à peu près trois quarts d'heure en différentes fois, l'assemblée répétant communément le dernier vers du couplet. Aussi une femme du peuple, qui attendait comme moi dans cette antichambre, disait: "Mais c'est drôle de passer comme ça tout le temps de leur assemblée à chanter; est-ce qu'ils sont là pour ça?"

~ L'ABBÉ MORELLET, *Mémoires*

Enfin, cette nation et cette ville ont vu et souffert une assemblée nationale ou se disant telle qui, chargés de défendre les propriétés, les libertés, les vies des Français, ordonnait ces horreurs, tandis que les moins coupables d'entre eux n'opposaient aucune résistance à ces lois de sang. Ce phénomène n'est pas encore expliqué, si même il est explicable.

~ L'ABBÉ MORELLET, *Mémoires*

"Oh! diable", dit M. de Buffon, la tête haute, les yeux à demi fermés, et avec un air moitié niais, moitié inspiré, "oh! diable! quand il est question de clarifier son style, c'est une autre paire de manches." A ce propos, à cette comparaison des rues, voilà Mlle de l'Espinasse qui se trouble; sa physionomie s'altère, elle se renverse sur son fauteil, répétant entre ses dents, "une autre paire de manches! clarifier son style!" Elle n'en revint pas de toute la soirée.

~ L'ABBÉ MORELLET, *Mémoires*

An honest amazement at the unspeakable beauties of the world is a comely posture for the scholar.

~ CHRISTOPHER MORLEY, *Parnassus on Wheels*

There is no hope for New Yorkers, for they glory in their skyscraping sins; but in Brooklyn there is the wisdom of the lowly.

~ CHRISTOPHER MORLEY, *Parnassus on Wheels*

The Harkeners were peaceful folk who devoted their lives to listening for instructive and consolatory voices from another plane. Since no one could be certain where such voices might best be heard, Harkeners listened to everything: old boots, haystacks, boulders, trees, bowls of oatmeal, and anything else at hand. Belsheer thought that over, and his expression brightened. "It would be nice to spend a few weeks sitting in the sun, listening to a loaf of bread."

~ JOHN MORRESSY, *A Tale of Three Wizards*

The biggest disease in the world today is not leprosy or tuberculosis, but rather the feeling of being unwanted, uncared for, and deserted by everybody.

~ MOTHER THERESA

Every so often a disappearance is in order. A vanishing. A checking out. An indeterminate period of unavailability.

~ JOHN MURPHY

... defining an entire group of people, their attitudes, pitfalls, and moral associations, based solely on their racial characteristics is itself a fairly good demonstration of racism.

~ DOUGLAS MURRAY, *The Madness of Crowds*

... the current way of regarding women is the same as men, but different where it's useful or flattering.

~ DOUGLAS MURRAY, *The Madness of Crowds*

[The concept of patriarchy] has become so ingrained that when it is mentioned it now floats by as though the idea that Western societies are centred around – and run solely for the comfort of – men is not even something that most people would bother to dispute.

~ DOUGLAS MURRAY, *The Madness of Crowds*

... if there is a bit more beheading and sexual assault than there used to be in Europe, then at least we also benefit from a much wider range of cuisines.

~ DOUGLAS MURRAY, *The Strange Death of Europe*

... on Bastille Day 2014, worshippers at a synagogue in Paris were barricaded inside by immigrant protesters chanting, among other things, “Death to the Jews”.

~ DOUGLAS MURRAY, *The Strange Death of Europe*

Asked whether he [Cat Stevens] would go to a demonstration where an effigy of Rushdie was being burnt, he replied, “I would have hoped that it would be the real thing.”

~ DOUGLAS MURRAY, *The Strange Death of Europe*

By 2015 Sweden had the highest level of rapes per capita of any country in the world after Lesotho.

~ DOUGLAS MURRAY, *The Strange Death of Europe*

Despite being illegal for three decades, and despite more than 130,000 women in Britain having suffered this barbaric treatment [of female genital mutilation], there still have been no successful persecutions of the crime.

~ DOUGLAS MURRAY, *The Strange Death of Europe*

This is why by 2015 more British Muslims were fighting for Isis than for the British Armed forces.

~ DOUGLAS MURRAY, *The Strange Death of Europe*

Thus the states that had been so open and liberal that they had allowed and encouraged large-scale migration were portrayed as countries which were uniquely racist.

~ DOUGLAS MURRAY, *The Strange Death of Europe*

What mainstream politicians and much of the media had in fact done, right up to and throughout the 2000s, was encourage a sense that the people in Europe who were shouting “fire” were the actual arsonists.

~ DOUGLAS MURRAY, *The Strange Death of Europe*

Within less than 24 hours Rushdie was in hiding, with protection provided by the British state. Soon thousands of British Muslims were on the streets supporting the imposition of Islamic blasphemy laws in Britain.

~ DOUGLAS MURRAY, *The Strange Death of Europe*

People began to talk of “equality”, but they did not seem to care about equal rights. They talked of “anti-racism”, but they sounded deeply racist. They spoke of “justice”, but they seemed to mean revenge.

~ DOUGLAS MURRAY, *The War on the West*

The bell in question was held under suspicion for having once been on a slave plantation, and so it was “shuttered off” from public view pending further investigations into the inanimate object. At such moments, you can begin to wonder whether we are getting into the realm of Narnia-like magic.

~ DOUGLAS MURRAY, *The War on the West*

This logical trap is the same one favored by witch-dunkers in the Middle Ages: if the woman drowns, she is innocent; if she floats, she’s a witch and can be burned. In DiAngelo’s logic, the person who denies they are a racist is racist, and so is the person who says they are racist.

~ DOUGLAS MURRAY, *The War on the West*

So pour some coffee, go outside, feel something enormous, stop.

~ CAROL MUSKE

On travaille pour vivre, et les arts deviennent des métiers.

~ ALFRED DE MUSSET, *André del Sarto*

Que de jeunes mains, pleines de force et de vie, reçoivent avec respect le flambeau sacré des mains tremblantes des vieillards! qu'ils la protègent du souffle des vents, cette flamme divine qui traversera les siècles futurs, comme elle a fait des siècles passés! À l'ouvrage! à l'ouvrage! la vie est si courte!

~ ALFRED DE MUSSET, *André del Sarto*

Je ne sais s'il y a une providence, mais c'est amusant d'y croire.

~ ALFRED DE MUSSET, *Fantasio*

Saint-Jean est mort? Le bouffon du roi est mort? Qui a pris sa place? le ministre de la justice?

~ ALFRED DE MUSSET, *Fantasio*

Un gentilhomme sans dettes ne saurait où se présenter.

~ ALFRED DE MUSSET, *Fantasio*

Un vide que je ne saurais exprimer et que je communique en vain à cette large coupe.

~ ALFRED DE MUSSET, *Les caprices de Marianne*

In and out of my heart flowed my rainbow blood.

~ VLADIMIR NABOKOV, *Lolita*

E mentre gli altri animali, con la faccia in basso, guardano in terra, Dio ha dato all'uomo una fronte rivolta verso l'alto, gli ha comandato di contemplare il cielo e di levare il volto verso gli astri.

~ PUBLIO OVIDIO NASONE

Americans no longer distinguish the phrase “you’re wrong” from “you’re stupid”. To disagree is to disrespect. To correct another is to insult.

~ TOM NICHOLS, *The Death of Expertise*

College students may not be dumber than they were thirty years ago, but their sense of entitlement and their unfounded self-confidence have grown considerably.

~ TOM NICHOLS, *The Death of Expertise*

The issue is not indifference to established knowledge; it’s the emergence of a positive *hostility* to such knowledge.

~ TOM NICHOLS, *The Death of Expertise*

To faculty everywhere, the lesson was obvious: the campus of a top university is not a place for intellectual exploration. It is a luxury home, rented for four to six years, nine months at a time, by children of the elite who may shout at faculty as if they’re berating clumsy maids in a colonial mansion.

~ TOM NICHOLS, *The Death of Expertise*

When feelings matter more than rationality or facts, education is a doomed enterprise. Emotion is an unassailable defense against expertise, a moat of anger and resentment in which reason and knowledge quickly drown. And when students learn that emotion trumps everything else, it is a lesson they will take with them for the rest of their lives.

~ TOM NICHOLS, *The Death of Expertise*

“Well,” the student said, “your guess is as good as mine.” [Robert] Jastrow stopped the young man short. “No, no, no” he said emphatically. “My guesses are much, *much* better than yours.”

~ TOM NICHOLS, *The Death of Expertise*

- I do not like it.
- Why?
- I am not up to it.

Has anyone ever answered like that?

~ FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE, *Beyond Good and Evil*

"Behold, I am disease." – thus speaks the evil deed; that is its honesty.

~ FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE, *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*

Life shrinks or expands in proportion to one's courage.

~ ANAÏS NIN, *Diary*, v.3

The young Americans show signs of total emotional atrophy.

~ ANAÏS NIN, *Diary*, v.3

There are only two kinds of freedom in the world: the freedom of the rich and powerful, and the freedom of the artist and the monk who renounce possessions.

~ ANAÏS NIN, *Diary*, v.3

"In my family", she said, "we did everything with enthusiasm. We even *died* with enthusiasm!"

~ ANAÏS NIN, *Diary*, v.3

The most tragic moment in human relationships is when we are given to see, accidentally, by a revealing word, or a moment of crisis, the image which the other carries within himself of us, and we catch a glimpse of a stranger, or a caricature of ourselves.

~ ANAÏS NIN, *Diary*, v.5

Galileo was not one of the great mathematical astronomers. He remained loyal to the circles used by Copernicus in planetary theory, and even in his *Dialogue Concerning the Two Chief World Systems* he made no reference to the elliptical orbits introduced by Kepler, although he certainly knew of Kepler's work.

~ JOHN NORTH, *Cosmos*

... when God created [the heavens], He impressed them with a certain quality and force of motion, just as He impressed terrestrial things with weight; it is just the same as a man building a clock and leaving it to run itself. [Written ca. 1360]

~ ORESME

Il avait sur lui un pantalon de poupée miniature qu'il enfilait sur deux doigts et faisait danser comme une marionnette sur le comptoir du café, à la grande joie d'une clientèle hétéroclite.

~ EDNA O'BRIEN, *James Joyce*

... they wildly reproached each other with bitter words and groundless accusations of bastardy and low birth ...

~ FLANN O'BRIEN, *At Swim-Two-Birds*

Blackheads are not so bad, said Furriskey. A good big boil on the back of your neck, that's the boy that will make you say your prayers at night. A boil is a fright. It's a fright now.

~ FLANN O'BRIEN, *At Swim-Two-Birds*

I poked him in a manner offensive to propriety and greeted his turned face with a facetious ejaculation: "How is the boy!", I said.

~ FLANN O'BRIEN, *At Swim-Two-Birds*

Take all that shall be brought upon thee, and keep patience, for gold and silver are tried in the fire, but acceptable men in the furnace of humiliation.

~ FLANN O'BRIEN, *At Swim-Two-Birds*

That, I answered, would be the chiefest wisdom.

~ FLANN O'BRIEN, *At Swim-Two-Birds*

The weather in the following March was cold, with snow and rain, and generally dangerous to persons of inferior vitality.

~ FLANN O'BRIEN, *At Swim-Two-Birds*

"It is true that I will not", said Finn MacCool.

~ FLANN O'BRIEN, *At Swim-Two-Birds*

Decolonisation is decivilisation. It is a purge. It is the purging of our institutions of the ideas and ideals that shaped our societies. It is a secular jihad.

~ BRENDAN O'NEILL, *After the Pogrom*

There were two eruptions of barbarism in October 2023. The first was Hamas's pogrom of 7 October, in which more than a thousand people were slaughtered and many others were maimed, raped, and kidnapped. The second was the sympathy for the pogrom across much of the Western world.

~ BRENDAN O'NEILL, *After the Pogrom*

In the Yank Mags you get real blood-lust, really gory descriptions of the all-in, jump-on-his-testicles style of fighting, written in a jargon that has been perfected by people who brood endlessly on violence.

~ GEORGE ORWELL, *Boys' Weeklies*

If there is really such a thing as turning in one's grave, Shakespeare must get a lot of exercise.

~ GEORGE ORWELL, *Drama Reviews*

As early as 1934 or 1935 it was considered eccentric in literary circles not to be more or less “left,” and in another year or two there had grown up a left-wing orthodoxy that made a certain set of opinions absolutely *de rigueur* on certain subjects.

~ GEORGE ORWELL, *Inside The Whale*

They can swallow totalitarianism *because* they have no experience of anything except liberalism.

~ GEORGE ORWELL, *Inside The Whale*

To abjure violence it is necessary to have no experience of it.

~ GEORGE ORWELL, *No, Not One*

The word *Fascism* has now no meaning except in so far as it signifies “something not desirable.”

~ GEORGE ORWELL, *Politics and the English Language*

A totalitarian state is in effect a theocracy, and its ruling caste, in order to keep its position, has to be thought of as infallible.

~ GEORGE ORWELL, *The Prevention of Literature*

It would probably not be beyond human ingenuity to write books by machinery.

~ GEORGE ORWELL, *The Prevention of Literature*

Masculinity is aggressive, unstable, combustible. It is also the most creative cultural force in history.

~ CAMILLE PAGLIA

At the end of [Heiseberg’s] first lecture [at age 24] one student reportedly said that one wouldn’t have believed he was so clever since he looked like a bright carpenter’s apprentice just returned from technical school.

~ ABRAHAM PAIS, *Niels Bohr*

In the very first sentence ever written on quantum mechanics, the abstract of Heisenberg's July 1925 paper, it was stated that "quantum mechanics should be founded exclusively upon relationships between quantities that are in principle observable."

~ ABRAHAM PAIS, *Niels Bohr*

Planck most probably first wrote down his law on the evening of Sunday 7 October 1900, as the result of new experimental information he received that day.

~ ABRAHAM PAIS, *Niels Bohr*

He's horrendously overqualified for this sort of work, having twice summited Everest. On one of those occasions he arrived at the top at 5.30 in the morning, so far ahead of the rest of the party that he lay down on top of Everest and fell asleep until they arrived. Now that is cool.

~ MICHAEL PALIN, *Himalaya*

... using the computer as an "object to think with".

~ SEYMOUR PAPERT, *Mindstorms*

Anything is easy if you can assimilate it to your collection of models. If you can't, anything can be painfully difficult.

~ SEYMOUR PAPERT, *Mindstorms*

But making good choices is not always easy, in part because past choices can often haunt us. I have called this phenomenon the QWERTY phenomenon.

~ SEYMOUR PAPERT, *Mindstorms*

First, relate what is new and to be learned to something you already know. Second, take what is new and make it your own: make something new with it, play with it, build with it.

~ SEYMOUR PAPERT, *Mindstorms*

I see “school math” as a social construction, a kind of QWERTY.

~ SEYMOUR PAPERT, *Mindstorms*

One might even say that computer science is wrongly so called. Most of it is not the science of computers, but the science of descriptions and descriptive languages.

~ SEYMOUR PAPERT, *Mindstorms*

Stated most succinctly, my conjecture is that the computer can concretize (and personalize) the formal.

~ SEYMOUR PAPERT, *Mindstorms*

Dr. Budlong bore a chilling resemblance to the mummified remains of Ramses II.

~ S. J. PERELMAN, *The Road to Miltdown*

He is in his mid-sixties, ramrod-straight, affects a white cavalry moustache and a buttonhole, and is well-dressed to the point of dandyism.

~ S. J. PERELMAN, *The Road to Miltdown*

Scene: ... a small cheerless room equipped with the standard instruments of torture – a desk, two chairs, a filing cabinet.

~ S. J. PERELMAN, *The Road to Miltdown*

The light of the bar was too dim to determine whether their lingerie had come from Bendel’s or Bonwit’s, but everything proclaimed them to be women not visibly harassed by the specter of want.

~ S. J. PERELMAN, *The Road to Miltdown*

The mood of the quartet was distinctly festive; tongues loosened by copious draughts of loganberry cocktails, their flushed cheeks and sparkling eyes marked them incontrovertibly as devotees of Bacchus.

~ S. J. PERELMAN, *The Road to Miltdown*

Then, out of the blue, Alec Fragonard, who played second leper in the road company of *Father Damien's Chickens* last season ...

~ S. J. PERELMAN, *The Road to Miltdown*

Though hardly the comeliest girl in the class, Celia possessed a figure so voluptuous that it addled every male within a radius of fifty feet.

~ S. J. PERELMAN, *The Road to Miltdown*

But are not all the finest works of nature common property? The sun shines upon all men. The Moon with countless troops of stars in her train leads even the beasts to their food. Can we imagine anything more lovely than water? Yet it flows for all the world.

~ PETRONIUS, *Satyricon*

For if you let two weights fall from the same height, one of them being many times heavier than the other, you will see that the times required for the motion are not in proportion dependent on the ratio of their weights, but that the actual difference in time is very small. [6th cent.]

~ PHILOPONAS THE BYZANTINE

... the woof and warp of all thought and research is symbols, and the life of thought and science is the life inherent in symbols; so it is wrong to say that a good language is important to good thought, merely; for it is the essence of it.

~ CHARLES PIERCE

Non desiderare, anima mia, la vita degli immortali, ma godi a fondo i beni alla tua portata.

~ PINDARO

Sogno di un'ombra è l'uomo.

~ PINDARO

When one person suffers from a delusion, it is called insanity.
When many people suffer from a delusion it is called Religion.

~ R. M. PIRSIG, *Zen and the Art of Motorcycle Maintenance*

During the [French] Revolution, we dared not scold our children for their faults. Those who called themselves patriots regarded it as against the fundamental principles of liberty to correct children. This made these so unruly that very often, when a parent presumed to scold his child, the latter would tell him to mind his own business, adding, "We are free and equal; the Republic is our only father, and no other."

~ ANNE PLUMPTRE

Gli Spartani non chiedono quanti sono i nemici, ma dove si trovano.

~ PLUTARCO

... out of joy is sorrow born. Either the memory of past bliss is the anguish of to-day, or the agonies which *are* have their origin in the ecstasies which *might have been*.

~ EDGAR ALLAN POE

... the play is the tragedy, "Man", and its hero the Conqueror Worm.

~ EDGAR ALLAN POE

... which confined me within the coffin, which deposited me within the hearse, which bore me to the grave, which lowered me within it, which heaped heavily the mould upon me, and which thus left me, in blackness and corruption, to my sad and solemn slumbers with the worm.

~ EDGAR ALLAN POE

Among other ideas, that of universal equality gained ground; and in the face of analogy and of God – in despite of the loud warning voice of the laws of gradation so visibly pervading all things in Earth and Heaven – wild attempts at an omni-prevalent Democracy were made.

~ EDGAR ALLAN POE

For example, there are few men of extraordinary profundity who are found wanting in an inclination for the bottle.

~ EDGAR ALLAN POE

I stood petrified with horror and rage. I endeavoured to reply, but my tongue refused its office.

~ EDGAR ALLAN POE

It was a night of unusual gloom.

~ EDGAR ALLAN POE

The thousand injuries of Fortunato I had borne as I best could, but when he ventured upon insult I vowed revenge.

~ EDGAR ALLAN POE

Another amusement consisted of breaking into a Jewish apartment or house and forcing young and old to undress and dance, arm in arm, to the sound of a phonograph. Following this with rape was optional, as one risked being tried for the “crime of race defilement”. Staider spirits, combining business and pleasure, seized pedestrian Jewesses in the street in order to make them clean their quarters or barracks (business) with the victim’s underwear (pleasure).

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *Harvest of Hate*

The [Allied] bombardment of the death factories, which was an easy operation to carry out and would have thrown the entire extermination machinery into confusion, was never permitted, although the Jewish organizations many times requested that it be done.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *Harvest of Hate*

The “Jewish question” continued to be the principal theme of Nazi propaganda. No Nazi leader could open his mouth in public without expatiating on this inexhaustible subject.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *Harvest of Hate*

[At Auschwitz,] the clothing or baggage they had been able to bring filled the thirty-five warehouses of the “Canada” – the nickname the prisoners gave this area of the camp had been picked up by the SS themselves.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *Harvest of Hate*

[Euphemisms for the murder camps] One is inclined to see it as a real exercise in magic, an attempt to influence things (to make the obscene innocuous and even noble) by manipulating words.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *Harvest of Hate*

[The Dutch] perhaps in all of Europe resisted the Germans the most.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *Harvest of Hate*

“I would have considered it contrary to my dignity not to make this brief and useless declaration.” [Marc Hagueneau, letter]

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *Harvest of Hate*

Georg von Schonerer drew his support [for anti-Semitism] mainly from students.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism (IV)*

“... it seems quite surprising to notice, under identical social conditions, differences as strange as the intellectual inertia of the Russian poor, whose eyes wander, dull and lifeless, and the restless curiosity of the Jewish adolescent. We observed them for the 36 hours we traveled in steerage from Kiev to Gomel: the wretched muzhik on one side, exchanging rare interjections and frequent shoves, and on the other, the Jews in pitiful rags, talking, discussing, reading.” [a French traveler in Russia]

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism (IV)*

“He was from the city rather than from the country, indifferent if not hostile to the Church rather than devoutly Christian, from the educated rather than the ignorant classes. The most virulent forms of anti-Semitism were propagated by teachers, students, office workers, minor bureaucrats, and secretaries of various organizations, ‘reform-of-life’ movements, vegetarians, antivivisectionists, back-to-nature cults.”

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism (IV)*

“Only 100,000 Jews live in the midst of 36 million Frenchmen, and they always rank first in high school. Fourteen of them in the Ecole Normale had won first place. It was necessary to reduce the number of those eligible to take public examinations.”

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism (IV)*

... accusations of ritual murder or of profanation of the Host gradually replaced the Crusades as a pretext for mass exterminations.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

... in 1491 the Inquisition discovered that he had Judaized after his baptism, condemned him *post obitum* [he had died around 1460], and caused his bones to be burned.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

... in 1558 that the situation worsened and Spain became a sort of totalitarian country.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

... the new municipality found nothing more pressing to do than to imprison all the Jews, numbering some two thousand, and to burn them the next day in their own cemetery (February 14, 1349), while their property was distributed among the city residents. These massacres and lootings took place in the great majority of German cities. [Epidemic in the 1300s]

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

... when the persecution of humanists began in Spain, the son of the Inquisitor General Manrique wrote to his famous friend Luis Vives: "For now it is clear that [in Spain] one cannot possess any culture without being suspected of heresy, error, and Judaism. Thus silence has been imposed on the learned [and] they have been filled with great terror."

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

A foreign observer, the Frenchman Pierre de Froissart, best summarized the general opinion, noting: "Hatred of the Jews is so common in Germany that the most peaceful men become agitated when it is a question of the Jews and their usury."

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

As one of them, Paramo [an inquisitor] observed proudly in 1404, the Holy Office had already burned over thirty thousand witches.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

Emicho and all his men, having taken counsel, proceeded at sunrise to attack the Jews with lances and axes. Having broken the locks and knocked in the doors, they seized and killed seven hundred who vainly sought to defend themselves against forces far superior to their own; the women were also massacred, and the young children, whatever their sex, were put to the sword. The Jews, seeing the Christians rise as enemies against them and their children, with no respect for the weakness of age, took arms in turn against their coreligionists, against their wives, their children, their mothers, and their sisters, and massacred their own. A horrible thing to tell of – the mothers seized the sword and cut the throats of the children at their breast, choosing to destroy themselves at their own hands rather than succumb to the blows of the uncircumcised! [Mainz, 1096]

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

Few dates are as important in Western history as that of November 27, 1095, when, at the council of Clermont-Ferrand, Pope Urban II undertook to preach the First Crusade.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

For nearly half a century the Inquisition's activities were limited almost entirely to the struggle against Judaism.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

Importation and possession of prohibited books became a crime punishable by death.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

In the course of the summer of 1321 a rumor arose in Aquitaine alleging that a dreadful conspiracy had been plotted by the lepers and the Jews to put all Christians to death by poisoning their wells and springs.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

Inquisitorial procedure insisted on the victim's confession. Torture, euphemistically called "the question", – continued sometimes for weeks and months, sometimes for several days in a row, sometimes with long interruptions – infallibly obtained these confessions, as precise and detailed as the inquisitor insisted they be.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

Leading an austere life and singing hymns, the "flagellants" traveled throughout Germany and even into France, and their public exhibitions, acclaimed by the populace, generally terminated in a massacre of the Jews.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

On their clothing they sewed the sign of the Cross. Whatever they did, eternal felicity had been promised them; they were God's avengers, appointed to punish all infidels, whoever they might be.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

One contemporary Christian chronicler declares that nearly one hundred thousand Jews were massacred at this time [1250–1300]; such a figure cannot be greatly exaggerated, for we have lists of several thousand victims.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

The Christian apologist Al Kindy challenged the Moslems even more aggressively: "Judge for yourselves, if your master was a prophet just as you claim. For is it the business of prophets to arm patrols and gangs to seize the goods of other men? Why did your master not leave this profession to thieves and highwaymen?"

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

The Devil's agent on earth is the witch (and not the wizard, who is only burned in exceptional circumstances). The contempt for woman, the fear and horror of temptation and the blandishments of the sex, contrast with the adoration of the Virgin and the cult of chastity.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

The first known trial for witchcraft occurred in 1335 in Toulouse.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

The massacres of the First Crusade were to leave an indelible imprint on Jewish memory, a kind of collective trauma.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

This piece of crude and rough cloth [the *sambenitos*, or “garments of shame”], decorated with various emblems (most often the cross of St. Andrew, but in the case of those condemned to death the devils of hell), was something the “reconciled” penitent had to wear on certain days or for his whole life, according to the sentence.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

To massacre first, and then, from fear of revenge, to accuse afterward; to attribute to the victims one's own aggressive intentions; to impute to them one's own cruelty: from century to century, under various disguises, this is the device we find.

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

“... he immediately advised me to go out every morning from now on, since there were individuals in charge of watching foreigners and verifying if they went to Mass.”

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

“An inhabitant of Asia, who should chance to arrive at Madrid the day of such an execution,” wrote Voltaire, “would not be able to determine whether it was a rejoicing, a religious ceremony, a sacrifice, or a butchery; and it is indeed all these together. Montezuma has been reproached with sacrificing the captives taken in war to his gods; but what would you have said if he had been at an auto-da-fé?”

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

“In Spain,” wrote a Franciscan in 1586, “there is not so much infamy in being a blasphemer, robber, vagabond, adulterer, sacrilegious person or in being infected with any vice as in having descended from the line of the Jews, even if one’s ancestors had been converted for two or three hundred years to the holy Catholic faith.”

~ LÉON POLIAKOV, *The History of Anti-Semitism*

All that has happened is that the public has adjusted to incoherence and been amused into indifference. Which is why Aldous Huxley would not in the least be surprised by the story. Indeed, he prophesized its coming. He believed that it is far more likely that the Western democracies will dance and dream themselves into oblivion than march into it, single file and manacled. Huxley grasped, as Orwell did not, that it is not necessary to conceal anything from a public insensible to contradiction and narcotized by technological diversions. Although Huxley did not specify that television would be our main line to the drug, he would have no difficulty accepting Robert MacNeil’s observation that “television is the soma of Aldous Huxley’s *Brave New World*”. Big Brother turns out to be Howdy Doody.

~ NEIL POSTMAN, *Amusing Ourselves To Death*

In Huxley's vision, no Big Brother is required to deprive people of their autonomy, maturity, and history. As he saw it, people will come to love their oppression, to adore the technologies that undo their capacities to think.

~ NEIL POSTMAN, *Amusing Ourselves To Death*

In the Huxleyan prophecy, Big Brother does not watch us, by his choice; we watch him, by ours. There is no need for wardens, or gates or Ministries of Truth. When a population becomes distracted by trivia, when cultural life is redefined as a perpetual round of entertainments, when serious public conversation becomes a form of baby-talk, then culture-death is a clear possibility.

~ NEIL POSTMAN, *Amusing Ourselves To Death*

The problem is not that television presents us with entertaining subject matter, but that all subject matter is presented as entertaining, which is another issue entirely.

~ NEIL POSTMAN, *Amusing Ourselves To Death*

Think of Richard Nixon, or Jimmy Carter, or Billy Graham, or even Albert Einstein, and what will come to your mind is an image, a picture of face, most likely a face on a television screen (in Einstein's case, a photograph of a face). Of words, nothing will come to mind. This is the difference between thinking in a word-centered culture and thinking in an image-centered culture.

~ NEIL POSTMAN, *Amusing Ourselves To Death*

I am constantly amazed at how obediently people accept explanations that begin with the words "the computer shows" or "the computer has determined" It is Technopoly's equivalent of the sentence "It is God's will.", and the effect is roughly the same.

~ NEIL POSTMAN, *Technopoly*

I will go further: in Technopoly, all experts are invested with the charisma of priestliness.

~ NEIL POSTMAN, *Technopoly*

It's a world in which the idea of human progress, as Bacon expressed it, has been replaced by the idea of technological progress.

~ NEIL POSTMAN, *Technopoly*

Technopoly is a state of culture. It is also a state of mind. It consists in the deification of technology, which means that the culture seeks its authorization in technology, and takes its orders from technology.

~ NEIL POSTMAN, *Technopoly*

... des principes égalitaires de 1789 elle ne réclamait qu'un droit du citoyen, celui de ne pas prononcer comme nous et de maintenir qu'hôtel, été et air étaient du genre féminin.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Albertine disparue*

Car il y a dans ce monde où tout s'use, où tout périt, une chose qui tombe en ruines, qui se détruit encore plus complètement, en laissant encore moins de vestiges que la Beauté: c'est le Chagrin.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Albertine disparue*

Jamais je ne retrouverais cette chose divine: un être avec qui je pusse causer de tout, à qui je pusse me confier.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Albertine disparue*

Laissons les jolies femmes aux hommes sans imagination.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Albertine disparue*

Notre amour de la vie n'est qu'une vieille liaison dont nous ne savons pas nous débarrasser. Sa force est dans sa permanence. Mais la mort qui la rompt nous guérira du désir de l'immortalité.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Albertine disparue*

Nous voyons, nous entendons, nous concevons le monde tout de travers. Cette perpétuelle erreur, qui est précisément la «vie», ne donne pas ses mille formes seulement à l'univers visible et à l'univers audible, mais à l'univers social, à l'univers sentimental, à l'univers historique, etc.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Albertine disparue*

Car l'un ne voulait pas d'un sucre d'orge rouge parce qu'il préférerait le violet et l'autre, les larmes aux yeux, refusait une prune que voulait lui acheter sa bonne, parce que, finit-il par dire d'une voix passionnée: «J'aime mieux, l'autre prune, parce qu'elle a un ver!»

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Du côté du chez Swann*

Chose étrange que ces mots «deux ou trois fois», rien que des mots, des mots prononcés dans l'air, à distance, puissent ainsi déchirer le coeur comme s'ils le touchaient véritablement, puissent rendre malade, comme un poison qu'on absorberait.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Du côté du chez Swann*

Dire que j'ai gâché des années de ma vie, que j'ai voulu mourir, que j'ai eu mon plus grand amour, pour une femme qui ne me plaisait pas, qui n'était pas mon genre!

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Du côté du chez Swann*

Il se taisait, il regardait mourir leur amour.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Du côté du chez Swann*

Je vis si résolument en dehors des contingences physiques que mes sens ne prennent pas la peine de me les notifier.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Du côté du chez Swann*

Quand d'un passé ancien rien ne subsiste, après la mort des êtres, après la destruction des choses seules, plus frêles mais plus vivaces, plus immatérielles, plus persistantes, plus fidèles, l'odeur et la saveur restent encore longtemps, comme des âmes, à se rappeler, à attendre, à espérer, sur la ruine de tout le reste, à porter sans fléchir, sur leur gouttelette presque impalpable, l'édifice immense du souvenir.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Du côté du chez Swann*

Quand, plus tard, j'ai eu l'occasion de rencontrer, au cours de ma vie, dans des couvents par exemple, des incarnations vraiment saintes de la charité active, elles avaient généralement un air allègre, positif, indifférent et brusque de chirurgien pressé, ce visage où ne se lit aucune commisération, aucun attendrissement devant la souffrance humaine, aucune crainte de la heurter, et qui est le visage sans douceur, le visage antipathique et sublime de la vraie bonté.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Du côté du chez Swann*

Un petit coup au carreau, comme si quelque chose l'avait heurté, suivi d'une ample chute légère comme de grains de sable qu'on eût laissé tomber d'une fenêtre au-dessus, puis la chute s'étendant, se réglant, adoptant un rythme, devenant fluide, sonore, musicale, innombrable, universelle: c'était la pluie.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Du côté du chez Swann*

... comme on fait du téléphone, instrument surnaturel devant les miracles duquel on s'émerveillait jadis, et dont on se sert maintenant sans même y penser, pour faire venir son tailleur ou commander une glace.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *La prisonnière*

... l'Ange écarlate du matin ...

~ MARCEL PROUST, *La prisonnière*

... pour aviser au plus vite, j'essayai de téléphoner à Andrée; je me saisis du récepteur, j'invoquai les divinités implacables, mais ne fis qu'exciter leur fureur qui se traduisit par ces mots: «Pas libre.»

~ MARCEL PROUST, *La prisonnière*

... une montagne de néant ...

~ MARCEL PROUST, *La prisonnière*

C'est terrible d'avoir la vie d'une autre personne attachée a la sienne comme une bombe qu'on tiendrait sans qu'on puisse la lâcher sans crime.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *La prisonnière*

J'appelle ici amour une torture réciproque.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *La prisonnière*

La curiosité amoureuse est comme celle qu'excitent en nous les noms de pays; toujours déçue, elle renaît et reste toujours insatiable.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *La prisonnière*

Le seul véritable voyage, le seul bain de Jouvence, ce ne serait pas d'aller vers de nouveaux paysages, mais d'avoir d'autres yeux, de voir l'univers avec les yeux d'un autre, de cent autres, de voir les cent univers que chacun d'eux voit, que chacun d'eux est; et cela, nous le pouvons avec un Elstir, avec un Vinteuil; avec leurs pareils, nous volons vraiment d'étoiles en étoiles.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *La prisonnière*

Quand elle dormait, je n'avais plus à parler, je savais que je n'étais plus regardé par elle, je n'avais plus besoin de vivre à la surface de moi-même.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *La prisonnière*

Quand je vous mens, c'est toujours par amitié pour vous.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *La prisonnière*

Qu'y a-t-il de plus poétique que Xerxès, fils de Darius, faisant fouetter de verges la mer qui avait englouti ses vaisseaux?

~ MARCEL PROUST, *La prisonnière*

Tantôt, par des jours irrémédiablement mauvais, disait-on, rien que la résidence dans la maison, située au milieu d'une pluie égale et continue, avait la glissante douceur, le silence calmant, l'intérêt d'une navigation; une autre fois, par un jour clair, en restant immobile dans mon lit, c'était laisser tourner les ombres autour de moi comme d'un tronc d'arbre.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *La prisonnière*

... après avoir poussé un léger soupir, elle se contenta de manifester de la nullité de l'impression que lui produisaient la vue de l'historien et la mienne en exécutant certains mouvements des ailes du nez avec une précision qui attestait l'inertie absolue de son attention désœuvrée.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le côté de Guermantes*

... il est bien rare qu'un d'entre nous ait le toupet de son originalité et ne mette pas son application à ressembler aux modèles les plus vantés.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le côté de Guermantes*

Au pied du lit, convulsée par tous les souffles de cette agonie, ne pleurant pas mais par moments trempée de larmes, ma mère avait la désolation sans pensée d'un feuillage que cingle la pluie et retourne le vent.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le côté de Guermantes*

Ce n'était pas «Rachel quand du Seigneur» qui me semblait peu de chose, c'était la puissance de l'imagination humaine, l'illusion sur laquelle reposaient les douleurs de l'amour, que je trouvais grandes.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le côté de Guermantes*

C'est la terrible tromperie de l'amour qu'il commence par nous faire jouer avec une femme non du monde extérieur, mais avec une poupée intérieure à notre cerveau.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le côté de Guermantes*

Et comme l'habitude est, de toutes les plantes humaines, celle qui a le moins besoin de sol nourricier pour vivre et qui apparaît la première sur le roc en apparence le plus désolé.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le côté de Guermantes*

La vérité est que je n'appartiens guère à cette Terre où je me sens si exilé; il faut toute la force de la loi de gravitation pour m'y maintenir et que je ne m'évade pas dans une autre sphère.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le côté de Guermantes*

Les Courvoisier se faisaient de l'intelligence une idée moins favorable et, pour peu qu'on ne fût pas de leur monde, être intelligent n'était pas loin de signifier «avoir probablement assassiné père et mère».

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le côté de Guermantes*

L'amour? Je le fais souvent mais je n'en parle jamais.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le côté de Guermantes*

Nous sentons dans un monde, nous pensons, nous nommons dans un autre, nous pouvons entre les deux établir une concordance mais non combler l'intervalle.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le côté de Guermantes*

... la mort de millions d'inconnus nous chatouille à peine et presque moins désagréablement qu'un courant d'air. Mme Verdurin, souffrant pour ses migraines de ne plus avoir de croissant à tremper dans son café au lait, avait obtenu de Cottard une ordonnance qui lui permettait de s'en faire faire dans certain restaurant dont nous avons parlé. Cela avait été presque aussi difficile à obtenir des pouvoirs publics que la nomination d'un général. Elle reprit son premier croissant le matin où les journaux narraient le naufrage du Lusitania. Tout en trempant le croissant dans le café au lait et donnant des pichenettes à son journal pour qu'il pût se tenir grand ouvert sans qu'elle eût besoin de détourner son autre main des trempettes, elle disait : «Quelle horreur! Cela dépasse en horreur les plus affreuses tragédies.» Mais la mort de tous ces noyés ne devait lui apparaître que réduite au milliardième, car tout en faisant, la bouche pleine, ces réflexions désolées, l'air qui surnageait sur sa figure, amené probablement là par la saveur du croissant, si précieux contre la migraine, était plutôt celui d'une douce satisfaction.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le temps retrouvé*

... le sens artistique, c'est-à-dire la soumission à la réalité intérieure.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le temps retrouvé*

... un être est tant d'êtres différents selon les personnes qui le jugent, en dehors même des différences de jugement.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le temps retrouvé*

Ainsi tourne la Roue du Monde.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le temps retrouvé*

Car je comprenais que mourir n'était pas quelque chose de nouveau, mais qu'au contraire depuis mon enfance j'étais déjà mort bien des fois.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le temps retrouvé*

Depuis le jour de l'escalier, rien du monde, aucun bonheur, qu'il vînt de l'amitié des gens, des progrès de mon oeuvre, de l'espérance de la gloire, ne parvenait plus à moi que comme un si pâle soleil qu'il n'avait plus la vertu de me réchauffer, de me faire vivre, de me donner un désir quelconque, et encore était-il trop brillant, si blême qu'il fût, pour mes yeux qui préféraient se fermer, et je me retournais du côté du mur.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le temps retrouvé*

Il y avait certes, maintenant comme alors, la splendeur antique inchangée d'une lune cruellement, mystérieusement sereine, qui versait aux monuments encore intacts l'inutile beauté de sa lumière.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le temps retrouvé*

J'avais trop expérimenté l'impossibilité d'atteindre dans la réalité ce qui était au fond de moi-même.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le temps retrouvé*

Le devoir et la tache d'un écrivain sont ceux d'un traducteur.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le temps retrouvé*

Là où je cherchais les grandes lois, on m'appelait fouilleur de détails.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le temps retrouvé*

Mais comme chaque fois que je me trouvais arraché à mes habitudes, sorti à une autre heure, dans un lieu nouveau, j'éprouvais un vif plaisir.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le temps retrouvé*

Ça me faisait toujours penser au vers de Victor Hugo: «Emporte le bonheur et laisse-moi l'ennui.»

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Le temps retrouvé*

Blottie toute seule derrière elle, une pauvre petite étoile allait servir d'unique compagne à la lune solitaire, tandis que celle-ci, tout en protégeant son amie, mais plus hardie et allant de l'avant, brandirait comme une arme irrésistible, comme un symbole oriental, son ample et merveilleux croissant d'or.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Sodome et Gomorrhe*

Car l'instinct d'imitation et l'absence de courage gouvernent les sociétés comme les foules.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Sodome et Gomorrhe*

Cependant l'aviateur sembla hésiter sur sa voie; je sentais ouvertes devant lui – devant moi, si l'habitude ne m'avait pas fait prisonnier – toutes les routes de l'espace, de la vie.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Sodome et Gomorrhe*

Il est mort! Mais non, on exagère, on exagère!

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Sodome et Gomorrhe*

Il voyait le peu qu'on pouvait attendre des affections humaines, il s'y était résigné.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Sodome et Gomorrhe*

Sans doute parlait-il ainsi par mécontentement de ne pas être invité, et aussi à cause de la satisfaction qu'ont les hommes «occupés» – fût-ce par le travail le plus sot – de «ne pas avoir le temps» de faire ce que vous faites.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Sodome et Gomorrhe*

Vous êtes plutôt bizarroïde dans vos renseignements, mon cher!

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Sodome et Gomorrhe*

... as will exert a benign influence on the mind by giving it a hankering for impossible journeys through the realms of time.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Swann's Way*

... this woman whose reputation for beauty, misconduct and elegance was universal.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Swann's Way*

An hour or so later he received a note from Odette, and at once recognized that large handwriting in which an affectation of British stiffness imposed an apparent discipline upon ill-formed characters, suggestive, perhaps, to less biased eyes than his, of an untidiness of mind, a fragmentary education, or a want of sincerity and will-power.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Swann's Way*

But the harshness of his steely gaze was compensated by the softness of his cotton gloves, so that, as he approached Swann, he seemed to be exhibiting at once an utter contempt for his person and the most tender regard for his hat.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Swann's Way*

He could not explore the idea further, for a sudden access of that mental lethargy which was, with him, congenital, intermittent and providential, happened at that moment to extinguish every particle of light in his brain.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Swann's Way*

Let's hope she'll refuse. Good God! Think of listening to Wagner for a whole fortnight with a woman who takes about as much interest in music as a tone-deaf newt – that would be fun!

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Swann's Way*

Sir, I am absolutely incapable of telling you whether it has rained. I live so resolutely apart from physical contingencies that my senses no longer trouble to inform me of them.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Swann's Way*

Swann speedily recovered his sense of the general ugliness of the human male when, on the other side of the tapestry curtain, the spectacle of the servants gave place to that of the guests.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Swann's Way*

The fault I find with our journalism is that it forces us to take an interest in some fresh triviality or other every day, whereas only three of four books in a lifetime give us anything that is of real importance.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Swann's Way*

Verdurin! What a name! Oh, it must be said that they're perfect specimens of their disgusting kind! Thank God, it was high time that I stopped condescending to promiscuous intercourse with such infamy, such dung.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Swann's Way*

With the result that he came to regret every pleasure that he tasted in her company, every new caress of which he had been so imprudent as to point out to her the delights, every fresh charm that he found in her, for he knew that, a moment later, they would go to enrich the collection of instruments in his torture chamber.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *Swann's Way*

... I was not really there; my mind stayed behind somewhere else and sent mere Habit to take its place.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *The Guermantes Way*

And, indeed, I ought to have guessed this from her way of smiling, for I had already observed this sort of behavior when I saw the Princess of Luxembourg buying rye-bread rolls on the beach in Balbec to give to my grandmother, as though to a deer at the zoo.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *The Guermantes Way*

Interesting place, Morocco. I could tell you a lot about it. Some very decent fellows out there. Mental equals and all that.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *The Guermantes Way*

The Courvoisiers had a less exalted notion of intelligence, and unless one belonged to their world, being intelligent came close to meaning “having probably murdered one’s parents”.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *The Guermantes Way*

... la permanence et la durée ne sont promises à rien, pas même à la douleur.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *À l'ombre des jeunes filles en fleurs*

Comment s’appelle-t-il, cet ostrogoth-là, me demandait Albertine.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *À l'ombre des jeunes filles en fleurs*

Elle était de ces femmes à qui c’est un si grand plaisir de serrer la main qu’on est reconnaissant à la civilisation d’avoir fait du shake-hand un acte permis entre jeunes gens et jeunes filles qui s’abordent.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *À l'ombre des jeunes filles en fleurs*

Et dès ce premier matin le soleil me désignait au loin, d’un doigt souriant, ces cimes bleues de la mer qui n’ont de nom sur aucune carte géographique, jusqu’à ce qu’étourdi de sa sublime promenade à la surface retentissante et chaotique de leurs crêtes et de leurs avalanches, il vînt se mettre à l’abri du vent dans ma chambre, se prélassant sur le lit défait et égrenant ses richesses sur le lavabo mouillé, dans la malle ouverte, où par sa splendeur même et son luxe déplacé, il ajoutait encore à l’impression du désordre.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *À l'ombre des jeunes filles en fleurs*

Et je me lassai d'attendre, bien que quelques habituées fort humbles, soi-disant ouvrières, mais toujours sans travail, fussent venues me faire de la tisane et tenir avec moi une longue conversation à laquelle – malgré le sérieux des sujets traités – la nudité partielle ou complète de mes interlocutrices donnait une savoureuse simplicité.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *À l'ombre des jeunes filles en fleurs*

Il me fallut l'accompagner dans un petit pavillon treillisé de vert, assez semblable aux bureaux d'octroi désaffectés du vieux Paris, et dans lequel étaient depuis peu installés ce qu'on appelle en Angleterre un lavabo, et en France, par une anglomanie mal informée, des water-closets.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *À l'ombre des jeunes filles en fleurs*

J'appliquais à son visage rendu indécis par le crépuscule le masque de mes rêves les plus passionnés, mais lisais dans son regard tourné vers moi l'horreur de mon néant.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *À l'ombre des jeunes filles en fleurs*

La constante vision de ce bonheur imaginaire m'aidait à supporter la destruction du bonheur réel.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *À l'ombre des jeunes filles en fleurs*

Mais avant tout j'avais ouvert mes rideaux dans l'impatience de savoir qu'elle était la Mer qui jouait ce matin-là au bord du rivage, comme une Néréïde. Car chacune de ces Mers ne restait jamais plus qu'un jour. Le lendemain il y en avait une autre qui parfois lui ressemblait. Mais je ne vis jamais deux fois la même.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *À l'ombre des jeunes filles en fleurs*

Mais il ne me répondit pas, soit étonnement de mes paroles, attention à son travail, souci de l'étiquette, dureté de son ouïe, respect du lieu, crainte du danger, paresse d'intelligence ou consigne du directeur.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *À l'ombre des jeunes filles en fleurs*

On peut tout faire aux hommes qui vous aiment, ils sont idiots.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *À l'ombre des jeunes filles en fleurs*

Quand on aime, l'amour est trop grand pour pouvoir être contenu tout entier en nous; il irradie vers la personne aimée, rencontre en elle une surface qui l'arrête, le force à revenir vers son point de départ; et c'est ce choc en retour de notre propre tendresse que nous appelons les sentiments de l'autre et qui nous charme plus qu'à l'aller, parce que nous ne connaissons pas qu'elle vient de nous.

~ MARCEL PROUST, *À l'ombre des jeunes filles en fleurs*

Quoi, vous croyez qu'elle a un derrière bleu ciel comme les singes?

~ MARCEL PROUST, *À l'ombre des jeunes filles en fleurs*

... I discovered that it *was* a decanter. Into this you may put a quart of ruby-coloured laudanum; that, and a book of German metaphysics placed by its side, will sufficiently attest to my being in the neighbourhood.

~ THOMAS DE QUINCEY, *Confessions of an English Opium-Eater*

... I do not readily believe that any man, having once tasted the divine luxuries of opium, will afterwards descend to the gross and mortal enjoyments of alcohol.

~ THOMAS DE QUINCEY, *Confessions of an English Opium-Eater*

... in fact, there was nobody at all, except one woman, apparently middle-aged, meaning by *that* from thirty-five to forty-five.

~ THOMAS DE QUINCEY, *Confessions of an English Opium-Eater*

But at present the whole artillery of her displeasure seemed to be unmasked.

~ THOMAS DE QUINCEY, *Confessions of an English Opium-Eater*

For tea, though ridiculed by those who are naturally coarse in their nervous sensibilities, or are become so from wine-drinking, and are not susceptible of influence from so refined a stimulant, will always be the favourite beverage of the intellectual.

~ THOMAS DE QUINCEY, *Confessions of an English Opium-Eater*

He still had his dying to do: he was in arrear as to *that*: else all was finished.

~ THOMAS DE QUINCEY, *Confessions of an English Opium-Eater*

Here opens upon me an Iliad of woes.

~ THOMAS DE QUINCEY, *Confessions of an English Opium-Eater*

... the preliminary task of unteaching is harder than that of teaching.

~ QUINTILIAN, *Institutio Oratorio*

Again it frequently happens that the more learned the teacher, the more lucid and intelligible is his instruction. For clearness is the first virtue of eloquence. Consequently the worse a teacher is, the harder he will be to understand.

~ QUINTILIAN, *Institutio Oratorio*

But such practices have disappeared into the limbo of absurdities.

~ QUINTILIAN, *Institutio Oratorio*

If therefore we have received no fairer gift from heaven than speech, what shall we regard as so worthy of laborious cultivation, or in what should we sooner desire to excel our fellow-men, than that in which humanity excels all other living things?

~ QUINTILIAN, *Institutio Oratorio*

It has always, therefore, been my custom not to tie myself down to universal or general rules. For rules are rarely of such a kind that their validity cannot be shaken and overthrown in some particular or other.

~ QUINTILIAN, *Institutio Oratorio*

Style has three kinds of excellence: correctness, lucidity, and elegance.

~ QUINTILIAN, *Institutio Oratorio*

He estimated that around 30 percent of his comrades committed the offense [of rape, in the march of the Soviet Army into Germany].

~ LAURENCE REES, *Hitler and Stalin*

No one can ever know exactly how many women were raped by the Soviet conquerors. It's possible, however, that nearly two million women and girls in Germany alone endured this horror during the war and its immediate aftermath.

~ LAURENCE REES, *Hitler and Stalin*

"I think that real life is hunger, and the rest is a mirage," wrote the Leningrad scholar Dmitry Likhachev. "In the time of famine people revealed themselves, stripped themselves, freed themselves of all trumpery. Some turned out to be marvelous, incomparable heroes, others – scoundrels, villains, murderers, cannibals. There were no half measures."

~ LAURENCE REES, *Hitler and Stalin*

"Ninety-nine percent of the German people have turned off thinking for themselves," wrote civil servant Friedrich Kellner, a critic of the regime, in his diary in July 1940.

~ LAURENCE REES, *Hitler and Stalin*

“The hurricane of war has torn off these rags: now everyone has become what he was in fact, and not what he wanted to seem. Many have turned out to be pitiful cowards and scoundrels.”
[Diary of Elena Kochina, October 1941]

~ LAURENCE REES, *Hitler and Stalin*

“The overwhelming feeling besides the fear of death is the feeling of hunger. The feeling of hunger is such an overpowering feeling that it covers up any other feeling, any other human feelings; [you become] just like a dog who is looking for food.” [Israel Abelesz]

~ LAURENCE REES, *Hitler and Stalin*

Étendez-vous sur le sol, la nuit, loin des lumières. Fermez les yeux. Après quelques minutes, ouvrez-les sur la voûte étoilée. Vous aurez le vertige. Collé à la surface de votre vaisseau spatial, vous vous sentirez *dans* l'espace. Goutez-en longuement l'ivresse.

~ HUBERT REEVES, *Patience dans l'azur*

Facebook is a fusillade of vacation photos and cat miscellany, but a letter is a guided missile to one person's heart.

~ ELIZABETH RENZETTI

John Hughes-McNoughton, born into Westmount affluence, misplaced his moral compass years ago.

~ MORDECAI RICHLER, *Barney's Version*

Il faut être absolument moderne.

~ ARTHUR RIMBAUD, *Une saison en enfer*

L'ennui n'est plus mon amour.

~ ARTHUR RIMBAUD, *Une saison en enfer*

Depuis que je me cachais, je m'efforçais de donner à mes mains une couleur moins blanche, de peur qu'elles me fissent reconnaître; je les frottais souvent avec de la terre.

~ MME LA MARQUISE DE LA ROCHEJAQUELEIN, *Mémoires*

Les paysans ne manquaient guère à dire leurs prières avant d'entrer en combat, et presque tous faisaient un signe de croix à chaque coup qu'ils allaient tirer.

~ MME LA MARQUISE DE LA ROCHEJAQUELEIN, *Mémoires*

MM. de Feu et de Richeteau, qui, à la suite de quelques pourparlers, avaient la veille consenti à rester en otage, furent aussi massacrés. Des gardes nationales de la plaine retournèrent dans leurs foyers, emportant comme trophées, au bout de leurs baïonnettes, des nez, des oreilles et des lambeaux de chair humaine.

~ MME LA MARQUISE DE LA ROCHEJAQUELEIN, *Mémoires*

Madame de Jourdain fut menée sur la Loire pour être noyée avec ses trois filles: un soldat voulut sauver la plus jeune, qui était fort belle; elle se jeta à l'eau pour partager le sort de sa mère: la malheureuse enfant tomba sur des cadavres, et n'enfonça point; elle criait: «Poussez-moi! je n'ai pas assez d'eau!» et elle périt.

~ MME LA MARQUISE DE LA ROCHEJAQUELEIN, *Mémoires*

... madame de Roudé, par exemple, qui, malgré son âge, aimait encore à faire belle gorge, et portait toujours la sienne à découvert, excepté lorsqu'elle montait en voiture, ou qu'elle en descendait; car elle la cachait alors d'un grand mouchoir qu'elle tenait à sa poche dans cette intention, parce que, disait-elle, cela n'est pas fait pour montrer à des laquais.

~ MME ROLAND, *Mémoires*

A quatorze ans, comme aujourd'hui, j'avais environs cinq pieds; ma taille avait acquis toute sa croissance; la jambe bien faite, le pied bien posé, les hanches très-relevées; la poitrine large et superbement meublée.

~ MME ROLAND, *Mémoires*

Enfin, je ne me suis mariée qu'à vingt-cinq ans, et avec une ame telle qu'on peut la présumer, des sens très-inflammables, beaucoup d'instruction sur divers objets; j'avais si bien évité l'instruction sur certain autre, que les événemens du mariage me parurent aussi surprenans que désagréables.

~ MME ROLAND, *Mémoires*

I feel my resolution to pursue these memories deserting me. The miseries of my country torment me; an involuntary gloom penetrates my soul, chilling my imagination. France has become a vast Golgotha of carnage, an arena of horrors, where her children tear and destroy one another. Never can history paint these dreadful times, or the monsters that fill them with their barbarities. What Rome or Babylon ever equaled Paris?

~ MME ROLAND, *Mémoires*

Sous le tranquil abri du toit paternel, j'étais heureuse dès l'enfance avec des fleurs et des livres: dans l'étroite enceinte d'une prison, au milieu des fers imposés par la tyrannie la plus révoltante, j'oublie l'injustice des hommes, leurs sottises et mes maux, avec des livres et des fleurs.

~ MME ROLAND, *Mémoires*

«Mon père, je m'accuse ... – Eh bien!» Que dire après? Le coeur me battait, le feu me montait au visage; certaine sueur se répandait partout: «Je m'accuse ... d'avoir eu des mouvemens contraires à la chasteté chrétienne.» Ah! La bonne phrase!

~ MME ROLAND, *Mémoires*

And then, of course, my father is a man who has a certain amount of worrying to do each day, and sometimes he just has to forgo listening to the conversations going on around him in order to fulfill his anxiety requirement.

~ PHILIP ROTH, *Portnoy's Complaint*

“The Pumpkin”, is what I called her, in commemoration of her pigmentation and the size of her can.

~ PHILIP ROTH, *Portnoy's Complaint*

The New Puritans have made themselves into comic figures. They are the very portrait of fastidious busybodies. They are worthy of mockery. Mock them.

~ NOAH ROTHMAN, *The Rise of the New Puritans*

The statement that the universe has to have had this history in order for galaxies, stars, and ourselves to exist is verging on the tautological and hardly merits the title *anthropic principle* which some authors give it.

~ M. ROWAN-ROBINSON, *Cosmology*

... But standing now on the last verge of life,
 Boldy I view the vast abyss, eternity,
 Eager to plunge, and leave my woes behind me.

~ N. ROWE

Oh, glorious thought! By Heav'n I will enjoy it,
 Tho but in fancy; imagination shall
 Make room to entertain the vast idea.

~ N. ROWE, *Tamerlane*

Away! my soul disdains thy conference.

~ N. ROWE, *Tamerlane*

Don't turn your head. Keep looking at the bandaged place. That's where the light enters you.

~ RUMI

Let the beauty we love be what we do.

~ RUMI

Lovers don't finally meet somewhere. They're in each other all along.

~ RUMI

Open the window in the centre of your chest, and let the spirits fly in and out.

~ RUMI

People who insult me are only polishing the mirror.

~ RUMI

That broken-down lowliness is the reality, not the language!
Forget phraseology. I want burning, *burning!*

~ RUMI

The soul at dawn is like darkened water that slowly begins to say
"Thank you, thank you."

~ RUMI

Then death comes like dawn, and you wake up laughing at what
you thought was your grief.

~ RUMI

Whoever is served that cup keeps quiet.

~ RUMI

Why do you stay in prison, when the door is so wide open?

~ RUMI

Between 1948 and 1957, as a consequence of government pressure, economic strangulation, and physical pogroms, some 467,000 Jews would be compelled to flee their ancestral homes in Moslem lands. The largest number of them would find asylum in Israel.

~ HOWARD SACHAR, *A History of Israel*

In April and May [1948], entire Arab communities were fleeing in terror even before Jewish forces overran their homes. A Swiss observer, Jacques de Reynier, described the panic among the inhabitants of Jaffa when the Jews attacked: "Immediately everyone was consumed with terror, and soon the evacuation started. In the hospitals, the drivers of cars and ambulances took their vehicles, assembled their families, and fled in complete disregard of their responsibilities. Many of the ill, nurses, even physicians, departed the hospital wearing the clothes they had on, and fled to the countryside. For all of them the one obsession was to escape at any cost."

~ HOWARD SACHAR, *A History of Israel*

In March 1950, therefore, the Iraqi parliament gave official sanction to Jewish emigration, on condition that Jews applying for exit permits relinquish their Iraqi citizenship. As an inducement for departure, the government assured prospective immigrants that the homes, businesses, and bank accounts they left behind would be disposed of legally, and that eventually they would receive the proceeds. Yet on March 10, 1951, one day following the deadline for exit registration, the government suddenly announced that the property and bank accounts of emigrating Jews henceforth were forfeited to the government.

~ HOWARD SACHAR, *A History of Israel*

Indeed, as they turned to new modes of warfare, it became clear that they were obsessed above all with the advantages to be derived in casting a shadow in the world, from drawing attention to Palestine Arab identity.

~ HOWARD SACHAR, *A History of Israel*

Psychologically, most important of all, the Arabs simply could not bring themselves to admit defeat at the hands of the “Zionist gangs”. The Moslem tradition of jihad – of unceasing warfare against infidel interlopers – played a role here. Pride and self-esteem were equally critical factors, however. Once signed, the peace treaties would have been admission that the game was over. Azzam Pasha put the matter forthrightly: “We have a secret weapon which we can use better than guns and machine guns, and this is time. As long as we do not make peace with the Zionists, the war is not over; and as long as the war is not over, there is neither victor nor vanquished.”

~ HOWARD SACHAR, *A History of Israel*

... these are some of the things that hydrogen atoms do, given fifteen billion years of cosmic evolution.

~ CARL SAGAN, *Cosmos*

Our achievements rest on the accomplishments of 40,000 generations of our human predecessors, all but a tiny fraction of which are nameless and forgotten.

~ CARL SAGAN, *Cosmos*

Contented poverty is an honourable estate.

~ LUCIO ANNEO SENECA

Establish business relations with poverty.

~ LUCIO ANNEO SENECA

Insegnami che il bene della vita non consiste nella sua durata, ma nel suo uso.

~ LUCIO ANNEO SENECA

Un grande anima si esprime con più calma e serenità.

~ LUCIO ANNEO SENECA

Viviamo tra cose tutte destinate a morire.

~ LUCIO ANNEO SENECA

When Zeno received news of a shipwreck and heard that all his luggage had been sunk, he said, "Fortune bids me to be a less encumbered philosopher."

~ LUCIO ANNEO SENECA

Behaving with strangers in an emotionally satisfying way and yet remaining aloof from them was seen by the mid-18th century as the means by which the human animal was transformed into a social being.

~ RICHARD SENNETT, *The Fall of Public Man*

During the 19th century the family came to appear less and less the center of a particular, non-public region, more an idealized refuge, a world all its own, with a higher moral value than the public realm.

~ RICHARD SENNETT, *The Fall of Public Man*

Today, public life has also become a matter of formal obligation. Most citizens approach their dealings with the state in a spirit of resigned acquiescence, but this public enervation is in its scope much broader than political affairs. Manners and ritual interchanges with strangers are looked on as at best formal and dry, at worst as phony. The stranger himself is a threatening figure, and few people can take great pleasure in that world of strangers, the cosmopolitan city.

~ RICHARD SENNETT, *The Fall of Public Man*

Come; the croaking raven doth bellow for revenge.

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Hamlet*

O day and night, but this is wondrous strange!

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Hamlet*

What a piece of work is a man! How noble in reason! how infinite in faculties! in form and moving, how express and admirable! in action, how like an angel! in apprehension, how like a god! the beauty of the world! the paragon of animals! And yet, to me, what is this quintessence of dust?

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Hamlet*

Dwell I but in the suburbs of your good pleasure?

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Julius Caesar*

A plague upon your epileptic visage.

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *King Lear*

An admirable evasion of whoremaster man, to lay his goatish disposition to the charge of a star!

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *King Lear*

Canst thou not minister to a mind diseas'd
Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow,
Raze out the written troubles of the brain,
And with some sweet oblivious antidote
Cleanse the stuff'd bosom of that perilous stuff
Which weighs upon the heart?

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Macbeth*

Come, thick night, and pall thee in the dunnest smoke of hell.

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Macbeth*

Hath no man's dagger here a point for me?

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Much Ado About Nothing*

I must discontinue your company.

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Much Ado About Nothing*

O God, that I were a man! I would eat his heart in the market-place.

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Much Ado About Nothing*

O illegitimate construction! I scorn that with my heels.

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Much Ado About Nothing*

What, my dear Lady Disdain? Are you yet living?

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Much Ado About Nothing*

Chaos is come again.

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Othello*

I know a lady in Venice would have walked barefoot to Palestine for a touch of his nether lip.

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Othello*

But He that hath the steerage of my course
Direct my sail! On, lusty gentlemen.

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Romeo and Juliet*

Death lies upon her like an untimely frost
Upon the sweetest flower of the field

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Romeo and Juliet*

Earth has swallowed all my hopes but she ...

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Romeo and Juliet*

Is this the poultice for my aching bones?

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Romeo and Juliet*

O happy dagger! This is thy sheath; there rust, and let me die.

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Romeo and Juliet*

They are but beggars who can count their worth.

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *Romeo and Juliet*

... glad that you thus continue your resolve to suck the sweets of sweet philosophy.

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *The Taming of the Shrew*

No profit grows where is no pleasure tane; in brief, sir, study what you most affect.

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *The Taming of the Shrew*

... and thence retire me to my Milan, where every third thought shall be of my grave.

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *The Tempest*

O wonder! How many goodly creatures are there here! How beauteous mankind is! O brave new world that has such people in it!

~ WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *The Tempest*

The framework that modern natural philosophers preferred to Aristotelian teleology was one that explicitly modelled nature on the characteristics of a *machine*.

~ STEVEN SHAPIN, *The Scientific Revolution*

The machine metaphor might, then, be a vehicle for “taking the wonder out” of our understanding of nature or, as the sociologist Max Weber put it in the early twentieth century, for the “disenchantment of the world”.

~ STEVEN SHAPIN, *The Scientific Revolution*

I should prefer to die in a reasonably dry ditch under the stars.

~ GEORGE BERNARD SHAW

Their chief is called Julius Caesar. His father was a tiger and his mother was a burning mountain.

~ GEORGE BERNARD SHAW, *Caesar and Cleopatra*

All artsmen know what it is to be enthusiastically praised for something so easy that they are half ashamed of it, and to receive not a word of encouragement for their finest strokes.

~ GEORGE BERNARD SHAW, *London Music*

Hell, in short, is a place where you have nothing to do but amuse yourself.

~ GEORGE BERNARD SHAW, *Man and Superman*

A perpetual holiday is a good working definition of hell.

~ GEORGE BERNARD SHAW, *Misalliance*

The secret of being miserable is to have leisure to bother about whether you are happy or not. The cure for it is occupation, because occupation means preoccupation; and the preoccupied person is neither happy nor unhappy, but simply alive and active, which is pleasanter than any happiness, until you are tired of it.

~ GEORGE BERNARD SHAW, *Misalliance*

I had rather be a dog than the Prime Minister of a country where the only thing the inhabitants can be serious about are football and refreshments.

~ GEORGE BERNARD SHAW, *The Apple Cart*

No man who is occupied in doing a very difficult thing, and doing it very well, ever loses his self-respect.

~ GEORGE BERNARD SHAW, *The Doctor's Dilemma*

The truth is the one thing nobody will believe.

~ GEORGE BERNARD SHAW, *The Man of Destiny*

The manager of the C.F.A. Theatre regrets to have to announce that his attempt to procure a new play introducing a married woman in love with her own husband, and without a past, has been wholly unsuccessful. An appeal to our leading dramatic authors to write such a play has elicited a unanimous refusal to compromise their professional reputation by dealing with an abnormal situation and catering for morbid tastes.

~ GEORGE BERNARD SHAW, *The Theatre of the Future*

I wanted to get at the facts. I was prepared for the facts being unflattering; had I not already faced the fact that instead of being a fallen angel I was first cousin to a monkey?

~ GEORGE BERNARD SHAW, *Three Plays by Brieux*

He talked of accepting Lord Foppington's invitation to sup at Sir Tunbelly Clumsey's.

~ R. B. SHERIDAN

I hope, my Lord, those buckles have had the unspeakable satisfaction of being honoured with your Lordship's approbation?

~ R. B. SHERIDAN

I will now show you the excess of my passion, by being very calm. Come, Lory, lay your loggerhead to mine, and, in cold blood, let us contrive his destruction.

~ R. B. SHERIDAN

"An old woman with snow-white hair was holding a one-year-old child in her arms and singing to it and tickling it. The child was cooing with delight. The parents were looking on with tears in their eyes. The father was holding the hand of a boy about 10 years old and speaking to him softly; the boy was fighting his tears. The father pointed to the sky, stroked his head and seemed to explain something to him." [1942-10-5, Dubno execution pits, Ukraine]

~ W. L. SHIRER, *The Rise and Fall of the Third Reich*

“Goering leaves Rome. We had dinner at the Excelsior Hotel, and during the dinner Goering talked of little else but the jewels he owned. In fact, he had some beautiful rings on his fingers. On the way to the station he wore a great sable coat, something between what automobile drivers wore in 1906 and what a high-grade prostitute wears to the opera.”

~ W. L. SHIRER, *The Rise and Fall of the Third Reich*

Ho! bold Orion, with thy lion-shield;
What tidings from the chase? what monsters slain?

~ LYDIA SIGOURNEY, *The Stars*

In the Middle Ages languages were learned by speaking and not from grammars.

~ C. SINGER, *A History of Scientific Ideas*

It appeared about 1240 and was still being reprinted in the seventeenth century. It is one of the puzzles of history that this great improvement [Hindu-Arabic numerals], represented by the “Arabic” as against the Latin system, took three centuries to gain general acceptance.

~ C. SINGER, *A History of Scientific Ideas*

It therefore behooves the historian of science to be very charitable, very forbearing, very humble, in his judgements and presentations of those who have gone before him. He needs to remember that he is dealing with the work of erring and imperfect human beings.

~ C. SINGER, *A History of Scientific Ideas*

The humanists discovered the literary works of antiquity. In them they became absorbed to the exclusion of all else. Their eagerness passed into a literary vogue, and cast the blight of a purely literary education on the modern world.

~ C. SINGER, *A History of Scientific Ideas*

Society and conversation ... are the most powerful remedies for restoring the mind to its tranquility.

~ ADAM SMITH

... it is not good for any field if any one person's views are taken too authoritatively. There is no scientist, not even Newton or Einstein, who was not wrong on a substantial number of issues they had strong views about.

~ LEE SMOLIN, *The Trouble With Physics*

But what is equally important, and sobering, is how often we fool ourselves. And we fool ourselves not only individually but en masse. The tendency of a group of human beings to quickly come to believe something that its individual members will later see as obviously false is truly amazing.

~ LEE SMOLIN, *The Trouble With Physics*

Feyerabend insisted that scientists should never agree, unless they are forced to.

~ LEE SMOLIN, *The Trouble With Physics*

Good ideas are not taken seriously enough when they come from people of low status in the academic world; conversely, the ideas of high-status people are often taken too seriously.

~ LEE SMOLIN, *The Trouble With Physics*

If a highly disciplined subject like physics is vulnerable to the symptoms of groupthink, what may be happening in other, less rigorous areas?

~ LEE SMOLIN, *The Trouble With Physics*

If your ideas are right and you fight for them, you'll accomplish something. No one but you can develop your ideas, and no one but you will fight for them.

~ LEE SMOLIN, *The Trouble With Physics*

On the other hand, if string theorists are wrong, they can't be just a little wrong. If the new dimensions and symmetries do not exist, then we will count string theorists among science's greatest failures, like those who continued to work on Ptolemaic epicycles while Kepler and Galileo forged ahead. Theirs will be a cautionary tale of how not to do science, how not to let theoretical conjecture get so far beyond the limits of what can rationally be argued that one starts engaging in fantasy.

~ LEE SMOLIN, *The Trouble With Physics*

Some people need to think through everything very carefully, and this takes time, as they get easily confused. It's not hard to feel superior to such people, until you remember that Einstein was one of them.

~ LEE SMOLIN, *The Trouble With Physics*

The most cherished goal in physics, as in bad romance novels, is unification.

~ LEE SMOLIN, *The Trouble With Physics*

To be fair, we have made two experimental discoveries in the past few decades: that neutrinos have mass and that the universe is dominated by a mysterious dark energy that seems to be accelerating its expansion.

~ LEE SMOLIN, *The Trouble With Physics*

What is remarkable to me is the number of distinguished scientists who seem unable to accept the possibility either that string theory or the hypothesis of a random multiverse is wrong.

~ LEE SMOLIN, *The Trouble With Physics*

[String theorists] seem to feel that appeal to consensus within their community is equivalent to rational argument.

~ LEE SMOLIN, *The Trouble With Physics*

... and I am persuaded it produces infinite mischief to the delicate and infirm.

~ TOBIAS SMOLLETT, *The Expedition of Humphry Clinker*

... and as to the few letters that passed between us, they are all in my uncle's hands, and I hope they contain nothing contrary to innocence and honour.

~ TOBIAS SMOLLETT, *The Expedition of Humphry Clinker*

... and let me tell you, it is no small alleviation of my grievances, that I have a sensible friend, to whom I can communicate my crusty humours, which, by retention, would grow intolerably acrimonious.

~ TOBIAS SMOLLETT, *The Expedition of Humphry Clinker*

... began to practise upon the French horn; and, being in the very first rudiments of execution, produced such discordant sounds, as might have discomposed the organs of an ass.

~ TOBIAS SMOLLETT, *The Expedition of Humphry Clinker*

I vow to God your impertinence is exceedingly provoking.

~ TOBIAS SMOLLETT, *The Expedition of Humphry Clinker*

Some cried, some swore, and the tropes and figures of Billingsgate were used without reserve in all their native zest and flavour; nor were those flowers of rhetoric unattended with significant gesticulations.

~ TOBIAS SMOLLETT, *The Expedition of Humphry Clinker*

Now is the time that we were going, I to die and you to live; but which of us has the happier prospect is unknown to anyone but God.

~ SOCRATES

Let all come out, however vile!

~ SOPHOCLES, *King Oedipus*

Time is awake. The wheel is turning.

~ SOPHOCLES, *Oedipus at Colonus*

Getting the coffee ready is the most delicate and attractive of domestic operations to one who lives alone; it is the masterpiece of a bachelor's housekeeping.

~ EMILE SOUVESTRE, *An Attic Philosopher In Paris*

Is it really certain that happiness is the prize of brilliant successes, rather than of a wisely accepted poverty? Ah, if men but knew in what a small dwelling joy can live, and how little it costs to furnish it!

~ EMILE SOUVESTRE, *An Attic Philosopher In Paris*

Bonaparte wanted me to praise him in my writings, not, certainly, that an additional eulogy would have been noticed in the fumes of incense surrounding him, but it annoyed him that I was the only writer the French knew who had published under his rule without making any mention of his majestic existence.

~ MADAME DE STAEL

I had the experience of entering poor homes [in Germany] blackened by tobacco-smoke and of suddenly hearing not only the mistress but also the master of the house improvising on the harpsichord, as the Italians improvise in verse.

~ MADAME DE STAEL

When a writer's main purpose is to produce an effect upon others, he never reveals his real self, but when he writes to satisfy an internal urge with which his soul is possessed, he involuntarily reveals through his writings even the slightest *nuances* of his way of living and thinking.

~ MADAME DE STAEL

He calls it [some uses of the Greek letter sigma] “a graceless disagreeable letter which gives great pain when used in excess, for its hissing seems more akin to that of a brute beast than to that of a rational being.”

~ W. B. STANFORD, *The Sound of Greek*

... and old age, instead of introducing melancholy Prospects of Decay ...

~ STEELE AND ADDISON, *The Spectator*

... whom I earnestly implore to accommodate me with a method how to settle my head and cool my brain-pan.

~ STEELE AND ADDISON, *The Spectator*

At length the audience grew tired of understanding half the opera; and therefore, to ease themselves entirely of the fatigue of thinking, have so ordered it at present, that the whole opera is performed in an unknown tongue.

~ STEELE AND ADDISON, *The Spectator*

Cette demoiselle, grande Franc-Comtoise, fort bien faite, et mise comme il le faut pour faire valoir un café.

~ STENDHAL, *Le rouge et le noir*

Le bonheur, pour ces seminaristes comme pour les héros des romans de Voltaire, consiste surtout à bien dîner.

~ STENDHAL, *Le rouge et le noir*

Le maire de Verrières devait une réputation d'esprit et surtout de bon ton à une demi-douzaine de plaisanteries dont il avait hérité d'un oncle.

~ STENDHAL, *Le rouge et le noir*

Son éducation fut faite par la douleur.

~ STENDHAL, *Le rouge et le noir*

Le tombeau d'un ami.

~ LAURENCE STERNE

... there thou mayest solace thy soul in converse sweet ...

~ LAURENCE STERNE, *A Sentimental Journey*

Hail ye sweet courtesies of life, for smooth do ye make the road of it!

~ LAURENCE STERNE, *A Sentimental Journey*

Now where would be the harm, said I to myself, if I was to beg of this distressed lady to accept of half of my chaise? and what mighty mischief could ensue?

~ LAURENCE STERNE, *A Sentimental Journey*

The old officer was reading attentively a small pamphlet, it might be the book of the opera, with a large pair of spectacles. As soon as I sat down, he took his spectacles off, and putting them into a shagreen case, return'd them and the book into his pocket altogether. I half rose up, and made him a bow. Translate this into any civilized language in the world, the sense is this: "Here's a poor stranger come in to the box; he seems as if he knew nobody; and is never likely, was he to be seven years in Paris, if every man he comes near keeps his spectacles upon his nose - 'tis shutting the door of conversation absolutely, in his face - and using him worse than a German."

~ LAURENCE STERNE, *A Sentimental Journey*

Tis going, I own, like the Knight of the Woeful Countenance, in quest of melancholy adventures.

~ LAURENCE STERNE, *A Sentimental Journey*

So much for Caligula as emperor; we must now tell of his career as a monster.

~ SUETONIUS, *Lives of the Caesars*

For Yevgenia Krasnova, a person could love one book, at most a few – beyond this was a form of promiscuity.

~ NASSIM TALEB

One frequent confusion: people believe that I am suggesting that agents should bet on Black Swans taking place, when I am saying they should avoid blowing up should a Black Swan take place.

~ NASSIM TALEB

Our problem is not just that we do not know the future, we do not know much of the past either.

~ NASSIM TALEB

People do not realize that success consists mainly in avoiding losses, not in trying to derive profits.

~ NASSIM TALEB

The idea that in order to make a decision you need to focus on the consequences (which you can know) rather than the probability (which you can't know) is the central idea of uncertainty. Much of my life is based on it.

~ NASSIM TALEB

Even the abandoned husk of a person can sometimes perform useful tasks and enjoy mildly good times.

~ JAMES TATE

The whole point of travelling is to arrive alone, like a spectre, in a strange country at nightfall, not in the brightly lit capital but by the back door, in the wooded countryside, hundreds of miles from the metropolis. Arriving in the hinterland with only the vaguest plans is a liberating event. It can be a solemn occasion for discovery, or more like an irresponsible and random haunting of another planet.

~ PAUL THEROUX, *The Tao of Travel*

No man is rich enough to keep a poet in his pay.

~ H. D. THOREAU

A farmer, a hunter, a soldier, a reporter, even a philosopher, may be daunted; but nothing can deter a poet, for he is actuated by pure love. Who can predict his comings and goings?

~ H. D. THOREAU, *Walden*

A lady once offered me a mat, but as I had no room to spare within the house, nor time to spare within or without to shake it, I declined it, preferring to wipe my feet on the sod before my door. It is best to avoid the beginnings of evil.

~ H. D. THOREAU, *Walden*

As if you could kill time without injuring eternity.

~ H. D. THOREAU, *Walden*

But lo! men have become the tools of their tools.

~ H. D. THOREAU, *Walden*

Even in our New England towns the accidental possession of wealth, and its manifestations in dress and equipage alone, obtain for the possessor almost universal respect.

~ H. D. THOREAU, *Walden*

For many years I was self-appointed inspector of snow storms and rain storms, and did my duty faithfully.

~ H. D. THOREAU, *Walden*

Give me the poverty that enjoys true wealth.

~ H. D. THOREAU, *Walden*

I find it wholesome to be alone the greater part of the time. To be in company, even with the best, is soon wearisome and dissipating. I love to be alone. I never found the companion so companionable as solitude.

~ H. D. THOREAU, *Walden*

Our lives are frittered away in detail. Simplify, simplify.

~ H. D. THOREAU, *Walden*

Time is but the stream I go a-fishin in.

~ H. D. THOREAU, *Walden*

Here we may notice the plucking or digging of magic herbs at a given time with certain ceremonies, or the curing of toothache by saying "Anasageus" thrice, touching the aching tooth with a spear, and driving the spear into the the pavement of the baptistery.

~ L. THORNDIKE, *History of Magic and Experimental Science v.6*

If our account seems cursory, this is partly because such works are so mystical and cloudy that a definite exposition of their contents is difficult, and that one dares not care to stand for long on the quicksands of their reveries.

~ L. THORNDIKE, *History of Magic and Experimental Science v.6*

... and on the bite of the tarantula, a poison supposed to operate on anniversaries of the original puncturing and to be relieved only by dancing to certain music.

~ L. THORNDIKE, *History of Magic and Experimental Science v.7*

Boyle himself told further of a man who had wasted away to a mere skeleton but recovered by hard-boiling an egg in his own urine, punching the egg-shell full of holes, and burying it in an anthill.

~ L. THORNDIKE, *History of Magic and Experimental Science v.8*

This extremely learned and virtuous man [Jean Filesac] in 1609 had published a treatise on Idolatrous Magic, in which he asserted that the transportation of witches to nocturnal sabbats had been so thoroughly proved by the most erudite of men of the age, that, if anyone any longer cherished any doubt about it, he should be judged not only a wanderer from the Christian faith and religion but as sadly deficient in reason and judgement.

~ L. THORNDIKE, *History of Magic and Experimental Science* v.8

[Quoting Caspar Batholinus:] No other quality more deserves the name of occult than gravity.

~ L. THORNDIKE, *History of Magic and Experimental Science* v.8

[Quoting Lord Keynes:] [Isaac Newton was] the last of the magicians.

~ L. THORNDIKE, *History of Magic and Experimental Science* v.8

But Pliny himself feels that the assertions of the books of magic are fantastic, exaggerated, and untrue. He repeatedly brands the *magi* or magicians as fools or impostors, and their statements as absurd and impudent tissues of lies.

~ L. THORNDIKE, *History of Magic and Experimental Science*

It has often been remarked that, as a new religion comes to prevail in a society, the old rites are discredited and prohibited as magic. The faith and ceremonies of the majority, performed publicly, are called religion; the discarded cult, now practiced only privately and covertly by a majority, is stigmatized as magic and contrary to the general good.

~ L. THORNDIKE, *History of Magic and Experimental Science*

The life of reason alone is free from magic.

~ L. THORNDIKE, *History of Magic and Experimental Science*

[Quoting Breasted:] It is difficult for the modern mind to understand how completely the belief in magic penetrated the whole substance of life, dominating popular custom and constantly appearing in the simplest acts of the daily household routine, as much a matter of course as sleep or the preparation of food.

~ L. THORNDIKE, *History of Magic and Experimental Science*

[Quoting E. A. Wallis Budge] The belief in magic influenced [Egyptian] minds from the earliest date to the latest period in their history, in a manner which, at this stage in the history of the world, is very difficult to comprehend.

~ L. THORNDIKE, *History of Magic and Experimental Science*

By its nature, the metropolis provides what otherwise could be given only by traveling; namely, the strange.

~ PAUL TILLICH

... but Vronsky went on looking at him as at a lamppost, and the young man grimaced, feeling that he was losing his self-possession under the pressure of this non-recognition of himself as a human being.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *Anna Karenina*

And so the liberal tendency became a habit with Stepan Arkadyich, and he liked his newspaper, as he liked his cigar after dinner, for the slight haze it produced in his head.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *Anna Karenina*

It showed him the eternal error people make in imagining that happiness is the realization of desires.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *Anna Karenina*

The conversation never flagged for a minute, so that the old princess, who, in case a topic was lacking, always kept two heavy cannon in reserve – classical versus modern education, and general military conscription – did not have to move them up.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *Anna Karenina*

There are no conditions to which a person cannot grow accustomed, especially if he sees that everyone around him lives in the same way.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *Anna Karenina*

All this was as it should be, because the welfare and happiness of the whole world depended on him, and wearied though he was, he would still not refuse the universe his assistance.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *Hadji Murad*

– Celle-là? Oui, c'est une bonne bête, elle ne chasse pas mal, répondit d'un ton indifférent Ilaguine qui, un an plus tôt, avait donné à un voisin trois familles de domestiques serfs en échange de son Erza rouge.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *La guerre et la paix*

Et Rostov se leva et alla errer entre les feux de camp, rêvant au bonheur de mourir, non pas en sauvant la vie de l'empereur (à cela il n'osait même pas rêver) mais simplement sous ses yeux.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *La guerre et la paix*

Et elle se remit à pleurer parce que son âme était si belle.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *La guerre et la paix*

Hélène sourit comme pour dire qu'elle n'admettait pas qu'on pût la voir sans être ravi.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *La guerre et la paix*

La guerre n'est pas de la galanterie mais la chose la plus abjecte de la vie, et il faut le comprendre et ne pas jouer à la guerre.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *La guerre et la paix*

Lui [Napoléon] que la Providence avait prédestiné au triste rôle asservi de bourreau des nations, il voulait se persuader que le but de ses actes était le bien des nations, qu'il pouvait diriger les destinées de millions d'hommes et, d'autorité, faire leur bonheur!

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *La guerre et la paix*

... the nakedness of woman already tormented me. The hours I spent alone were not pure ones.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *The Kreutzer Sonata*

A honeymoon is an embarrassing, shameful, loathsome, pathetic business, and most of all it is tedious, unbearably tedious! It is something similar to what I experienced when I was learning how to smoke. I felt like vomiting, my saliva flowed, but I swallowed it and pretended I was enjoying myself.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *The Kreutzer Sonata*

In town a man can live for a hundred years and never notice that he's long dead and buried. There's never any time to study your conscience; you're busy all the time.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *The Kreutzer Sonata*

It's really quite remarkable how complete the illusion is that beauty is the same as goodness.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *The Kreutzer Sonata*

But despite the fact that the doctors treated him, bled him, and gave him medicines to drink, he recovered.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *War and Peace*

Count Rostov was displeased to see that the company consisted almost entirely of men and women known for the freedom of their conduct.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *War and Peace*

Here Prince Hippolyte paused, evidently collecting his ideas with some difficulty.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *War and Peace*

Silence ensued.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *War and Peace*

Unhappiness arises not from privation but from superfluity.

~ LEO TOLSTOY, *War and Peace*

The change-over from a developmental to a static conception of matter was as profound as the change from a geocentric to a heliocentric astronomy, and its effects were as far-reaching.

~ TOULMIN AND GOODFIELD, *The Architecture of Matter*

For Galileo still thought of “inertial motion” as naturally circular, whether in the case of a ship moving over the Earth’s surface, or in that of a satellite circling around the planet Jupiter.

~ TOULMIN AND GOODFIELD, *The Fabric of the Heavens*

It says much for Newton’s mathematical facility that he engaged in the whole enterprise as though it were an intellectual pastime, while believing all the time that the questions of true importance lay in other, religious directions.

~ TOULMIN AND GOODFIELD, *The Fabric of the Heavens*

Leibniz would have said that the term “field” was only a way of making Newton’s miracles computable.

~ TOULMIN AND GOODFIELD, *The Fabric of the Heavens*

Yet ideas cannot be burned at the stake as heretics can.

~ TOULMIN AND GOODFIELD, *The Fabric of the Heavens*

By law, children who were said to have attended their mother to the sabbat were merely flogged in front of the fire in which their parent was burning.

~ H. R. TREVOR-ROPER, *The European Witch-Craze*

In the sixteenth century the witch gradually replaces the Jew, and in the seventeenth century the reversal is almost complete. If the universal scapegoat of the Black Death in Germany had been the Jew, the universal scapegoat of the Wars of Religion will be the witch.

~ H. R. TREVOR-ROPER, *The European Witch-Craze*

Montaigne remarked that "it is rating our conjectures highly to roast people alive for them."

~ H. R. TREVOR-ROPER, *The European Witch-Craze*

Romances of chivalry could be laughed out of existence, but no Don Quixote dared to kill, by ridicule, the bizarre novellettes which the grave lawyers and divines of all Europe published about Satan's kingdom.

~ H. R. TREVOR-ROPER, *The European Witch-Craze*

The last legal execution [of a witch] was in Protestant Glarus, in Switzerland, in 1782.

~ H. R. TREVOR-ROPER, *The European Witch-Craze*

The law of God was stated most explicitly in Exodus 22-18: "thou shalt not suffer a witch to live."

~ H. R. TREVOR-ROPER, *The European Witch-Craze*

When [the *Malleus Maleficarum*, “Hammer of Witches”] was published, it carried on its title-page the bold epigraph, “To disbelieve in witchcraft is the greatest of heresies.” It was the exact opposite of the ruling of the Church in the Dark Ages. Since the 9th century, the wheel had come full circle.

~ H. R. TREVOR-ROPER, *The European Witch-Craze*

“Johnny Eames has come across Crosbie, and given him a desperate beating.” “No,” said Lady Julia, putting down her newspaper and spectacles, and expressing by the light of her eyes anything but Christian horror at the wickedness of the deed.

~ ANTHONY TROLLOPE, *The Small House at Allington*

Chaos should be regarded as extremely good news.

~ CHÖGYAM TRUNGPA

The attainment of enlightenment from ego’s point of view is extreme death, the death of self, the death of me and mine, the death of the watcher. It is the ultimate and final disappointment. Treading the spiritual path is painful. It is a constant unmasking, peeling off layer after layer of masks. It involves insult after insult.

~ CHÖGYAM TRUNGPA

The real function of a spiritual friend is to insult you.

~ CHÖGYAM TRUNGPA

Eventually we must give up trying to be something special.

~ CHÖGYAM TRUNGPA, *Cutting Through Spiritual Materialism*

In fact, the higher we go, the more we come down to earth.

~ CHÖGYAM TRUNGPA, *Cutting Through Spiritual Materialism*

Let people look at you and examine you. You are at their disposal.

~ CHÖGYAM TRUNGPA, *Cutting Through Spiritual Materialism*

No man will ever possess Myra Breckinridge, though she will possess men, in her own good time and in ways convenient to her tyrannous lust.

~ GORE VIDAL, *Myra Breckenridge*

... Il ne lui faut que deux choses: la vie et la rêverie; le *pain* et le *temps*.

~ ALFRED DE VIGNY, *Dernière nuit de travail*

Il est bon et salubre de n'avoir aucune espérance.

~ ALFRED DE VIGNY, *Le journal d'un poète*

Je me laissais dévorer par le vautour intérieur.

~ ALFRED DE VIGNY, *Le journal d'un poète*

La Gloire. J'ai cru longtemps en elle; mais, réfléchissant que l'auteur de Laocoön est inconnu, j'ai vu sa vanité.

~ ALFRED DE VIGNY, *Le journal d'un poète*

Les illusions sont le pain de sots. L'homme fort ne les prend que comme des liqueurs fortes lorsqu'il sent le besoin de s'enivrer. Remède contre l'ennui.

~ ALFRED DE VIGNY, *Le journal d'un poète*

L'homme d'action n'est qu'un penseur manqué.

~ ALFRED DE VIGNY, *Le journal d'un poète*

L'homme, créature inachevée, tient encore du singe et du chien.

~ ALFRED DE VIGNY, *Le journal d'un poète*

Plus je vois, plus je m'aperçois que la seule chose essentielle, pour les hommes, c'est de tuer le temps. Dans cette vie dont nous chantons la brièveté sur tous les tons, notre plus grand ennemi, c'est le temps, dont nous avons toujours trop.

~ ALFRED DE VIGNY, *Le journal d'un poète*

L'admiration est corrupue et corruptrice. On doit bien faire pour soi-même, et non pour le bruit.

~ ALFRED DE VIGNY, *Servitudes et grandeurs militaires*

Je ne veux, derrière moi, que le néant.

~ A. DE VILLIERS DE L'ISLE-ADAM, *Deux augures*

Le public ne lit pas un journal pour penser ou réfléchir, que diable! On lit comme on mange.

~ A. DE VILLIERS DE L'ISLE-ADAM, *Deux augures*

Lorsque Stendhal voulait écrire une histoire d'amour un peu sentimentale, il avait coutume, on le sait, de relire d'abord une demi-douzaine de pages du Code pénal pour, – disait-il, – se donner le ton.

~ A. DE VILLIERS DE L'ISLE-ADAM, *La convive des dernières fêtes*

... le vieil abîme des cieux ...

~ A. DE VILLIERS DE L'ISLE-ADAM, *Le désir d'être un homme*

Ne serait-ce pas de quoi étonner la Grande Ourse elle-même si, soudainement, surgissait entre ses pattes sublimes, cette annonce inquiétante: "Faut-il des corsets, oui ou non?"

~ A. DE VILLIERS DE L'ISLE-ADAM, *L'affichage céleste*

Pour conclure, me dit Maucombe en se levant, nous sommes ici pour témoigner, – par nos oeuvres, nos pensées, nos paroles et notre lutte contre la Nature, – pour témoigner si *nous pesons le poids*. Et il termina par une citation de Joseph de Maistre: «Entre l'Homme et Dieu, il n'y a que l'Orgueil.»

~ A. DE VILLIERS DE L'ISLE-ADAM, *L'intersigne*

Those who make you believe absurdities can make you commit atrocities.

~ VOLTAIRE

... if one digs in a town of the Old Babylonian period it seems that one can find a few tablets in almost every house.

~ C. B. F. WALKER, *Cuneiform*

As in other Semitic languages, Akkadian words basically have a root of three consonants, e.g. *prs*, which is then modified internally by the doubling of consonants or insertion of vowels, and externally by the addition of prefixes or postfixes, e.g. *iprus*, *purus*, *iparrasuni*.

~ C. B. F. WALKER, *Cuneiform*

Eighty-five percent of the tablets from the early levels at Uruk are economic and are concerned with the income and outgoings of the city's temples in terms of food, livestock, and textiles. Fifteen percent of the texts are lexical lists, including the names of various commodities, animals, and officials.

~ C. B. F. WALKER, *Cuneiform*

Enheduanna, the daughter of Sargon I, and high priestess of the moon-god Nanna at Ur, is one of the few female scribes known from Mesopotamia, and the earliest named author in history.

~ C. B. F. WALKER, *Cuneiform*

In some respects the Sumerian script never quite escapes from the fact that it was originally designed for the purpose of practical book-keeping rather than to express abstract ideas.

~ C. B. F. WALKER, *Cuneiform*

The end of the wooden or reed stylus, which struck the clay first, made a wider mark than the shaft, and so came into being the typical wedge-shaped impressions after which this writing system became known – cuneiform, from the Latin word *cuneus* meaning wedge.

~ C. B. F. WALKER, *Cuneiform*

The number of distinct cuneiform signs in use from the late third millenium onwards is about six hundred.

~ C. B. F. WALKER, *Cuneiform*

The scribes often describe themselves simply as *dubsar*, but sometimes give themselves other titles such as “junior scribe”, or “exorcist”.

~ C. B. F. WALKER, *Cuneiform*

Thus it is beginning to look as if we should think in terms of the invention of writing as being a gradual process, accomplished over a wide area, rather than the product of a single Sumerian genius.

~ C. B. F. WALKER, *Cuneiform*

Writing was invented in order to record business activities in the early Near East.

~ C. B. F. WALKER, *Cuneiform*

Flaubert's friends were often obliged to stretch their sense of the comic beyond its comfortable limits.

~ GEOFFREY WALL, *Flaubert: A Life*

... [les conseils officieux] nous informèrent aussi que la guillotine avait été déclarée permanente sur la place du Carrousel; que cette place venait d'être nommée place de l'Egalité [août 1792].

~ WEBER, *Mémoires*

... when Pierre Fermat derived the law [of refraction] from the principle of least time, mechanical philosophers refused to have truck with what they considered occult notions.

~ RICHARD WESTFALL, *Never at Rest*

By 1661, the official curriculum of Cambridge, prescribed by statute nearly a century before, was in an advanced state of decomposition.

~ RICHARD WESTFALL, *Never at Rest*

Cambridge was fast approaching the status of an intellectual wasteland.

~ RICHARD WESTFALL, *Never at Rest*

For them, Aristotelian philosophy was dead beyond resurrection. In its place stood a new philosophy for which the machine, not the organism, was the dominant analogy.

~ RICHARD WESTFALL, *Never at Rest*

Indeed, it was Descartes and not Galileo who stated the principle of inertia in the form we accept today, insisting on the rectilinear character of inertial motion.

~ RICHARD WESTFALL, *Never at Rest*

Nevertheless, I have undertaken to write a biography of Newton, and my personal preferences cannot make more than a million words he wrote in the study of alchemy disappear.

~ RICHARD WESTFALL, *Never at Rest*

What he thought on, he thought on continually, which is to say exclusively, or nearly exclusively. What seized his attention in 1664, to the virtual exclusion of everything else, was mathematics.

~ RICHARD WESTFALL, *Never at Rest*

The countless anti-Semitic persecutors who plundered Jewish property and burned and massacred Jews over the centuries always prepared the ground by first accusing their victims of the crimes they themselves intended to commit.

~ ROBERT WESTRICH, *A Lethal Obsession*

This belief in the fantasies of the *Protocols* is not confined to Qutb and his fundamentalist believers. To this day it remains absolutely mainstream in the Muslim world.

~ ROBERT WESTRICH, *A Lethal Obsession*

Civilization advances by extending the number of important operations which we can perform without thinking about them.

~ ALFRED NORTH WHITEHEAD, *Introduction to Mathematics*

I bequeath myself to the dirt to grow from the grass I love,
If you want me again look for me under your boot-soles.

~ WALT WHITMAN, *Song of Myself*

And I or you pocketless of a dime may purchase the pick of the earth, and to glance with an eye or show a bean in its pod confounds the learning of all times, and there is no trade or employment but the young man following it may become a hero, and there is no object so soft but it makes a hub for the wheel'd universe, and I say to any man or woman, let your soul stand cool and composed before a million universes.

~ WALT WHITMAN, *Song of Myself*

I and this mystery here we stand.

~ WALT WHITMAN, *Song of Myself*

If you would understand me go to the heights or water-shore. The nearest gnat is an explanation.

~ WALT WHITMAN, *Song of Myself*

... facts are either kept in their proper subordinate position, or else entirely excluded on the general ground of dullness.

~ OSCAR WILDE

Consistency is the last refuge of the unimaginative.

~ OSCAR WILDE

Many a young man starts in life with a natural gift for exaggeration which, if nurtured in congenial and sympathetic surroundings, or by the imitation of the best models, might grow into something really great and wonderful. But, as a rule, he comes to nothing. He either falls into careless habits of accuracy, or takes to frequenting the society of the aged and well-informed.

~ OSCAR WILDE

I had multiple fractures of the soul.

~ DONNA WILLIAMS, *Nobody Nowhere*

I stopped at a bus stop, happy to be alone in a quiet place; a nobody nowhere.

~ DONNA WILLIAMS, *Nobody Nowhere*

I am forced to admit that over the past couple of days I have not held the banner of Veracity and Rectitude as steadily as I might have done.

~ R. M. WILSON, *Ripley Bogle*

I can wheel and circle without restraint ... and I can breathe unlimited by wall and roof.

~ R. M. WILSON, *Ripley Bogle*

In real life I'd soon be graced with a headhole that was, strictly speaking, surplus to my cranial requirements.

~ R. M. WILSON, *Ripley Bogle*

I'm glad to see that the twin tides of wit and discernment have not entirely ebbed from South London.

~ R. M. WILSON, *Ripley Bogle*

My hair is winning few prizes but it's vaguely presentable, in half light, with a paper bag over my head.

~ R. M. WILSON, *Ripley Bogle*

Perhaps that's why my style is so florid, so rotund, so fucking courtly.

~ R. M. WILSON, *Ripley Bogle*

She smiles in her turn, her eyes adorned with the indifference of beauty.

~ R. M. WILSON, *Ripley Bogle*

Things looked black indeed for young Bogle until the fellow that they had been assaulting rose to his feet and began to lend me assistance in the most vigorous fashion, employing the cricket bat he had been carrying with great elan and native dexterity.

~ R. M. WILSON, *Ripley Bogle*

This was fortunate as my darling mother had vowed to boil my head if I got into more trouble and she wasn't one for hyperbole.

~ R. M. WILSON, *Ripley Bogle*

A considerable part of the intelligentsia is inclined toward anti-Semitism and, what is much more important, the major part of the student body approves it.

~ JAMES WATERMAN WISE, *Swastika: The Nazi Terror*

Contemporary youth has a new conception of the nature of the State which tends in the direction of the collectivistic ideal.

~ JAMES WATERMAN WISE, *Swastika: The Nazi Terror*

He was a ferret-faced kid, whom I had disliked since birth.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *Carry On, Jeeves*

I am open to correction, sir ...

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *Carry On, Jeeves*

I shall naturally order my behaviour according to the accepted rules of civilized intercourse.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *Carry On, Jeeves*

I was walking back along the shore, when I saw the fat child meditatively smacking a jelly-fish with a spade.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *Carry On, Jeeves*

If you fail, I shall know that your Aunt Agatha was right when she called you a spineless invertebrate and advised me strongly not to marry you.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *Carry On, Jeeves*

Lay out our gent's medium-smart raiment, suitable for Bohemian revels.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *Carry On, Jeeves*

Mrs. Pringle's aspect was that of one who had had bad news round about the year 1900 and never really got over it.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *Carry On, Jeeves*

Nobody has a greater respect than I have for your judgement in socks, in ties, and – I will go farther – in spats; but when it comes to evening shirts your nerve seems to fail you. You have no vision. You are prejudicial and reactionary. Hidebound is the word that suggests itself.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *Carry On, Jeeves*

You may say what you want against Bingo, but nobody has ever found him a depressing host. Why, many a time in the days of his bachelorhood I've known him to start throwing bread before the soup course.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *Carry On, Jeeves*

"Yes, sir," said Jeeves, in a low, cold voice, as if he had been bitten in the leg by a personal friend.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *Carry On, Jeeves*

For Madeline Basset was undeniably of attractive exterior – slim, *svelte*, if that's the word, and bountifully equipped with golden hair and all the fixings.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *The Code of the Woosters*

I ventured to suggest that it might be possible to induce him to leave his post by conveying word to him that the parlourmaid Mary, to whom he was betrothed, wished to confer with him in the raspberry bushes.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *The Code of the Woosters*

It was plain from old Bassett's manner that he was not prepared to classify this under the heading of tidings of great joy.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *The Code of the Woosters*

She had been as tough as a restaurant steak, and she continued as tough as a restaurant steak.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *The Code of the Woosters*

Since you ask, Spode, I want to know what the devil you mean by keeping coming into my private apartment, taking up space which I require for other purposes and interrupting me when I am chatting with my personal friends.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *The Code of the Woosters*

Yes. They were arguing about something, and Augustus told him to go and boil his head.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *The Code of the Woosters*

You've met her. She came to lunch at the flat a week or two ago. Smallish girl of about the tonnage of Jessie Matthews.

~ P. G. WODEHOUSE, *The Code of the Woosters*

... and that, in the true style of Mahometanism, [women] are treated as a kind of subordinate being, and not as part of the human species.

~ MARY WOLLSTONECRAFT, *A Vindication of the Rights of Woman*

If she attends to her children, it is in general to dress them in a costly manner.

~ MARY WOLLSTONECRAFT, *A Vindication of the Rights of Woman*

In short, speaking of the majority of mothers, they leave their children entirely to the care of servants; or, because they are their children, treat them as if they were little demi-gods.

~ MARY WOLLSTONECRAFT, *A Vindication of the Rights of Woman*

Men order their clothes to be made, and have done with the subject; women make their own clothes, and are continually talking about them.

~ MARY WOLLSTONECRAFT, *A Vindication of the Rights of Woman*

Thanks to that Being who impressed them on my soul, and gave me sufficient strength of mind to dare to exert my own reason, till, becoming dependent only on Him for the support of my virtue, I view, with indignation, the mistaken notions that enslave my sex.

~ MARY WOLLSTONECRAFT, *A Vindication of the Rights of Woman*

After the wedding, Ling's parents became discreet to the point of dying.

~ MARGUERITE YOURCENAR, *How Wang Fo Was Saved*

Her dress was disorderly, her voice husky from too much smoking and beer-drinking. Here indubitably was a fellow-mortal who was weary unto death, and who only continued living out of long-established habit.

~ STEFAN ZWEIG, *Moonbeam Alley*

There was something saucy in this ostentation. Was she a confirmed flirt? Was she stirred by a surplus of animal passion? I drew a step nearer, for I had been infected by her sauciness.

~ STEFAN ZWEIG, *Transfiguration*

For there is no man on earth who can fully renounce living work, but he who renounces the *reward* of his work is in truth a man of renunciation.

~ *Bhagavad Gita*

Of prayers I am the prayer of silence; and of things that move not I am the Himalayas.

~ *Bhagavad Gita*

Then his soul is like a lamp whose light is steady, for it burns in a shelter where no wind comes.

~ *Bhagavad Gita*

Do not what is evil. Do what is good. Keep your mind pure. That is the teaching of Buddha.

~ *Dhammapada*

Abandon all possessions and look for life, despise worldly goods and save your soul alive.

~ *Gilgamesh*

The dream was marvelous but the terror was great; we must treasure the dream whatever the terror.

~ *Gilgamesh*

... and ye shall know that I am the Lord that smiteth.

~ *King James Bible*

... because the daughters of Zion are haughty, and walk with stretched forth necks and wanton eyes, walking and mincing as they go, and making a tinkling with their feet.

~ *King James Bible*

... for them that honour me I will honour, and they that despise me shall be lightly esteemed.

~ *King James Bible*

... of making books there is no end; and much study is a weariness of the flesh.

~ *King James Bible*

A soft answer turneth away wrath: but grievous words stir up anger.

~ *King James Bible*

And it shall come to pass, that instead of sweet smell there shall be stink.

~ *King James Bible*

And now she is planted in the wilderness, in a dry and thirsty ground.

~ *King James Bible*

As a dog returneth to his vomit, so a fool returneth to his folly.

~ *King James Bible*

Awake, ye drunkards, and weep: and howl, all ye drinkers of wine, because of the new wine; for it is cut off from your mouth.

~ *King James Bible*

Because ye have taken my silver and gold, and have carried into your temples my goodly pleasant things.

~ *King James Bible*

But he turned, and said unto Peter, "Get thee behind me, Satan: thou art an offence unto me: for thou savourest not the things that be of God, but those that be of men."

~ *King James Bible*

Destruction cometh; and they shall seek peace, and there shall be none.

~ *King James Bible*

Hast thou entered into the treasures of the snow?

~ *King James Bible*

Hear, for I will speak of excellent things.

~ *King James Bible*

How long will ye vex my soul, and break me in pieces with words?

~ *King James Bible*

I will open my mouth in parables; I will utter things kept secret since the world was made.

~ *King James Bible*

If now thou hast understanding, hear this: hearken to the voice of my words.

~ *King James Bible*

Is not thy wickedness great? And thine iniquities infinite?

~ *King James Bible*

Now will I shortly pour out my fury upon thee, and accomplish mine anger upon thee: and I will judge thee according to thy ways, and will recompense thee for all thine abominations.

~ *King James Bible*

Pleasant words are as an honeycomb, sweet to the soul, and health to the bones.

~ *King James Bible*

So Job died, being old and full of days.

~ *King James Bible*

Suffer me that I may speak; and after that I have spoken, mock on.

~ *King James Bible*

The words of Job are ended.

~ *King James Bible*

When he speaketh fair, believe him not: for there are seven abominations in his heart.

~ *King James Bible*

When the morning stars sang together, and all the sons of God shouted for joy?

~ *King James Bible*

Which doeth great things past finding out; yea, and wonders without number.

~ *King James Bible*

Day after day and hour after hour, people die and corpses are carried along, yet the onlookers never realise that they are also to die one day, but think they will live forever. This is the greatest wonder of the world.

~ *Mahabharata*

A la place du supplice, elle [Mme. Roland] s'inclina devant la statue de liberté, et prononça ces paroles mémorables: "O liberté, que de crimes on commet en ton nom!"

~ *Mémoires sur les prisons*

Au moment d'aller au supplice, on arracha, du sein d'une de ces infortunées, un enfant qu'elle nourrissait, et qui, au moment même, s'abreuvait d'un lait dont le bourreau allait tarir la source. O cris de la douleur maternelle, que vous fûtes aigus! mais vous fûtes sans effet! Quelque femmes sont mortes dans la charrette, et on a guillotiné des cadavres.

~ *Mémoires sur les prisons*

Cette époque, qui offre l'exemple de tous les crimes, offre aussi quelquefois celui de la vertu sublime.

~ *Mémoires sur les prisons*

A man who knows this is not moved by grief or exultation on account of the evil or good he has done. He goes beyond both. What is done or left undone grieves him not.

~ *Upanishads*

All beings are born in delusion, the delusion of division which comes from desire and hate.

~ *Upanishads*

And in dreams the mind beholds its own immensity. What has been seen is seen again, and what has been heard is heard again. What has been felt in different places or faraway regions returns to the mind again. Seen and unseen, heard and unheard, felt and not felt, the mind sees all, since the mind is all.

~ *Upanishads*

The earth seems to rest in silent meditation; and the waters and the mountains and the sky and the heavens seem all to be in meditation.

~ *Upanishads*

Let him not ponder on many words, for many words are weariness.

~ *Upanishads*

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